

Records of the General Conference

43rd session

Samarkand, 30 October – 13 November 2025

Volume 1

Resolutions

United Nations
Educational, Scientific and
Cultural Organization

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Note on the Records of the General Conference

The Records of the 43rd session of the General Conference are printed in two volumes:¹

The present volume, containing the resolutions adopted by the General Conference, the reports of the APX, ED, SC-IOC, SHS, CLT and CI Commissions, the joint meeting of commissions, the Legal Committee and the list of officers of the General Conference and of the commissions and committees (Volume 1).

The volume of *Proceedings*, which contains the verbatim records of the plenary meetings and the list of participants (Volume 2).

Note on the numbering of resolutions

The resolutions have been numbered serially. It is recommended that references to resolutions be made in one of the following forms:

In the body of the text:

“Resolution 15 adopted by the General Conference at its 43rd session” or “43 C/Resolution 15”.

In passing reference:

“(43 C/Resolution 15)” or “(43 C/Res.15)”

All the terms used in this collection of texts to designate the person discharging duties or functions are to be interpreted as implying that men and women are equally eligible to fill any post or seat associated with the discharge of these duties and functions.

¹

Until the 30th session, the records of the General Conference were printed in three volumes: *Resolutions* (Volume 1); *Reports* (Volume 2); *Proceedings* (Volume 3).

Contents

I	Organization of the session	1
01	Credentials.....	1
02	Communications received from Member States invoking the provisions of Article IV.C, paragraph 8(c), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution.....	2
03	Adoption of the agenda	3
04	Composition of the Bureau	5
05	Organization of the work of the session	5
06	Admission to the 43rd session of observers from non-governmental organizations	5
II	Tributes	3
07	Tribute to Ms Audrey Azoulay, Director-General of UNESCO (2017–2025).....	3
08	Tribute to the President of the General Conference.....	4
09	Tribute to the Chairperson of the Executive Board.....	4
010	Vote of thanks to the people and Government of Uzbekistan.....	4
III	Elections	7
011	Appointment of the Director-General	7
012	Election of Members of the Executive Board	8
013	Election of the members of the Legal Committee for the 43rd session of the General Conference	8
014	Election of members of the Headquarters Committee	8
015	Election of members of the Conciliation and Good Offices Commission responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes that may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education	9
016	Election of members of the Council of the International Bureau of Education (IBE)	9
017	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council for the Information for All Programme (IFAP).....	9
018	Election of members of the International Coordinating Council of the Programme on Man and the Biosphere (MAB).....	9
019	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP).....	10
020	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to its Countries of Origin or its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (ICPRCP)	10
021	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC).....	10
022	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Management of Social Transformations (MOST) Programme.....	11
023	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC)	11
024	Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS).....	12
025	Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS).....	12
026	Election of the members of the Executive Committee of the International Campaign for the Establishment of the Nubia Museum in Aswan and the National Museum of Egyptian Civilization (NMEC) in Cairo	12
027	Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM)	13
IV	Programme and Budget for 2026–2029	15
	General Policy and Direction	15
1	General Policy and Direction	15
	<i>Programmes</i>	15
2	Major Programme I – Education	15
3	International Bureau of Education (IBE).....	17
4	International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP)	18
5	UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL).....	19
6	UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE).....	19
7	UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA).....	20
8	UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC)	21
9	Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP).....	22
10	UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM).....	22
11	Learning Planet Institute (France).....	23
12	Simon Bolivar Musical Foundation (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela).....	23

13	Institute for Retraining and Professional Development of Directors and Specialists of Preschool Educational Organizations (Uzbekistan)	23
14	Enhancing dialogue with teachers around the world: proposal for an Interactive platform	24
15	Supporting the continuity of UNRWA's educational activities in the Occupied Palestinian Territory	24
16	SDG 4 – Education 2030: global/regional coordination, monitoring and support	25
17	Major Programme II – Natural Sciences	25
18	Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP)	26
19	Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC)	27
20	Biotechnology Centre for Training in Agamic Seed Production (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela)	28
21	International Centre for Integrated River Research and Management (Austria)	28
22	Australian Rivers Institute (Australia)	28
23	African Institute in Indigenous Knowledge Systems (South Africa)	29
24	International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development	29
25	International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS)	29
26	International Day of Caves and Karst	30
27	Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences	30
28	Commemoration of the International Day of Vesak at UNESCO	32
29	Fit for Life: Advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education, including through the promotion of cycling	32
30	International Taijiquan Day	33
31	International Day of Nomadic Heritage	33
32	Cyrus Cylinder: an early charter of human rights and cultural diversity	33
33	UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029)	34
34	Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology	35
35	Major Programme IV – Culture	35
36	Jerusalem and the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 32	36
37	Three Cultures of the Mediterranean Foundation (Spain)	37
38	Underwater Heritage Institute (Bulgaria)	37
39	International Day for Underwater Cultural Heritage	37
40	Examination of the recommendations concerning public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly-traded cultural object from its country of origin pursuant to paragraph 5 of 40 C/Resolution 42	38
41	International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development	38
42	Major Programme V – Communication and Information	39
43	International Media and Information Literacy Institute (Nigeria)	40
44	Report by the Director-General on implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes	40
	<i>UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)</i>	42
45	UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)	42
	<i>Programme-related services</i>	43
46	Priority Africa and External Relations Sector	43
47	Coordination and monitoring of action to implement gender equality	46
48	Strategic planning	46
49	Communication and public engagement	47
50	Field offices programme management and support services	48
V	Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme	49
51	Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme	49
VI	Support for Programme Execution and Administration	51
52	Corporate services	51
VII	General resolutions	53
53	Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories	53
54	Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week”	53
55	Celebration of anniversaries in 2026–2027	54
56	UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine	54
57	Recognition and observance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha at UNESCO	55
58	Revised timeline for reporting on programme implementation – strategic results report (SRR)	55
59	World Greek Language Day	56
60	Enhancing cooperation with and between National Commissions for UNESCO	56
61	World Turkic Language Family Day	57
62	Support to Yemen in safeguarding cultural heritage, education, higher education and media in the context of the ongoing conflict	57
63	Impact and consequences of the current situation in the Gaza Strip/Palestine in all aspects of UNESCO's mandate	58
64	Conclusions of the Youth Forum	59

VIII	Administrative and financial questions	61
	<i>Financial questions</i>	61
65	Financial report and audited consolidated financial statements relating to the accounts of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024, and report by the External Auditor	61
66	Member States' contributions	61
	<i>Staff issues</i>	64
67	Staff Regulations and Staff Rules	64
68	Staff salaries, allowances and benefits	66
69	United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF)	66
70	Report by the Director-General on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF)	66
71	Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027	67
	<i>Headquarters questions</i>	67
72	Report by the Director-General, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO complex	67
IX	Constitutional and legal questions	71
73	Preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997)	71
74	Summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960)	72
75	Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978)	72
76	Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021)	73
77	Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017)	73
78	Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021)	74
X	Methods of work of the Organization	75
79	Recognition of Kiswahili as an official language of the General Conference of UNESCO	75
80	Follow-up to 42 C/Resolution 35 and prospects for the UNESCO conventions in the field of culture	75
81	Revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee	75
82	Report by the Executive Board on its own activities and programme implementation: activities in 2024–2025, including its methods of work	75
83	Report by the Executive Board on its own activities and programme implementation: implementation of the current Programme and Budget (42 C/5) with results achieved in 2022–2025	76
XI	Budget 2026–2027	77
84	Appropriation resolution for 2026–2027	77
85	Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles	78
XII	44th session of the General Conference	81
86	Venue of the 44th session of the General Conference	81
XIII	Reports of the programme commissions, the APX Commission (Finance, administration and general questions, programme support and external relations), the joint meeting of commissions and the Legal Committee	83
A.	Report of the APX Commission (Financial, Administrative and General Questions, Programme Support and External Relations)	85
B.	Report of the ED Commission (Education)	95
C.	Report of the SC-IOC Commission (Natural Sciences and the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission)	99
D.	Report of the SHS Commission (Social and Human Sciences)	103
E.	Report of the CLT Commission (Culture)	107
F.	Report of the CI Commission (Communication and Information)	111
G.	Report of the joint meeting of commissions	113
H.	Reports of the Legal Committee	111
ANNEX I	List of officers elected at the 43rd session of the General Conference	117
ANNEX II	RECOMMENDATION ON THE ETHICS OF NEUROTECHNOLOGY	119

I Organization of the session

01 Credentials

In accordance with Rule 35, paragraph 3, of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, the Legal Committee acts as a credential committee.

On the report of the Legal Committee or on the report of the Chairperson specially authorized by the Committee, the General Conference recognized as valid the credentials of:

(a) The delegations of the following Member States:

Afghanistan	Denmark	Libya
Albania	Djibouti	Lithuania
Algeria	Dominican Republic	Luxembourg
Andorra	Ecuador	Madagascar
Angola	Egypt	Malawi
Antigua and Barbuda	El Salvador	Malaysia
Argentina	Equatorial Guinea	Maldives
Armenia	Eritrea	Mali
Australia	Estonia	Malta
Austria	Eswatini	Marshall Islands
Azerbaijan	Ethiopia	Mauritius
Bahamas	Fiji	Mauritania
Bahrain	Finland	Mexico
Bangladesh	France	Micronesia
Barbados	Gabon	(Federated States of)
Belarus	Gambia	Monaco
Belgium	Georgia	Mongolia
Benin	Germany	Montenegro
Bhutan	Ghana	Morocco
Bolivia (Plurinational State of)	Greece	Mozambique
Bosnia and Herzegovina	Grenada	Namibia
Botswana	Guatemala	Nauru
Brazil	Guinea	Nepal
Brunei Darussalam	Guinea-Bissau	Netherlands (Kingdom of the)
Bulgaria	Guyana	New Zealand
Burkina Faso	Haiti	Nigeria
Burundi	Honduras	North Macedonia
Cabo Verde	Hungary	Norway
Cambodia	Iceland	Oman
Cameroon	India	Pakistan
Canada	Indonesia	Palau
Chad	Iran (Islamic Republic of)	Panama
Chile	Iraq	Papua New Guinea
China	Ireland	Paraguay
Colombia	Italy	Peru
Comoros	Jamaica	Philippines
Congo	Japan	Poland
Cook Islands	Jordan	Portugal
Costa Rica	Kazakhstan	Qatar
Côte d'Ivoire	Kenya	Republic of Korea
Croatia	Kuwait	Republic of Moldova
Cuba	Kyrgyzstan	Romania
Cyprus	Lao People's Democratic	Russian Federation
Czechia	Republic	Rwanda
Democratic People's Republic of	Latvia	Saint Kitts and Nevis
Korea	Lebanon	Saint Lucia
Democratic Republic of the	Lesotho	Saint Vincent and the Grenadines
Congo	Liberia	Samoa

San Marino	State of Palestine	Uganda
Sao Tome and Principe	Sudan	Ukraine
Saudi Arabia	Suriname	United Arab Emirates
Senegal	Sweden	United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
Serbia	Switzerland	United Republic of Tanzania
Seychelles	Syrian Arab Republic	Uruguay
Sierra Leone	Tajikistan	Uzbekistan
Singapore	Thailand	Vanuatu
Slovakia	Timor-Leste	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)
Slovenia	Togo	Viet Nam
Solomon Islands	Tonga	Yemen
Somalia	Tunisia	Zambia
South Africa	Türkiye	Zimbabwe
Spain	Turkmenistan	
Sri Lanka	Tuvalu	

(b) The delegations of the following Associate Members:

Åland Islands
Sint Maarten

(c) The following observers:

Holy See
Israel

The following delegations did not present credentials:

(a) Member States:

Belize
Central African Republic
Dominica
Kiribati
Nicaragua
Niger
Niue
South Sudan
Trinidad and Tobago
United States of America

(b) Associate Members:

Anguilla
Aruba
British Virgin Islands
Cayman Islands
Curaçao
Faroe Islands
Macau (China)
Montserrat
New Caledonia
Tokelau

(c) Observer:

Liechtenstein

02 **Communications received from Member States invoking the provisions of Article IV.C, paragraph 8(c), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution**

The General Conference,

Recalling the constitutional obligation of Member States to pay their contributions fully and on time,

Also recalling Article IV.C, paragraph 8(b), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b) and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b) of the Constitution,

Having considered the communications received from Afghanistan, the Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, Comoros, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, the Islamic Republic of Iran, Lebanon, Libya, Sierra Leone, Somalia and Yemen invoking the terms of the Constitution on the grounds that failure to pay their statutory contributions is due to conditions beyond their control,

Taking into account the history of payment of contributions in preceding years and previous requests for voting rights in the case of each of these Member States, as well as the measures proposed by them to eliminate their arrears,

Noting that Lebanon has, subsequent to its request, paid the amount required under Article IV.C, paragraph 8(b), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution,

1. *Considers* that the failure of Afghanistan, the Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, Comoros, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, the Islamic Republic of Iran, Libya, Sierra Leone, Somalia and Yemen to pay contributions for an amount exceeding the total due for the current year and the immediately preceding calendar year and/or instalments on payment plans is due to conditions beyond their control, and *decides* that these Member States may take part in the voting at its 43rd session, be eligible as a Member of the Executive Board in the elections that will take place at its 43rd session and, if applicable, may take part in the voting at sessions of the Executive Board until the 44th session of the General Conference;
2. *Also considers* that the failure of Antigua and Barbuda, Central African Republic, Dominica, Kiribati, Lesotho, Mozambique, Sao Tome and Principe, South Sudan and the United States of America to pay contributions for an amount exceeding the total due for the current year and the immediately preceding calendar year and/or instalments on payment plans does not comply with the conditions laid down in Rule 80 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, and *also decides* that these Member States may not take part in the voting at its 43rd session, may not be eligible as a Member of the Executive Board in the elections that will take place at its 43rd session and, if applicable, may not take part in the voting at sessions of the Executive Board until the 44th session of the General Conference¹;
3. *Invites* the Director-General to report to the Executive Board at its 225th and 227th sessions and to the General Conference at its 44th session on the actual position concerning all payment plans agreed upon between UNESCO and Member States in arrears with their contributions.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

03 Adoption of the agenda

At its 1st plenary meeting, on 30 October 2025, the General Conference, having considered the revised provisional agenda drawn up by the Executive Board (43 C/1 Prov. Rev.), adopted that document (43 C/1). At its 6th plenary meeting, on 3 November 2025, the General Conference adopted the revised agenda (43 C/1 Rev.).

Organization of the session

- 1.1 Opening of the session by the President of the 42nd session of the General Conference
- 1.2 Report by the Director-General on communications received from Member States invoking the provisions of Article IV.C, paragraph 8(c), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution
- 1.3 Adoption of the agenda
- 1.4 Election of the President and Vice-Presidents of the General Conference and of the Chairpersons, Vice-Chairpersons and Rapporteurs of the commissions and committees
- 1.5 Organization of the work of the session
- 1.6 Admission to the 43rd session of the General Conference of observers from non-governmental organizations (other than those in official partnership with UNESCO), foundations and similar institutions maintaining official relations with UNESCO, as well as from other international organizations, and recommendation of the Executive Board thereon

Reports on the activities of the Organization, and evaluation of the Programme

- 2.1 Report of the Director-General on the activities of the Organization in 2020–2023, presented by the Chair of the Executive Board
- 2.2 Report by the Executive Board on its own activities and on programme implementation

Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
- 3.2 Adoption of the Appropriation Resolution for 2026–2027
- 3.3 Adoption of the provisional budget ceiling
- 3.4 Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles

General policy and programme questions

- 4.1 Proposals by Member States concerning the celebration of anniversaries with which UNESCO could be associated in 2026–2027
- 4.2 Jerusalem and the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 32
- 4.3 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories
- 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres
- 4.5 Report by the Director-General on implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes
- 4.6 UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine
- 4.7 Renaming "International Arts Education Week" as "UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week"
- 4.8 Commemoration of the International Day of Vesak at UNESCO
- 4.9 Recognition and Observance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha at UNESCO
- 4.10 International Day for Underwater Cultural Heritage

¹ Following the adoption of this resolution, Antigua and Barbuda and Mozambique paid the amounts required under Article IV.C, paragraph 8(b), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b) of the Constitution.

- 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
- 4.12 Revised timeline for reporting on programme implementation – strategic results report (SRR)
- 4.13 Examination of the recommendations concerning public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly traded cultural object from its country of origin pursuant to paragraph 5 of 40 C/Resolution 42
- 4.14 Fit for Life: Advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education, including through the promotion of cycling
- 4.15 International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development
- 4.16 World Greek Language Day
- 4.17 International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS)
- 4.18 Enhancing dialogue with teachers around the world: proposal for an Interactive Platform
- 4.19 International Taijiquan Day
- 4.20 International Day of Nomadic Heritage
- 4.21 Cyrus Cylinder: an Early Charter of Human Rights and Cultural Diversity
- 4.22 Enhancing cooperation with and between National Commissions for UNESCO
- 4.23 International Day of Caves and Karst
- 4.24 International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development
- 4.25 World Turkic Language Family Day
- 4.26 Support to Yemen in safeguarding cultural heritage, education, higher education and media in the context of the ongoing conflict
- 4.27 Impact and consequences of the current situation in the Gaza Strip/Palestine in all aspects of UNESCO's mandate
- 4.28 Supporting the continuity of UNRWA's educational activities in the occupied Palestinian territory
- 4.29 UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029)
- 4.30 SDG 4 – Education 2030: Global/regional coordination, monitoring and support

Methods of work of the Organization

- 5.1 Follow-up to 42 C/Resolution 35 and prospects for the UNESCO conventions in the field of culture
- 5.2 Revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC)
- 5.3 Recognition of Kiswahili as an official language of the General Conference

Conventions, recommendations and other international instruments

A. Preparation and adoption of new instruments

- 6.1 Draft recommendation on the ethics of neurotechnology
- 6.2 Preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997)

B. Monitoring existing instruments

- 7.1 Summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960)
- 7.2 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation

concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978)

- 7.3 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017)
- 7.4 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021)
- 7.5 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021)

Administrative and financial questions

Financial questions

- 8.1 Financial report and audited consolidated financial statements relating to the accounts of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024, and report by the External Auditor
- 8.2 Member States' contributions

Staff issues

- 9.1 Staff Regulations and Staff Rules
- 9.2 Staff salaries, allowances and benefits
- 9.3 United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF)
- 9.4 Report by the Director-General on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF)
- 9.5 Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027

Headquarters questions

- 10.1 Report by the Director-General, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO complex

Director-General

- 11.1 Appointment of the Director-General

Elections

- 12.1 Election of Members of the Executive Board
- 12.2 Election of the members of the Legal Committee for the 44th session of the General Conference
- 12.3 Election of members of the Headquarters Committee
- 12.4 Election of members of the Conciliation and Good Offices Commission responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes that may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education
- 12.5 Election of members of the Council of the International Bureau of Education (IBE)
- 12.6 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council for the Information for All Programme (IFAP)
- 12.7 Election of members of the International Coordinating Council of the Programme on Man and the Biosphere (MAB)
- 12.8 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP)
- 12.9 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to its Countries of Origin or its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (ICPRCP)

- 12.10 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC)
- 12.11 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Management of Social Transformations (MOST) Programme
- 12.12 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC)
- 12.13 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS)
- 12.14 Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)

- 12.15 Election of the members of the Executive Committee of the International Campaign for the Establishment of the Nubia Museum in Aswan and the National Museum of Egyptian Civilization (NMEC) in Cairo
- 12.16 Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM)

44th session of the General Conference

- 13.1 Venue of the 44th session of the General Conference

04 Composition of the Bureau

On the report of the Nominations Committee, which had before it the proposals made by the Executive Board, and in accordance with Rule 29 of its Rules of Procedure, the General Conference at its 1st plenary meeting, on 30 October 2025, elected its Bureau¹ as follows:

President of the General Conference: Mr Khondker Mohammad Talha (Bangladesh)

Vice-Presidents of the General Conference: the heads of the delegations of the following Member States:

Armenia	France	Norway
Australia	Germany	Poland
Austria	Honduras	Rwanda
Azerbaijan	Iraq	Saint Lucia
Bahrain	Kazakhstan	Seychelles
Brazil	Latvia	South Africa
Canada	Maldives	State of Palestine
Chile	Morocco	Thailand
China	Mozambique	Ukraine
Congo	Netherlands (Kingdom of the)	United Arab Emirates
Costa Rica	Nigeria	Viet Nam
El Salvador		Yemen

Chairperson of the APX Commission:

Chairperson of the ED Commission:

Chairperson of the SC-IOC Commission:

Chairperson of the SHS Commission:

Chairperson of the CLT Commission:

Chairperson of the CI Commission:

Chairperson of the Legal Committee:

Chairperson of the Nominations Committee:

Chairperson of the Headquarters Committee:

Ms Jolanta Balčiūnienė (Lithuania)

Ms Paula Alves de Souza (Brazil)

Mr Samir Addahre (Morocco)

Mr Philemon Mjwara (South Africa)

Mr Georgios Koumoutsakos (Greece)

Ms Mumtaz Zahra Baloch (Pakistan)

Mr Pierre Michel Eisemann (France)

Ms Jiřina Valentová (Czechia)

Ms Rosa Batoréu (Portugal)

05 Organization of the work of the session

At its 3rd plenary meeting, on 31 October 2025, on the recommendation of the Bureau, the General Conference approved the plan for the organization of the work of the session submitted by the Executive Board (43 C/2). At its 6th plenary meeting, on 3 November 2025, the General Conference adopted the revised plan (43 C/2 Rev.).

06 Admission to the 43rd session of observers from non-governmental organizations

The General Conference,

Having examined the recommendation of the Executive Board (222 EX/Decision 28.IV),

Admits as observers at its 43rd session the organizations listed in the Annex to document 43 C/12.

Resolution adopted at the 1st plenary meeting, on 30 October 2025.

¹ A complete list of the elected officers of the General Conference is shown in Annex I to this volume.

II Tributes

07 Tribute to Ms Audrey Azoulay, Director-General of UNESCO (2017–2025)

The General Conference,

Recalling that Ms Audrey Azoulay was appointed to the office of Director-General by the General Conference at its 39th session on 10 November 2017, and that her appointment was renewed by the General Conference at its 41st session on 9 November 2021 for a second term, which will expire on 14 November 2025,

Noting in particular her engagement in focusing on UNESCO's mandate and universal vocation,

Noting efforts to focus UNESCO on the strategic reforms she has undertaken to strengthen cross-sectoral approaches, enabling it to increase its resources, particularly with respect to voluntary contributions, by 178%, thanks to the Member States, multilateral institutions and private partners,

Noting with satisfaction the work of UNESCO in crisis areas, illustrated by the implementation of the UNESCO initiative: revive the spirit of Mosul, the mobilization of youth in Yemen for the rehabilitation of historic buildings, and assistance programmes for Ukraine, Sudan, Gaza, Lebanon and Haiti,

Recognizing her leadership in the implementation of UNESCO's Global Priority Africa, notably through the six-fold increase in dedicated voluntary contributions, the strengthening of the representation of African heritage, the promotion of the restitution of cultural property and the fight against its illicit trafficking – including the launch of a virtual museum of stolen cultural objects – support for creative industries and the integration of the continent into the global governance of artificial intelligence (AI),

Appreciating the quality of UNESCO's response to the COVID-19 pandemic, in particular with the creation of the Global Education Coalition, which is still at work, and the launch of the ResiliArt initiative, which has provided support for artists and culture professionals,

Underlining her commitment to inclusive, quality education, illustrated by the significant increase in UNESCO's budget for education, the adoption of international instruments, including the UNESCO Recommendation on Education for Peace, Human Rights and Sustainable Development (2023),

Commending her efforts to revitalize UNESCO's cultural mandate, notably through the expansion and diversification of the world heritage and intangible cultural heritage lists, the relaunch of the UNESCO World Conference on Cultural Policies and Sustainable Development (MONDIACULT) and the recognition of culture as a global public good,

Acknowledging her commitment to science, illustrated by the coordination of the United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development, the mapping of 27% of the seabed, the creation of the Blue School Global Network and the ocean education programme,

Also noting her efforts to make the fight against climate disruption a cross-cutting priority, through major scientific programmes, innovative partnerships and global advocacy of environmental education and biodiversity protection,

Also underlining the progress made by UNESCO in recognizing Indigenous Peoples, taking their voices and cultural rights into account, and valuing their knowledge in the management of sites listed by UNESCO,

Also acknowledging her efforts in positioning UNESCO at the centre of standard setting for emerging technologies, through the adoption of the first global ethical framework on artificial intelligence (AI), and the launch of initiatives on neurotechnology and the governance of digital platforms,

Also appreciating her action in favour of gender equality and assistance provided to countries in revising their education policies to promote gender equality,

Also recognizing her engagement in promoting UNESCO's role within the United Nations system and in the wider multilateral landscape, in particular positioning UNESCO as a privileged partner of the G20,

Also appreciating her engagement with civil society, young people and the private sector, as well as strengthening UNESCO's visibility through innovative communication and partnerships,

Pays solemn tribute to Ms Audrey Azoulay at its plenary meeting on 5 November 2025, and *conveys* to her its gratitude.

Resolution adopted at the 10th plenary meeting, on 5 November 2025.

08 Tribute to the President of the General Conference

The General Conference,

Mindful that H.E. Ms Simona-Mirela Miculescu concluded her term of office as President of the General Conference, which she had held since 7 November 2023, at the opening of the 43rd session of the General Conference,

Acknowledging with gratitude her unwavering commitment to promoting UNESCO across all domains of its mandate, as a foundation for building peace and solidarity,

Recognizing with appreciation her attentive approach and dedication to nurturing dialogue among Member States, and *welcoming* her sustained efforts to strengthen the spirit of cooperation between UNESCO's governing bodies,

Highlighting her significant contribution to the safeguarding of UNESCO's Archives by raising Member States' attention and identifying the necessary partnerships for their digitization,

Emphasizing her leadership in the celebration of the centenary of the International Institute of Intellectual Cooperation, the precursor of UNESCO, and in the promotion of UNESCO's key role in strengthening intellectual cooperation among Member States,

Also highlighting her notable contribution to the promotion of effective multilateralism through continued cooperation with relevant United Nations entities so as to deepen political and diplomatic commitment to the defense of freedom of expression and universal access to information,

Acknowledging with appreciation her efforts in promoting gender equality, with special attention to the role of women in diplomacy,

Recalling the diplomatic acumen, impartiality and wisdom with which she fulfilled her high responsibilities,

Expresses its profound appreciation and esteem to H. E. Ms Simona-Mirela Miculescu for the remarkable services she rendered to UNESCO throughout her tenure.

Resolution adopted at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

09 Tribute to the Chairperson of the Executive Board

The General Conference,

Mindful that H. E. Ms Vera El Khoury Lacoeuilhe concludes her term of office as Chairperson of the Executive Board, in November 2025,

Recalling her long-standing association with UNESCO and her extensive experience within the Organization, both as a member of its governing bodies and through her active participation in intergovernmental negotiations over more than two decades,

Recognizing the value of the institutional memory and historical perspective she brought to her functions, which have contributed to ensuring continuity, accountability and respect for the prerogatives of the Executive Board,

Acknowledging her deep and enduring ties to the Organization to which she has devoted her professional life, and the passion with which she has consistently defended its mandate, its integrity and the well-being of its staff,

Noting that under her leadership five regular sessions and one extraordinary session of the Executive Board were conducted efficiently and in full conformity with its constitutional and procedural responsibilities,

Also acknowledging her constant attention to matters of governance and oversight, and her efforts to strengthen the Executive Board's monitoring role with regard to programme implementation and financial management,

Highlighting her insistence on transparency, accountability and the proper balance between the responsibilities of the governing bodies and those of the administration,

Welcoming the introduction of informal "Exchange Sessions", initiated under her chairship, as a means of enhancing dialogue and reflection among Member States beyond the constraints of formal sessions and agendas, thereby reinforcing the Board's deliberative and strategic functions,

Expresses its profound appreciation to H. E. Ms Vera El Khoury Lacoeuilhe for her dedicated service to the Executive Board and for her lasting contribution to the strengthening of UNESCO's governance and institutional integrity.

Resolution adopted at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

010 Vote of thanks to the people and Government of Uzbekistan

The General Conference,

Meeting at its 43rd session in Samarkand, Uzbekistan, from 30 October to 13 November 2025, at the invitation of the Government of the Republic of Uzbekistan,

Expressing its profound gratitude to the people and Government of Uzbekistan for their exceptionally warm welcome and generous hospitality, and for all the arrangements made to ensure that the deliberations of this Conference could take place in the best possible conditions, most conducive to their successful conclusion,

1. *Expresses* its great satisfaction at having been able to hold its 43rd session in the magnificent city of Samarkand;
2. *Commends* the efforts of the Government of Uzbekistan to ensure the full participation of all Member States, Associate Members and observers;
3. *Expresses its profound gratitude and appreciation* to the people and authorities of Uzbekistan, and most particularly to H. E. Mr Shavkat Mirziyoyev, President of the Republic of Uzbekistan, for their invaluable support, gracious presence and attention to the needs of the General Conference;

4. *Thanks* all Uzbek services and staff for their remarkable dedication and efficiency in ensuring the smooth and harmonious conduct of this 43rd session;
- Emphasizing*, lastly, that the cultural treasures of Uzbekistan, a country of ancient civilization and rich heritage, have made a significant contribution to promoting a spirit of mutual understanding and concord among delegations,
5. *Addresses* to the people and Government of Uzbekistan a message of friendship, shared trust and confidence in the future of international cooperation with UNESCO.

Resolution adopted at the 17th plenary meeting, on 13 November 2025.

III Elections

011 Appointment of the Director-General

I

The General Conference,

Having considered the Executive Board's proposal contained in document 43 C/NOM/3 concerning the appointment of the Director-General,

Acting in accordance with Article VI.2 of the Constitution,

Appoints Mr Khaled Ahmed El-Enany Ali Ezz Director-General of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization for a period of four years from 15 November 2025.

II

The General Conference

Approves the draft contract submitted to it by the Executive Board in document 43 C/50, establishing the terms of appointment, salary and allowances of the Director-General, as well as the statute relating to the Director-General annexed hereto.

ANNEX

STATUTE RELATING TO THE DIRECTOR-GENERAL

Article 1

The Director-General is the Chief Administrative Officer of the Organization. In the discharge of his duties he shall observe the provisions of the Constitution and any rules made by the General Conference and by the Executive Board, and shall give effect to the decisions of these two organs. In the context of Article VI of the Constitution, the Director-General is accountable to the General Conference and the Executive Board.

Article 2

If the Director-General dies or resigns, the Executive Board shall appoint an Acting Director-General to serve until the following session of the General Conference.

Article 3

In the event of the Director-General being incapacitated, the Executive Board may grant him leave of absence on such conditions and for such period as the Board may decide pending the following session of the General Conference; in such case, the duties of the Director-General shall be exercised by an Acting Director-General appointed by the Executive Board.

If, in the opinion of the General Conference, the incapacity of the Director-General renders it impossible for him to continue to exercise his functions, the Conference will request the Executive Board to make a new nomination and will proceed to a new election. In such circumstances the Conference may grant to the former Director-General such indemnity as it deems proper.

Article 4

The Executive Board by a vote of two thirds of its members may suspend the Director-General on grounds of misconduct, or of violation of the Constitution or Rules of the General Conference or of the Executive Board; in such case it may appoint an Acting Director-General until the following session of the General Conference. If the General Conference endorses the decision of the Executive Board, the contract of the Director-General shall be terminated forthwith, and the Executive Board shall be requested to make a new nomination for appointment to the position of Director-General.

Resolution adopted at the 11th plenary meeting, on 6 November 2025.

012 Election of Members of the Executive Board

At the 12th plenary meeting, held on 7 November 2025, the President of the General Conference announced the results of the election of Members of the Executive Board, held on that same day on the basis of the lists of candidates submitted by the Nominations Committee.

The following Member States were thus elected:

Bolivia (Plurinational State of)	Jamaica	Romania
Cameroon	Japan	Saint Vincent and the Grenadines
China	Jordan	Thailand
Egypt	Kyrgyzstan	Türkiye
Equatorial Guinea	Luxembourg	Uganda
Ethiopia	Malaysia	Ukraine
Guyana	Morocco	Uruguay
Haiti	Norway	Zambia
India	Republic of Moldova	Zimbabwe

013 Election of the members of the Legal Committee for the 44th session of the General Conference

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with its Rules of Procedure, the following Member States to be members of the Legal Committee from the beginning of the 44th session until the beginning of the 45th session of the General Conference

Angola	Japan
Bulgaria	Lebanon
Burkina Faso	Paraguay
Comoros	Philippines
Cook Islands	Slovakia
France	Switzerland
Honduras	Tunisia
Iran (Islamic Republic of)	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Note: Group I presented only two candidates for five vacant seats, Group II presented only two candidates for three vacant seats, Group III presented only three candidates for five vacant seats, and Group V(b) presented only two candidates for four vacant seats. As a result, only 16 members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

014 Election of members of the Headquarters Committee

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with its Rules of Procedure, the following Member States to be members of the Headquarters Committee until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Angola	Philippines
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	Portugal
Equatorial Guinea	Sri Lanka
Japan	Syrian Arab Republic
Paraguay	

Note: Group I presented only one candidate for two vacant seats, Group V(a) presented only two candidates for four vacant seats, and Group V(b) presented only one candidate for two vacant seats. As a result, only nine members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session. The remaining four vacant seats will be open for election at the 44th session of the General Conference. The other members of the Headquarters Committee, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Belgium	Guinea
Brazil	Republic of Moldova
Chile	Saint Lucia
China	State of Palestine
Croatia	Togo
France	

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

015 Election of members of the Conciliation and Good Offices Commission responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes that may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education

The General Conference,

Recalling Article 3 of the Protocol instituting a Conciliation and Good Offices Commission responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes that may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education,

Elects Mr Abdelilah Fountir Benbrahim (Morocco) as a member of the Conciliation and Good Offices Commission until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference.

Note: In accordance with the interpretation of Article 7 of the Protocol instituting a Conciliation and Good Offices Commission (1962) agreed by the Meeting of States Parties to the Protocol (Paris, 7 and 8 October 2003), the four members of the Commission whose term of office expires at the end of the 43rd session of the General Conference shall remain in office until the end of the 44th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

016 Election of members of the Council of the International Bureau of Education (IBE)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with Article III of the Statutes of the International Bureau of Education (IBE), the following experts to be members of the Council of the IBE until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Ms Loredana Perla (Italy) (Group I)
Mr David Njeng'ere (Kenya) (Group V(a))

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

017 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council for the Information for All Programme (IFAP)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with Article 2 of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Council for the Information for All Programme (IFAP), the following Member States to be members of the Council until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Democratic People's Republic of Korea	Mali
Latvia	Saudi Arabia
Libya	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Note: Group I presented no candidate for five vacant seats, and Group V(a) presented only one candidate for three vacant seats. As a result, only six members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session. The other members of the Intergovernmental Council, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office will expire at the end of the 44th session are:

Algeria	Mongolia
Brazil	Namibia
Chile	Pakistan
China	Slovakia
Congo	Thailand
Dominican Republic	Ukraine
Madagascar	

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

018 Election of members of the International Coordinating Council of the Programme on Man and the Biosphere (MAB)

The General Conference,

Recalling Article II of the Statutes of the International Coordinating Council of the Programme on Man and the Biosphere (MAB),

Elects the following Member States to be members of the International Coordinating Council until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Algeria	Lithuania
Brazil	Oman
Canada	Portugal
China	Spain
France	Sudan
Guinea	Togo
Honduras	United Republic of Tanzania
Japan	

Note: The other members of the International Coordinating Council, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session, are:

Austria
Azerbaijan
Bangladesh
Bulgaria
Colombia
Congo

Costa Rica
Cook Islands
Democratic Republic of the Congo
Denmark
Italy
Jamaica

Mali
Morocco
Panama
Pakistan
Republic of Korea
Romania
Zambia

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

019 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP)

The General Conference,

Recalling Article II of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP),

Elects the following Member States to be members of the Intergovernmental Council until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Burkina Faso
Egypt
France
India
Italy
Japan
Kazakhstan
Mali

Mauritania
Netherlands (Kingdom of the)
Paraguay
Republic of Korea
Slovenia
Uruguay
Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Note: The other members of the Intergovernmental Council, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Algeria
Austria
Brazil
China
Dominican Republic
Germany
Ghana

Kenya
Malaysia
Morocco
Nigeria
Pakistan
Peru
Poland

Romania
Russian Federation
Sudan
South Africa
Spain
Tunisia
United States of America

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

020 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to its Countries of Origin or its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (ICPRCP)

The General Conference,

Recalling 20 C/Resolution 4/7.6/5, in which it approved the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to its Countries of Origin or its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (ICPRCP),

Elects, in accordance with Article 2, paragraphs 2 and 4, of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Committee, the following Member States to be members of the Committee until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Azerbaijan
Brazil
Burkina Faso
China
Colombia
Côte d'Ivoire

Guatemala
Iran (Islamic Republic of)
Iraq
Poland
Republic of Korea

Note: The other members of the Intergovernmental Committee, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Chile
Czechia
Egypt
Ghana
Greece
India

Italy
Japan
Libya
United Kingdom of Great Britain
and Northern Ireland
Zambia

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

021 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with Article 2 of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC), the following Member States to be members of the Intergovernmental Council until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Cuba	Namibia
Czechia	Pakistan
Denmark	Paraguay
Italy	Philippines
Haiti	Poland
Japan	Republic of Korea
Kenya	Sri Lanka
Latvia	State of Palestine
Lebanon	Uruguay

Note: Group V(a) presented only two candidates for three vacant seats. As a result, only 18 members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session. The remaining vacant seat will be open for election at the 44th session of the General Conference. The other members of the Intergovernmental Council, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Austria	Luxembourg
Brazil	Madagascar
Burkina Faso	Netherlands (Kingdom of the)
Chile	Norway
Congo	United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Ukraine
Egypt	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)
Estonia	Thailand
Ghana	Yemen
Guinea	
Indonesia	

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

022 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Council of the Management of Social Transformations (MOST) Programme

The General Conference,

Recalling paragraphs 1 and 2 of Article II of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Council for the Management of Social Transformations (MOST) Programme,

Elects the following Member States to be members of the Intergovernmental Council until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Austria	Philippines
Côte d'Ivoire	Qatar
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	South Africa
Guinea	Uruguay
Indonesia	

Note: Group I presented only one candidate for four vacant seats, Group IV presented only three candidates for four vacant seats, and Group V(b) presented only one candidate for two vacant seats. As a result, only nine members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session. The remaining five vacant seats will be open for election at the 44th session of the General Conference. The other members of the Intergovernmental Council, which were elected at the 42nd session and whose term of office will expire at the end of the 44th session are:

Bulgaria	Mongolia
Brazil	Namibia
Chile	Nigeria
Czechia	Oman
Ghana	Paraguay
Iran (Islamic Republic of)	Peru
Kenya	Poland
Libya	Romania
Luxembourg	Spain
Mali	Thailand
	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

023 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with Article 11 of the Statutes of the International Bioethics Committee (IBC), the following Member States to be members of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC) until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

France	Paraguay
Iran (Islamic Republic of)	Senegal
Kenya	Singapore
Latvia	Slovenia
Mexico	South Africa
Mozambique	Togo
Nigeria	

Note: Group I presented only one candidate for four vacant seats, and Group III presented only two candidates for four vacant seats. As a result, only 13 members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session. The remaining three vacant seats will be open for election at the 44th session of the General Conference. The other members of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Bangladesh	Luxembourg
Belgium	Morocco
Bulgaria	Oman
Chile	Republic of Korea
China	Russian Federation
Congo	Sri Lanka
Côte d'Ivoire	Tunisia
Japan	United States of America
Lebanon	Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

024 Election of members of the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS)

The General Conference,

Recalling Article 3, paragraph 1, of the Statutes of the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS),

Elects the following Member States to be members of the Intergovernmental Committee until the end of the 45th session of the General Conference:

Chile	Libya
Cook Islands	Namibia
Costa Rica	Slovenia
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	Spain
Egypt	Syrian Arab Republic
Kenya	

Note: The other members of the Intergovernmental Committee, which were elected at the 42nd session of the General Conference and whose term of office expires at the end of the 44th session are:

Albania	Turkmenistan
Côte d'Ivoire	Ukraine
Finland	United Kingdom of Great Britain
Jamaica	and Northern Ireland

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

025 Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with paragraph 1(a) of Article IV of the Statutes of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS), the following experts to be members of the Governing Board :

Mr Pankaj K P Shreyaskar (India) (Group IV) (elected until 31 December 2029)
 Ms Shaikha Abdulla Mufeez (Bahrain) (Group V(b)) (elected until 31 December 2029)
 Ms Jana Straková (Czechia) (Group II) (elected until 31 December 2027)
 Mr Gustavo Junger Da Silva (Brazil) (Group III) (elected until 31 December 2027)
 Mr Solly Molayi (South Africa) (Group V(a)) (elected until 31 December 2027)

Note: Group I presented no candidates for one vacant seat. As a result, only five members were proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

026 Election of the members of the Executive Committee of the International Campaign for the Establishment of the Nubia Museum in Aswan and the National Museum of Egyptian Civilization (NMEC) in Cairo

The General Conference,

Recalling 21 C/Resolution 4.11 in which it approved the setting up of the Executive Committee of the International Campaign for the Establishment of the Nubia Museum in Aswan and the National Museum of Egyptian Civilization (NMEC) in Cairo,

Elects the following Member State to be a member of the Executive Committee until the end of the 44th session of the General Conference:

Egypt

Note: Group I presented no candidates for five vacant seats, Group II presented no candidates for two vacant seats, Group III presented no candidates for two vacant seats, Group IV presented no candidates for two vacant seats, Group V(a) presented no candidates for two vacant seats, and Group V(b) presented only one candidate for two vacant seats. As a result, only one member was proposed for election by the General Conference at its 43rd session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

027

Election of members of the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM)

The General Conference

Elects, in accordance with Article 3 of the Statutes of the UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM), the following experts to be members of the Governing Board :

Ms Annette Scheunpflug (Germany)
 Mr Sergey Garbuk (Russian Federation)*
 Ms Lorena Medina (Chile)*
 Mr Waqas Ahmed (Pakistan)
 Ms Faith Njoki Karanja (Kenya)*
 Mr Adam Almulla (Kuwait)

Note: The experts whose names are marked with an asterisk (*) are those drawn by lots at the seventh meeting of the Nominations Committee on 10 November 2025, in accordance with the Transitional provisions in Article 13 of the Statutes, and who will serve an initial term of two years until the 44th session of the General Conference. The other experts shall serve an initial term of four years until the 45th session of the General Conference.

Resolution adopted on the report of the Nominations Committee at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025

IV Programme and Budget for 2026–2029

General Policy and Direction

1 General Policy and Direction

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the following plan of action for General Policy and Direction in order to:
 - (i) organize in the most cost-effective manner the 44th and 45th sessions of the General Conference (November 2027 and 2029) and eight to ten ordinary sessions of the Executive Board;
 - (ii) provide for the functioning of the Directorate;
 - (iii) contribute to the running costs of the joint machinery of the United Nations system;
- (b) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in statutory reports, on the execution of the programme and budget adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Directorate and Office of the Director-General

Output 8.1.CAB Leadership and strategic positioning of the Organization ensured to effectively address the Member States' evolving needs and identify emerging opportunities with a focus on achieving the SDGs

Internal oversight

Output 8.2.IOS Independent, effective and timely evaluations, audits and investigations conducted to strengthen governance, enhance performance, foster learning and ensure accountability, transparency and efficiency across UNESCO's operations

Enabling Outcome 9: A UNESCO where accountable, efficient, and effective management and governance help deliver results

Governing bodies

Output 9.1.GBS The work of the Governing Bodies Secretariat streamlined to support efficient, effective and transparent governance

International standards and legal affairs

Output 9.2.LA Management and programme implementation conducted in compliance with the Organization's rules, regulations and procedures, ensuring the legal safety of operations

Ethics

Output 9.3.ETH Organizational culture and working environment strengthened to ensure that UNESCO's policies and procedures consistently uphold and advance the highest ethical standards.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

Programmes

2 Major Programme I – Education

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for Major Programme I, contributing to the Organization's four strategic objectives and its seven outcomes within the framework of the Medium-Term Strategy (41 C/4);
- (b) to contribute to the Organization's global priorities to promote gender equality and support Africa, and to accord priority to young people and small island developing States (SIDS), including through North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation, and with particular attention to least developed countries (LDCs), countries in emergency situations, and the most vulnerable, recognizing the

transformative power of inclusive, quality education throughout life in the transition to more sustainable and equitable societies;

- (c) to fulfil UNESCO's mandate, as entrusted to it by the international community, to lead the coordination of the Education 2030 agenda and monitor progress towards Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4, reaffirming the central role of education in advancing all SDGs; and to support countries in the last decisive years to realize the SDG 4-Education 2030 agenda to "ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all", through efforts to:
 - (i) promote the right to education for all learners and support countries to strengthen their education systems with a lifelong learning approach from early childhood to higher education, including through education for sustainable development, culture and arts education, inclusive sport and physical education, media and information literacy, education for peace, technical and vocational education and training (TVET), science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) education, and literacy and adult education;
 - (ii) support education reforms that prioritize evidence-based policies, by ensuring adequate and sustainable financing, in order to strengthen implementation and monitoring and evaluation;
 - (iii) address the global shortage of qualified teachers and enhance their social and professional status, by valorizing and dignifying the teaching profession;
 - (iv) strengthen inclusive, gender-equitable, health-promoting learning environments free from all forms of violence and discrimination;
 - (v) focus particularly on the needs of teachers and learners in crisis-affected contexts;
 - (vi) promote education for peace, as a follow-up to the UNESCO Recommendation on Education for Peace, Human Rights and Sustainable Development (2023);
 - (vii) harness the digital transformation, including artificial intelligence (AI), to advance education, overcome inequalities, promote human agency and safeguard fundamental values;
 - (viii) steer global progress on education by fostering international cooperation and advancing monitoring, research and foresight, with a view to achieving SDG 4 and shaping the post-2030 education agenda;
 - (ix) strengthen the UNESCO Associated Schools Network (ASPnet) as a key platform for promoting global citizenship education, intercultural dialogue and education for sustainable development, ensuring its effective contribution to the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs);
- (d) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests the Director-General:*

- (a) to implement the various activities authorized by this resolution, including through intersectoral cooperation, to achieve the outcomes and the outputs pertaining to Major Programme I;
- (b) to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 1: A world where inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning opportunities are ensured, while strengthening international cooperation for the achievement of SDG 4

Output 1.1.ED Education systems governance, policy, management and curriculum frameworks strengthened to ensure inclusive and quality education for all

Output 1.2.ED Teacher policy and the status of the profession enhanced, and Member States supported to address teacher shortages

Output 1.3.ED TVET, youth literacy, and adult education supported to enhance skills development and flexible and inclusive learning pathways

Output 1.4.ED Right to education and inclusion promoted from early childhood throughout life, with emphasis on vulnerable groups, including learners with disabilities

Intersectoral Output 1.5 Access to and participation of learners in inclusive and gender-responsive STEM education and science literacy expanded, with equal and equitable access for all to resources and career pathways regardless of gender, so as to foster innovation

Output 1.6.ED Higher education systems and academic research strengthened, including through UNITWIN/UNESCO Chairs and instruments for student mobility

Output 1.7.ED Gender equality enhanced in and through education to empower all learners, particularly those marginalized, addressing the root causes of inequalities

Output 1.8.ED Learning and teaching supported in crisis-affected contexts, and education systems recovery and reconstruction supported

Output 1.9.ED Gender transformative and inclusive learning environments fostered, and learners' knowledge and skills in health and sexuality education improved to enhance their health and well-being

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight

Outcome 2: A world where biodiversity, geodiversity, water and the ocean are valued and sustainably managed, in order to face the challenges posed by climate change and contribute to climate action

Intersectoral Output 2.6 Education for sustainable development expanded, including through the Greening Education Partnership, to make learners and communities climate-ready and agents of change

Outcome 4: A world where culture in all its forms is protected and promoted

Intersectoral Output 4.7 Member States' capacities and awareness raised to protect, safeguard and promote Indigenous knowledge, cultures and languages through inclusive policies and targeted action

Intersectoral Output 4.8 Member States supported in implementing and monitoring the UNESCO Framework for Culture and Arts Education

Outcome 6: A world of peace and inclusion, free from discrimination, disinformation and hate speech

Output 6.1.ED The UNESCO Recommendation on Education for Peace, Human Rights and Sustainable Development (2023) operationalized by Member States to address hate speech, discrimination and violence, and to foster sustainable peace, including through global citizenship education

Intersectoral Output 6.3 Member States, education institutions, youth organizations and media supported in adopting inclusive media and information literacy policies and digital initiatives to build resilience to disinformation, misinformation and hate speech in particular targeting women and girls

Outcome 7: A world where new technologies are developed and applied ethically for sustainable development and in respect of human rights and dignity

Intersectoral Output 7.4 Knowledge and capacities of Member States and stakeholders enhanced for inclusive digital transformation, advancing sustainable AI and data governance, equitable access to quality education and diversity of contents.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

3

International Bureau of Education (IBE)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the International Bureau of Education for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/1), and *congratulating* the Institute on its 100th anniversary celebrated in 2025,

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of the IBE in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of the IBE as a global centre of excellence for curriculum and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of the IBE to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the area of curriculum, with a renewed mandate in line with 41 C/Resolution 12:
 - (a) to consolidate and synergize the work of UNESCO in curriculum, fostering a forward-looking vision to contribute to equitable and inclusive education and sustainable development for all in the wake of global challenges and societal changes;
 - (b) to build a knowledge base on curriculum, with the most advanced and cutting-edge research and comparative studies, making available methodological tools, curriculum prototypes and good practices;
 - (c) to develop standard-setting norms and instruments in curriculum that can guide and support Member States in the definition of their public policies and strategies;
 - (d) to respond to the needs of Member States, particularly developing countries, in developing and reforming curriculum through capacity development and technical assistance, and to foster policy dialogue and the sharing of experiences in curriculum development and good practices among Member States;
 - (e) to serve as a platform for networking and intersectoral dialogue on curriculum for the twenty-first century among relevant stakeholders, including relevant international organizations and academic institutions, with a particular focus on the transformative role of education for sustainable development, societal change and global challenges;
 - (f) to develop training programmes, in collaboration with universities and other relevant stakeholders from different regions of the world;
 - (g) to preserve the historical archives and documentation of the IBE, making them accessible to Member States and the public;
2. *Requests* the IBE Council, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026 and 2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of the IBE correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I as listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable the IBE to accomplish its mission;
3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for the IBE for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to the activities of the IBE and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions

to enable the IBE to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;

6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of the IBE to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:

Output 1.1.ED Education systems governance, policy, management and curriculum frameworks strengthened to ensure inclusive and quality education for all

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

4 International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/2),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of IIEP in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of IIEP as a global centre of excellence in educational planning and management, and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I, with a field presence through its regional offices in Dakar and Buenos Aires,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of IIEP to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the area of educational planning and management, with a mandate:
 - (a) to reinforce Member States' capacities for the planning, management and administration of education systems;
 - (b) to leverage the Institute's presence on three continents with its offices in Paris, Buenos Aires and Dakar to strengthen national, subregional and inter-regional training programmes in educational planning, administration, evaluation and monitoring in cooperation with the other education-related category 1 institutes of UNESCO, as well as the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS), and UNESCO field offices;
 - (c) to carry out research and development activities aimed at the upgrading of knowledge in educational planning and management, and at the production of methodologies and tools to support Member States in planning and managing their education systems;
 - (d) to serve as a hub that curates and widely disseminates knowledge, information and resources, and enables the exchange of experiences in educational planning and administration among Member States;
 - (e) to carry out technical assistance projects in its field of competence to practically support Member States while fostering sustainable national technical capacities and leadership;
2. *Requests* the Governing Board of IIEP, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026 and 2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of IIEP correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable IIEP to accomplish its mission;
3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for IIEP for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Governments of Argentina and France for their financial contribution and for providing the Institute's premises free of charge, and to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to IIEP's activities, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable IIEP to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of IIEP to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:

Output 1.1.ED Education systems governance, policy, management and curriculum frameworks strengthened to ensure inclusive and quality education for all

Output 1.8.ED Learning and teaching supported in crisis-affected contexts, and education systems recovery and reconstruction supported

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

5 UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/3),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of UIL in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of UIL as a global centre of excellence for lifelong learning, and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of the UIL to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the areas of lifelong learning, literacy and basic skills, and adult learning and education, with a mandate:
 - (a) to reinforce Member State's capacities for the design and implementation of lifelong-learning policies and strategies;
 - (b) to take the necessary measures to follow up on the Marrakech Framework for Action, adopted at the Seventh International Conference on Adult Education (CONFINTEA VII, 2022), and monitor implementation;
 - (c) to support and coordinate the Global Network of Learning Cities (GNLC), a platform that enables cities worldwide to exchange best practices, strategies and policies to promote lifelong learning for all;
 - (d) to coordinate the Global Alliance for Literacy (GAL), a platform for policy and knowledge exchanges among Member States and other stakeholders to improve and strengthen literacy as a foundation for lifelong learning;
2. *Requests* the Governing Board of UIL, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026 and 2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of UIL correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable UIL to accomplish its mission;
3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for UIL for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the German Government and to the City of Hamburg for their continued support and financial contribution to UIL, and for providing its premises free of charge, and to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to UIL's activities, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable UIL to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of UIL to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:

Output 1.1.ED Education systems governance, policy, management and curriculum frameworks strengthened to ensure inclusive and quality education for all

Output 1.3.ED TVET, youth literacy and adult education supported to enhance skills development and flexible and inclusive learning pathways

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

6 UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/4),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of IITE in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of IITE as a global centre of excellence for technologies in education, and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of IITE to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the area of technologies in education, through:
 - (a) evidence-based policy research, analytical studies and the collection and dissemination of best practices on the use of technologies in education for teachers and learners;

- (b) provision of technical assistance, knowledge and information sharing with Member States on the application of technologies in education, with particular emphasis on teachers and learners and the digital content of curricula;
 - (c) harnessing digital technologies to raise awareness and promote health and well-being education for youth with a focus on technology-enhanced learning for healthy lifestyles;
- 2. *Requests* the Governing Board of IITE, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of IITE correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable IITE to accomplish its mission;
- 3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for IITE for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
- 4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Government of the Russian Federation for its financial contribution and for providing the Institute's premises free of charge, and to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to IITE's activities, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
- 5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable IITE to contribute to the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
- 6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of IITE to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:

Intersectoral Output 7.4 Knowledge and capacities of Member States and stakeholders enhanced for inclusive digital transformation, advancing sustainable artificial intelligence AI and data governance, equitable access to quality education and diversity of contents

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

7 UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/6),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of IICBA in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of IICBA as a regional centre of excellence for teacher policy, training and professional development in Africa and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I and Global Priority Africa,

- 1. *Emphasizes* and *values* the specialized contribution of IICBA to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the area of teacher development, addressing the teacher shortage, the professional development of teachers and attractiveness of the profession to improve the quality of education through:
 - (a) supporting the development and implementation of effective teacher policies and tools to improve the quality of teacher-education curricula, qualification frameworks and training of teacher trainers at all levels in innovative teacher development;
 - (b) developing the capacity of teacher-training institutions in management and quality assurance, in particular in the areas of technology-enhanced teacher standards, planning for technologies in education strategies, development of technologies in education and open and distance learning (ODL), and online certificate training programmes in teacher development;
 - (c) advocating, through research and policy dialogue, for well-trained, qualified and motivated teachers;
- 2. *Requests* the Governing Board of IICBA, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of IICBA correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable IICBA to accomplish its mission;
- 3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for IICBA for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
- 4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to IICBA's activities, *taking note* of IICBA's progress in resource mobilization, partnerships and communications in line with its new strategy, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;

5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable IICBA to contribute to the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of IICBA to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:
Output 1.2.ED Teacher policy and the status of the profession enhanced, and Member States supported to address teacher shortages
Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

8 UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/5),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of IESALC in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of IESALC as a regional centre of excellence for higher education and the promotion of scientific and technological development in the Latin America and the Caribbean region, and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of IESALC to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research and knowledge-sharing in the area of higher education and academic research, through:
 - (a) providing a regional platform for the promotion of inter-university cooperation, as well as collaboration among higher education institutions, in particular by facilitating the active involvement of and intellectual partnerships among UNESCO Chairs on higher education;
 - (b) addressing the challenges related to the internationalization of higher education in the region by monitoring the Regional Convention on the Recognition of Studies, Diplomas and Degrees in Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (2019) and contributing to the monitoring of the Global Convention on the Recognition of Qualifications concerning Higher Education (2019);
 - (c) expanding the global relevance of the contributions of IESALC as the only UNESCO specialized institute in higher education by providing capacity-development opportunities, promoting South-South cooperation, and contributing to expanding the knowledge base about higher education policies worldwide, thus ensuring that Member States' priorities in this field are technically supported by the Institute;
2. *Requests* the Governing Board of IESALC, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of IESALC correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable IESALC to accomplish its mission;
3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for IESALC for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Government of the Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela for providing the premises of IESALC free of charge, and to the Member States and organizations that have contributed intellectually or financially to IESALC's activities, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable IESALC to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of IESALC to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programme I:
Output 1.6.ED Higher education systems and academic research strengthened, including through UNITWIN/UNESCO Chairs and instruments for student mobility
Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

9 Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP)

The General Conference,

Acknowledging the report of the Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP) for the 2024–2025 biennium (43 C/REP/7),

Recognizing the importance of maintaining the functional autonomy of MGIEP in order to ensure that it can provide services to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the unique mandate of MGIEP as a regional centre of excellence for global citizenship education, education for peace, human rights and sustainable development in the Asia and the Pacific region, and its fundamental role in the implementation of Major Programme I,

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of MGIEP to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I, particularly with regard to capacity development, policy advice, research, and knowledge-sharing in the area of education for peace, human rights and sustainable development, and global citizenship education and social and emotional learning through:
 - (a) embedding social and emotional competencies and skills, knowledge, and attitudes for peace, sustainable development and global citizenship in existing curriculums;
 - (b) supporting innovation in pedagogies and learning processes through research in cognitive science, transformative education, digital pedagogical tools and experiential learning;
 - (c) enhancing education policy and practices based on science and evidence-based research, as well as knowledge management, capacity building and dissemination capacity, on transformative education for peace and sustainable development;
 - (d) facilitating science- and evidence-based and inclusive international education policy dialogues and online youth education programmes for peace, sustainable development and global citizenship, which focus on building youth capacities and competencies in active and sustainable civic and social engagement;
2. *Requests* the MGIEP Governing Board, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of MGIEP correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programme I listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to strengthen collaboration with the Director-General, Member States and UNESCO's networks to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable MGIEP to accomplish its mission;
3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for MGIEP for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Government of India, Member States and other bodies and institutions that have contributed intellectually or financially to MGIEP's activities, and *invites* them to continue their support for 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant or renew financial and other appropriate contributions to enable MGIEP to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programme I and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of MGIEP to the achievement of the following output of Major Programme I:

Output 6.1.ED The UNESCO Recommendation on Education for Peace, Human Rights and Sustainable Development (2023) operationalized by Member States to address hate speech, discrimination and violence, and to foster sustainable peace, including through global citizenship education

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

10 UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM)

The General Conference,

Recognizing the importance of the functional autonomy of IISTEM in order to ensure that it can provide support to the Member States in a proactive, flexible, effective, efficient, timely and sustainable way,

Also recognizing the important role of IISTEM, under the leadership of Major Programme I, in promoting inclusive, equitable, relevant and quality education for all from early childhood to adulthood in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM),

1. *Emphasizes and values* the specialized contribution of IISTEM to the fulfilment of UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programmes I and II, particularly with regard to strengthening the capacities of Member States and catalysing interdisciplinary and innovative research, policy dialogues, and development of standards pertaining to STEM education through:
 - (a) providing policy analysis and advice for Member States, and initiating and facilitating international dialogues on issues concerning STEM education;
 - (b) strengthening the capacity of decision makers, teacher trainers, teachers and other education personnel relating to STEM education;

- (c) initiating collaborative research on forward-looking, interdisciplinary and innovative approaches to STEM education, by planning and organizing a broad range of STEM education experimental studies, developing appropriate teaching and learning interventions, and pedagogical practices, in order to foster learners' and teachers' competences and knowledge in STEM education;
 - (d) creating a global pool of individual and institutional expertise, serving as a network and clearing house on best practices for STEM education, and promoting monitoring and evaluation of advances in STEM education;
 - (e) prioritizing Africa, small island developing States (SIDS) and least developed countries and promoting the involvement of girls and women in STEM education;
 - (f) working closely with UNESCO Headquarters, field offices and UNESCO category 1 institutes so as to underpin UNESCO's leading role in this field, reinforcing the global agenda in STEM education and enhancing UNESCO's visibility, impact and sphere of influence in STEM education;
 - (g) fostering alliances, sharing knowledge and mobilizing partnership and resources in collaboration with other United Nations bodies, other international organizations and global initiatives, and strengthening North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation, leveraging UNESCO's networks, in the coordination and execution of the relevant STEM education strategies and programmes;
2. *Requests* the IISTEM Governing Board, in accordance with the Institute's Statutes and the present resolution, when approving the Institute's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to ensure that the objectives and activities of IISTEM correspond to UNESCO's strategic objectives and outcomes, and the outputs of Major Programmes I and II listed in paragraph 6 below;
 - (b) to continue to work with the Director-General to mobilize the necessary human and financial resources to enable IISTEM to accomplish its mission;
 3. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for IISTEM for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme I, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
 4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Government of China and to the Municipality of Shanghai for their contribution to IISTEM and for providing the premises of IISTEM free of charge;
 5. *Appeals* to Member States, intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to grant financial and other appropriate contributions to enable IISTEM to contribute towards the priorities of Major Programmes I and II and the strategic objectives of UNESCO for 2022–2029;
 6. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies in the statutory reports on the contribution of IISTEM to the achievement of the following outputs of Major Programmes I and II:

Intersectoral Output 1.5 Access to and participation of learners in inclusive and gender-responsive STEM education and science literacy expanded, with equal and equitable access for all to resources and career pathways regardless of gender, so as to foster innovation

Output 1.10.ED A common international vision driven by cooperation, monitoring, research and foresight.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

11 Learning Planet Institute (France)

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.I,

Having examined document 43 C/18.I,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of France to designate the Learning Planet Institute (LPI), in Paris, France, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the deviations between, on the one hand, the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and, on the other hand, the draft tripartite agreement between UNESCO, the Government of France and the Learning Planet Institute (LPI);
3. *Approves* the designation of the Learning Planet Institute (LPI), in Paris, France, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.I;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

12 Simon Bolivar Musical Foundation (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela)

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.II,

Having examined document 43 C/18.II,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of the Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela to designate the Simon Bolivar Musical Foundation (SBMF), in Caracas, Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);

2. Approves the designation of the Simon Bolivar Musical Foundation (SBMF), in Caracas, Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.II;
3. Authorizes the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

13 Institute for Retraining and Professional Development of Directors and Specialists of Preschool Educational Organizations (Uzbekistan)

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.III,

Having examined document 43 C/18.III,

1. Welcomes the proposal of Uzbekistan to designate the Institute for Retraining and Professional Development of Directors and Specialists of Preschool Educational Organizations, in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. Approves the designation of the Institute for Retraining and Professional Development of Directors and Specialists of Preschool Educational Organizations, in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.III;
3. Authorizes the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

14 Enhancing dialogue with teachers around the world: proposal for an Interactive platform

The General Conference,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 42 and 222 EX/Decision 4.I.B,

Having examined document 43 C/47,

Emphasizing the importance of the outcome statement (Santiago Consensus) of the World Summit on Teachers (2025) adopted at the World Summit on Teachers (2025, Chile) as a high-level commitment to addressing teacher shortages, supporting the teaching profession and strengthening teachers' voices in educational policymaking, as well as its key role in the implementation and monitoring of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4) – Education 2030, in particular target 4.c,

1. Invites the Director-General and the International Task Force on Teachers for Education 2030 to continue elevating teachers' voices including through social dialogue processes and global education forums that are inclusive of all teachers and settings in all their diversity, and fostering direct engagement among educators worldwide, including through existing networks and programmes;
2. Encourages Member States to provide voluntary contributions to enable the development of a pilot platform to collect and amplify teachers' voices in the context of the revision of the Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997);
3. Requests the Director-General to report regularly to the Executive Board in the framework of the C/5 Implementation Report on progress made in strengthening teacher engagement in global education dialogue.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

15 Supporting the continuity of UNRWA's educational activities in the Occupied Palestinian Territory

The General Conference,

Recalling 8 X/EX/Decision 2, 221 EX/Decision 5.I.K and 222 EX/Decision 4.I.O,

Having examined document 43 C/61,

1. Acknowledges the progress made by the Secretariat in the implementation of its previous decisions on educational activities in the Occupied Palestinian Territories, in coordination with relevant authorities;
2. Requests the Secretariat to continue taking all appropriate measures for the implementation of these activities;
3. Requests the Director-General to continue coordinating with relevant authorities for the implementation of the education-related recommendations from the "Colonna Report";
4. Also requests the Director-General to report to the Executive Board at its 225th session on the progress made towards the implementation of relevant UNESCO resolutions and decisions and *decides* to include this item in the agenda of the 44th session of the General Conference if the situation necessitates it.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

16 SDG 4 – Education 2030: global/regional coordination, monitoring and support

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 18, 219 EX/Decision 6, 220 EX/Decision 6, 221 EX/Decision 6 and 222 EX/Decision 5,

Reaffirming the critical role of inclusive, equitable, quality education and lifelong learning as a fundamental human right, catalytic force and strategic investment in sustainable development,

Recognizing UNESCO's unique mandate in leading the coordination and monitoring of the global education agenda,

Having examined document 43 C/63,

1. *Commends* the Director-General on UNESCO's continued leadership in positioning education at the centre of the global political and development financing agendas, and for effectively coordinating global action through the SDG 4–Education 2030 High-Level Steering Committee (SDG4 HLSC);
2. *Expresses its appreciation* to the Inter-Agency Secretariat and the SDG 4–Education 2030 High-Level Steering Committee (SDG4 HLSC) for mobilizing high-level political commitment, multilateral and multistakeholder cooperation, and global advocacy for education and its financing as essential for the advancement of all Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and as a transformative force for equity, peace and sustainable development;
3. *Invites* all Member States to accelerate progress towards Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4 and strengthen their engagement in international and regional cooperation, joint advocacy, policy dialogue and monitoring, as well as cross-country and regional exchange of experiences, good practices and knowledge;
4. *Welcomes* the Fortaleza Declaration adopted at the 2024 Global Education Meeting (2024 GEM) held in Fortaleza, Brazil, in November 2024, and the outcome document (Santiago Consensus) of the World Summit on Teachers (2025) held in Santiago, Chile, in August 2025, while *inviting* Member States to translate commitments into concrete actions;
5. *Requests* the Director-General to continue to prioritize UNESCO's mandate in SDG 4–Education 2030 coordination and leadership and to report thereon to the Executive Board at its 224th session;
6. *Also requests* the Director-General to report to it at its 44th session on the achievements of the SDG 4–Education 2030 High-Level Steering Committee (SDG4 HLSC) and on the consultation process to shape the post-2030 global education agenda led by UNESCO, the SDG4 HLSC and the SDG4 Youth & Student Network.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

17 Major Programme II – Natural Sciences

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for Major Programme II, contributing to the Organization's four strategic objectives and its seven outcomes within the framework of the Medium-Term Strategy (41 C/4), by aiming to support the realization of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), to promote sustainable and resilient societies and support Member States to advance science, technology, innovation, research and engineering to address contemporary environmental and societal challenges;
- (b) to contribute to the Organization's global priorities to promote gender equality, and address the needs of Africa, and pay particular attention to the least developed countries (LDCs), the small island developing States (SIDS), Indigenous Peoples and the most vulnerable segments of society, including persons with disabilities, as well as to engage with youth;
- (c) to resort also in the implementation of the plan of action for Major Programme II to North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation, as complementary modalities for delivery of the programme and to continue to develop partnerships with scientific and research institutions, academia and especially UNESCO Chairs, organizations of the United Nations system and other international and regional organizations and networks, civil society and the private sector, at all stages of programme development and implementation, in order to:
 - (i) leverage UNESCO's global networks for climate adaptation and ecosystem restoration: utilize biosphere reserves, geoparks, and ecohydrology demonstration sites as platforms to test interdisciplinary solutions, integrate Indigenous knowledge, strengthen climate adaptation and mitigation strategies, restore ecosystems, and create sustainable green livelihood opportunities for all;
 - (ii) enhance water security, as defined in the eighth phase of UNESCO's Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP-VIII), and disaster risk reduction: improve access and sustainable and integrated management of water and sanitation for all, hydrological monitoring, and disaster risk reduction by integrating science-based policies and strengthening forecasting systems, while building resilient communities against natural hazards and climate-induced risks;
 - (iii) advance science, technology and innovation (STI) for sustainable development: foster global collaboration in science, technology and innovation by promoting open science, knowledge sharing, technology transfer and evidence-based STI policies that enhance socio-economic development;
 - (iv) strengthen science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) education for sustainable development: enhance STEM education by integrating sustainability principles

into curricula, equipping learners with knowledge and skills to address global challenges, and ensuring alignment with Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) Target 4.7 to foster long-term environmental stewardship and scientific literacy;

- (v) promote the International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development: strengthen global awareness and collaboration through multi-stakeholder engagement, leveraging science diplomacy to foster international cooperation, inform policy actions, drive innovation, and build scientific capacity, ensuring transformative impact in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs);
 - (d) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
2. *Requests the Director-General:*
- (a) to implement the various activities authorized by this resolution, including through intersectoral cooperation, to achieve the outcomes and the outputs pertaining to Major Programme II;
 - (b) to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 1: A world where inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning opportunities are ensured, while strengthening international cooperation for the achievement of SDG 4

Intersectoral Output 1.5 Access to and participation of learners in inclusive and gender-responsive STEM education and science literacy expanded, with equal and equitable access for all to resources and career pathways regardless of gender, so as to foster innovation

Outcome 2: A world where biodiversity, geodiversity, water and the ocean are valued and sustainably managed, in order to face the challenges posed by climate change and contribute to climate action

Output 2.1.SC Policy advice, science and Indigenous knowledge leveraged to equip Member States and custodians in advancing biodiversity, ecosystems and geodiversity conservation in UNESCO designated sites for sustainable management and landscape connectivity

Output 2.3.SC Knowledge generated, and Member States' capacity for inclusive water resources management strengthened in a changing environment

Intersectoral Output 2.5 Capacity, risk awareness, prevention and preparedness of Member States and communities strengthened for inclusive climate adaptation, disaster risk reduction and resilient societies in line with the Sendai Framework

Intersectoral Output 2.6 Education for sustainable development expanded, including through the Greening Education Partnership, to make learners and communities climate-ready and agents of change

Intersectoral Output 2.7 Holistic and strategic support provided to small island developing States (SIDS) to address their priorities and vulnerabilities, aligned with the UNESCO Operational Strategy for SIDS and the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda

Outcome 3: A world where the sciences, technology and innovation are responsive to current and emerging challenges and accessible to all

Output 3.1.SC Member States supported in strengthening science, technology and innovation (STI) ecosystems and their access for all, including the most vulnerable populations, to advance open science, gender equality in science, evidence-based policymaking and science literacy

Output 3.2.SC Technical assistance, guidance and standards provided to Member States to strengthen capacity with due regard to gender equality, in basic sciences, engineering and STEM education to foster innovation and science-driven sustainable development

Output 3.3.SC Dialogue across science and society enhanced to foster global science culture and evidence-based decision making

Outcome 4: A world where culture in all its forms is protected and promoted

Intersectoral Output 4.7 Member States' capacities and awareness raised to protect, safeguard and promote Indigenous knowledge, cultures and languages through inclusive policies and targeted action

Outcome 5: A world where freedom of expression and the right and access to information are guaranteed to allow societies to manage today's transitions in a just and inclusive way

Intersectoral Output 5.3 Capacity of Member States, key stakeholders, public awareness and public engagement enhanced on freedom and safety of scientists and scientific research, taking into account gender equality and emergency settings.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

18 **Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP)**

The General Conference,

Recognizing the important role of the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP), as a UNESCO category 1 centre, in fostering capacities and knowledge in theoretical and applied physics, pure and applied mathematics, in interdisciplinary areas including climate change, disaster risk reduction, renewable energy, quantitative biology and high-performance computing, with a special focus on developing countries, under Major Programme II,

1. *Requests* the ICTP Steering Committee and Scientific Council, in accordance with the ICTP Tripartite Agreement, country agreements, and this resolution, when approving the Centre's budget for 2026–2027:
 - (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for ICTP structured around three lines of action, with special emphasis on Africa, gender equality, least developed countries (LDCs) and small island developing States (SIDS), as well as youth;
 - (b) to resort also to the implementation of the plan of action for ICTP to South-South and triangular cooperation as modalities for delivery of the programme and to continue to develop partnerships with civil society, the private sector, organizations of the United Nations system, and other international organizations, at all stages of programme development, in order to achieve ICTP's internal lines of action listed in paragraph 3 below;
 - (c) to reinforce ICTP capacity for research, education and networking in the physical and mathematical sciences, as well as in interdisciplinary areas, for the benefit of scientists from developing countries, ensuring that staff scientists remain at the forefront of their fields;
2. *Takes note* that the integrated budget for ICTP for the period 2026–2027 is part of the total budget of Major Programme II, including a financial allocation from the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
3. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports and as part of the reporting on Major Programme II, in relation to Output 3.2.SC, on the implementation of the following lines of action:
 - (a) developing countries' scientific expertise and interdisciplinary research expanded in the fields of artificial intelligence (AI), quantitative life sciences and quantum information;
 - (b) developing countries' capacity strengthened in the basic sciences, in particular physics and mathematics;
 - (c) developing countries' access to scientific education and knowledge expanded, particularly through ICTs and regional collaboration;
4. *Expresses its gratitude* to the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), the Government of Italy, and the Member States and other entities that have supported ICTP through voluntary contributions, and *invites* them to continue their support in 2026–2027 and beyond;
5. *Appeals* to Member States, international organizations, donor agencies, foundations, and the private sector to provide or renew support to enable ICTP to implement and expand the activities envisaged herein.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

19 Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC)

The General Conference,

Recognizing the important role of the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC), established as a body with functional autonomy within UNESCO with the Assembly being the principal organ of the Commission under the IOC Statutes, to promote international cooperation and to coordinate programmes in research, services and capacity building, in order to learn more about the nature and resources of the ocean and coastal areas and to apply that knowledge for the improvement of management, sustainable development, the protection of the marine environment, and the decision-making process of its Member States,

Also recognizing the importance of the United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development (2021–2030), coordinated by the IOC on behalf of the United Nations system, and its vision of the science we need for the ocean we want,

Recalling that the IOC plan of action for the period 2026–2027 contributes to Strategic Objective 2 of the UNESCO Medium-Term Strategy 2022–2029 and the related Outcomes 3 and 4, as translated into the IOC Medium-Term Strategy 2022–2029,

Also recalling that, in accordance with the IOC Medium-Term Strategy 2022–2029, the IOC plan of action is focused on the following five thematic programme areas (high-level objectives), with particular attention to ensuring that all its Member States have the capacity to meet these objectives:

- (i) healthy ocean and sustained ocean ecosystem services;
- (ii) effective warning systems and preparedness for tsunamis and other ocean-related hazards;
- (iii) resilience to climate change and contribution to its mitigation;
- (iv) scientifically-founded services for the sustainable ocean economy;
- (v) foresight on emerging ocean science issues;

and supported by the following conceptual framework of functions:

- A. foster research to strengthen knowledge of ocean and coastal processes and human impacts upon them (*ocean research*);
- B. maintain, strengthen and integrate global ocean observing, data prediction and information systems (*observing systems and data management*);
- C. develop early warning systems, services, and preparedness for risks of tsunamis and ocean-related hazards (*early warning and services*);
- D. support assessment and provision of information through the science-policy interface (*assessment and information for policy*);
- E. enhance ocean governance through a shared knowledge base and improved regional cooperation (*sustainable management and governance*);

- F. develop the institutional capacity in all of the functions above, as a cross-cutting function (*capacity development*),

Further recalling that the Commission shall prepare regular reports on its activities, which shall be submitted to the General Conference of UNESCO,

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
2. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the achievement of the following outcome and outputs:

Outcome 2: A world where biodiversity, geodiversity, water and the ocean are valued and sustainably managed, in order to face the challenges posed by climate change and contribute to climate action

Output 2.4.IOC Member States critically supported in strengthening their capacity to conduct marine scientific research, generate knowledge, and develop and implement science-based tools, services and policies in order to reverse the decline in ocean health and accelerate the transition towards sustainable management of ocean-related risks and opportunities (IOC Resolution EC-57/2)

Intersectoral Output 2.6 Education for sustainable development expanded, including through the Greening Education Partnership, to make learners and communities climate-ready and agents of change

Intersectoral Output 2.7 Holistic and strategic support provided to small island developing States (SIDS) to address their priorities and vulnerabilities, aligned with the UNESCO Operational Strategy for SIDS and the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda

3. *Appeals* to Member States, international organizations, donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to provide or renew support to enable IOC to implement and expand the activities envisaged herein, including its role as coordinator of the United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development (2021–2030).

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

20 **Biotechnology Centre for Training in Agamic Seed Production (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.IV,

Having examined document 43 C/18.IV,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of the Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela to designate the Biotechnology Centre for Training in Agamic Seed Production (CEBISA), in Mérida, Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Approves* the designation of the Biotechnology Centre for Training in Agamic Seed Production (CEBISA), in Mérida, Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.IV;
3. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

21 **International Centre for Integrated River Research and Management (Austria)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.V,

Having examined document 43 C/18.V,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of Austria to designate the International Centre for Integrated River Research and Management (IC-Rivers) at the University of Natural Resources and Life Sciences (BOKU), in Vienna, Austria, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the deviations between, on the one hand, the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and, on the other hand, the draft agreement between UNESCO and Austria and the draft memorandum of understanding between UNESCO and the University of Natural Resources and Life Sciences (BOKU);
3. *Approves* the designation of the International Centre for Integrated River Research and Management (IC-Rivers) at the University of Natural Resources and Life Sciences (BOKU), in Vienna, Austria, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.V;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement and memorandum of understanding.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

22 **Australian Rivers Institute (Australia)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.VI,

Having examined document 43 C/18.VI,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of Australia to designate the Australian Rivers Institute (ARI) at Griffith University, in Brisbane, Australia, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the deviations between, on the one hand, the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and, on the other hand, the draft agreement between UNESCO and the Government of Australia and the draft memorandum of understanding between UNESCO and Griffith University;
3. *Approves* the designation of the Australian Rivers Institute (ARI) at Griffith University, in Brisbane, Australia, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.VI;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement and memorandum of understanding.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

23 African Institute in Indigenous Knowledge Systems (South Africa)

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.X,

Having examined document 43 C/18.X,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of South Africa to designate the African Institute in Indigenous Knowledge Systems (AIKS) at the University of KwaZulu-Natal, in Durban, South Africa, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the deviations between, on the one hand, the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and, on the other hand, the draft agreement between UNESCO and the Government of South Africa and the draft memorandum of understanding between UNESCO and the University of KwaZulu-Natal;
3. *Approves* the designation of the African Institute in Indigenous Knowledge Systems (AIKS) at the University of KwaZulu-Natal, in Durban, South Africa, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.X;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement and memorandum of understanding.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

24 International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development

The General Conference,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 37,

Having examined document 43 C/37,

Also recalling UNESCO's Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017) and Recommendation on Open Science (2021),

Recognizing the potential of science engagement to foster inclusive and sustainable development and to empower youth and citizens worldwide,

Noting that the proclamation of an international day of engagement in science for sustainable development will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization,

1. *Proclaims* 27 November of every year International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development;
2. *Invites* all Member States and partners to make voluntary contributions to enhance the work of the International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development, 2024–2033, and to actively participate in organizing and supporting the activities associated with the International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development, while recognizing the potential for multi-stakeholder partnerships to achieve its goals;
3. *Encourages* the Director-General to promote the observance of the International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development in connection with UNESCO's leadership of the International Decade of Sciences for Sustainable Development, 2024–2033.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

25 International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS)

The General Conference,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 41,

Having examined document 43 C/39,

Recognizing the unique vulnerabilities and contributions of small island developing States (SIDS), and the growing need for broader awareness, solidarity and support in their regard,

Emphasizing UNESCO's long-standing engagement with small island developing States (SIDS) as a priority group and its strategic commitment under the UNESCO Operational Strategy for Small Island Developing States (SIDS) (2023–2029),

Noting that the proclamation of an international day for small island developing States (SIDS) will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization,

1. *Proclaims* 25 April of every year International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS);
2. *Invites* all Member States and partners to support those of UNESCO's activities related to small island developing States (SIDS), and to actively contribute by organizing events at the national, regional and international levels to mark the International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS).

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025

26 International Day of Caves and Karst

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 43,

Having examined document 43 C/55,

Considering the significant scientific, ecological, hydrological, cultural and economic value of caves and karst, and their critical role in water provision, biodiversity conservation, geoscience, cultural heritage, climate regulation and sustainable development,

Noting the contribution of many UNESCO-designated sites that include cave and karst features, such as world heritage properties, Global Geoparks and biosphere reserves, as well as the support of relevant UNESCO programmes (International Geoscience and Geoparks Programme (IGGP), Man and the Biosphere Programme (MAB), Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP), and so on),

Acknowledging the written support received for this initiative from 15 international organizations, 8 regional organizations, 38 International Union of Speleology (UIS) member countries and 91 national organizations and institutions from every continent,

Also noting that the proclamation of an international day of caves and karst will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization,

1. *Proclaims* 13 September of each year International Day of Caves and Karst;
2. *Encourages* Member States, civil society, non-governmental organizations, academia and the private sector to actively participate in organizing activities relating to the International Day of Caves and Karst;
3. *Invites* the Director-General to promote the celebration of the International Day of Caves and Karst on 13 September of every year as one of the international days marked by UNESCO;
4. *Calls* for increased international cooperation among Member States, researchers and institutions to enhance collective efforts in protecting caves and karst and promoting recognition of their cultural, hydrological, biodiversity and geodiversity value.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025

27 Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for Major Programme III, contributing to the Organization's four strategic objectives and its seven outcomes within the framework of the Medium-Term Strategy (41 C/4), by aiming to support the realization of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), leveraging the contributions from the human and social sciences to support Member States in designing evidence-based policies towards building inclusive and peaceful societies, and addressing the impact of major interconnected trends such as the fast paced digital transformation; the social impact of climate change; demographic trends and migration, and the increased inequalities of income and opportunities, including of gender;
- (b) to prioritize work and programmes for the two global priorities, Africa and gender equality and the priority groups small island developing States (SIDS) and youth, place special emphasis on least developed countries (LDCs) and support the most vulnerable in our societies, including Indigenous Peoples, people with disabilities, low-income women and youth, the elderly and migrants;
- (c) to resort also in the implementation of the plan of action for Major Programme III to North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation, for delivery of the programme and to continue to develop partnerships with civil society, the private sector, research institutions, academia and notably UNESCO Chairs, organizations of the United Nations system and other international organizations at all stages of programme development, in order to:
 - (i) advance the role of social science in policy by enhancing analytical capacities to understand the interactions between social, environmental and economic systems, thereby improving the management of synergies between efficiency, equity and sustainability goals and ensure a robust science-policy nexus by providing tailored policy advice to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs);
 - (ii) promote science ecosystems anchored in universal values in line with the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017) through upscaled efforts and upstream actions for the realization of the right to science and trust in science, and a stronger implementation of the Programme and Call to Action on the Freedom and Safety of Scientists;
 - (iii) support Member States in advancing the ethical governance of emerging technologies, through implementing the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021) and its tools and platforms, and the Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology (2025),

and the identification and analysis of emerging trends in quantum technologies, synthetic biology, climate engineering and digital innovations, among others and also ensuring that the development of these technologies remain responsible, transparent, inclusive and respectful of privacy and in line with the rule of law;

- (iv) strengthen intercultural dialogue and combat all forms of racism, discrimination and gender inequality, enhancing synergies between initiatives, research and capacity-building efforts through key programmes;
- (v) support Member States in advancing the inclusion of people with disabilities by implementing the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy, in particular through intersectoral cooperation;
- (vi) leverage the power of inclusive sport for development, social cohesion, peace and gender equality, particularly fighting violence against women and girls, and accelerate the effectiveness of the International Convention against Doping in Sport (2005) by mobilizing governments and stakeholders to drive meaningful change in the global sports ecosystem, enhancing values, ethics and integrity in sports through guidance, tailored assistance, resources and tools;
- (vii) ensure youth engagement in the co-creation of knowledge and in decision-making in all areas of UNESCO's mandate notably by strengthening capacities of youth stakeholders as well as supporting youth-led research and youth-led action with social impact;
- (d) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests the Director-General:*

- (a) to implement the various activities authorized by this resolution, including through intersectoral cooperation, to achieve the outcomes and the outputs pertaining to Major Programme III;
- (b) to report periodically to the governing bodies, in statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 2: A world where biodiversity, geodiversity, water and the ocean are valued and sustainably managed, in order to face the challenges posed by climate change and contribute to climate action

Output 2.2.SHS Social and human sciences leveraged to support Member States in addressing the interconnected challenges posed by climate disruption, including its social, environmental and economic impacts

Outcome 3: A world where the sciences, technology and innovation are responsive to current and emerging challenges and accessible to all

Output 3.4.SHS Science-policy nexus strengthened through multidisciplinary approaches to manage social transformations and the impact of global trends

Outcome 5: A world where freedom of expression and the right and access to information are guaranteed to allow societies to manage today's transitions in a just and inclusive way

Intersectoral Output 5.3 Capacity of Member States, key stakeholders, public awareness and public engagement enhanced on freedom and safety of scientists and scientific research, taking into account gender equality and emergency settings

Outcome 6: A world of peace and inclusion, free from discrimination, disinformation and hate speech

Output 6.2.SHS Capacity of Member States and stakeholders strengthened to combat discrimination and racism, in particular by addressing the consequences of enslavement and the trade of enslaved people, and by promoting intercultural and interreligious dialogue and understanding, gender-based resilience and disability inclusion building on the UNESCO Roadmap against Racism and Discrimination

Output 6.4.SHS Capacities of youth stakeholders strengthened, knowledge generated and youth actions, networks and spaces supported to develop and implement youth-focused policies and programmes addressing multidimensional societal challenges faced by youth

Output 6.5.SHS Capacities of Member States strengthened to develop inclusive sport and physical education policies that foster social inclusion, equality and human development, reinforcing sport ethics, integrity and the International Convention against Doping in Sport (2005)

Outcome 7: A world where new technologies are developed and applied ethically for sustainable development and in respect of human rights and dignity

Intersectoral Output 7.1 Member States and other stakeholders supported in developing and implementing ethical AI governance frameworks, policies, and institutions incorporating human rights, gender equality, and sustainability, building on the Recommendation on the Ethics of AI

Output 7.2.SHS Ethical and human rights-based scientific and technical frameworks and guidelines for frontier and digital technologies developed, and Member States supported in integrating these into national and international policy frameworks

Intersectoral Output 7.4 Knowledge and capacities of Member States and stakeholders enhanced for inclusive digital transformation, advancing sustainable AI and data governance, equitable access to quality education and diversity of contents.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

28 Commemoration of the International Day of Vesak at UNESCO

The General Conference,

Recalling 219 EX/Decision 27,

Having examined document 43 C/22,

Also recalling United Nations General Assembly resolution 54/115 of 1999, “International recognition of the Day of Vesak at United Nations Headquarters and other United Nations offices”, and *noting* the 25th anniversary of its proclamation, commemorated in 2024–2025, as decided by the General Conference through 42 C/Resolution 51,

Acknowledging the contribution that Buddhism, one of the oldest religions and philosophies in the world, has made over millennia and continues to make to the spirituality of humanity, as well as its universal significance,

Recognizing UNESCO’s lead role within the United Nations system in contributing to the building of a culture of peace, the eradication of poverty, and sustainable development through education, the sciences, culture and communication and information,

Further recalling Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 16, “promote peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, provide access to justice for all and build effective, accountable and inclusive institutions at all levels”, as a reflection of the ideals endorsed through the International Day of Vesak,

Highlighting the value of Buddhist teachings and practices in fortifying the mental and physical well-being of persons and societies affected by recurrent wars, natural disasters and similar calamities,

Emphasizing the continuing relevance of Buddhism and mindfulness practices for the health and well-being of contemporary society,

1. *Requests* the Director-General to issue an annual message on the International Day of Vesak;
2. *Also requests* the Director-General to make appropriate arrangements to commemorate the International Day of Vesak annually on the Day of Vesak, in the month of May, at UNESCO Headquarters, in consultation with the relevant permanent delegations wishing to collaborate in this endeavour.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

29 Fit for Life: Advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education, including through the promotion of cycling

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/27 and Add.,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 5.I.D,

Also recalling 216 EX/Decision 40, 217 EX/Decision 38, 219 EX/Decision 10, 219 EX/Decision 32, 220 EX/Decision 43 and 221 EX/Decision 13,

Reaffirming the principles set out in the Revised International Charter of Physical Education, Physical Activity and Sport (2015), and UNESCO’s central role in enhancing Member States’ capacities for policies that advance inclusive, equitable and safe participation in sport and physical education,

Recognizing the breadth of UNESCO’s actions in this regard through the Fit for Life Global Alliance, including the promotion of gender equality and safe sport, disability inclusion, the fight against racism, quality physical education, and the advancement of activities and programmes that promote cycling,

1. *Acknowledges* the progress made in advancing UNESCO’s work on inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education since its 42nd session, including through the promotion of cycling;
2. *Reaffirms* the thematic priorities of the Organization’s work in this domain, including gender equality, safe sport, disability inclusion, and the fight against racism and racial discrimination;
3. *Affirms* the importance of an intersectional approach to this work, and the need to connect these thematic priorities through coherent and integrated efforts;
4. *Welcomes* the development of global policy standards to support Member States in advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and physical education systems, in general, including the recognition of the importance of safe cycling infrastructure and cycling as a part of quality physical education;
5. *Underscores* the importance of capacity-building initiatives, including the Fit for Life Sport Leadership Programme and other toolkits, as well as resources that promote cycling literacy and active mobility;
6. *Supports* continued advocacy and public engagement efforts to raise awareness and strengthen political and cultural support, including cycling as an accessible and sustainable practice that promotes inclusion, health and environmental goals;
7. *Encourages* Member States to actively engage with the piloting, implementation and scaling up of UNESCO’s global policy standards for sport and physical education, and to integrate cycling-related good practices within these standards;
8. *Invites* Member States to mobilize financial and in-kind resources in support of the aforementioned efforts.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

30 International Taijiquan Day

The General Conference,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 43,

Having examined document 43 C/48,

Recognizing that Taijiquan, as an ancient sport and intangible cultural heritage, plays a positive role in improving health and well-being, promoting social inclusion and gender equality, deepening exchanges and mutual learning, and contributing to peace,

Reaffirming the important role that inclusive, equitable and safe sport plays in promoting cultural exchanges and mutual learning, as well as fostering peace and development,

Noting that the proclamation of an international Taijiquan day will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization,

1. *Proclaims* 21 March of every year International Taijiquan Day;
2. *Invites* all Member States and partners to support those of UNESCO's activities related to inclusive, equitable and safe sport and to actively contribute to the promotion and observance of International Taijiquan Day;
3. *Encourages* cooperation with relevant stakeholders in this regard, including the International Wushu Federation (IWUF);
4. *Encourages* Member States and relevant partners to mobilize voluntary contributions to support the implementation of activities related to International Taijiquan Day.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

31 International Day of Nomadic Heritage

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 28,

Having examined document 43 C/51,

Recognizing that nomadic cultures and traditions have made a profound contribution to humanity's shared heritage, knowledge exchanges, mobility patterns, craftwork, music, oral traditions, social practices and sustainable interaction with nature,

Affirming the deep historical significance of nomadic societies in fostering intercontinental exchange, shaping technological and economic advancements and strengthening diplomatic and intercultural relations,

Acknowledging the essential contributions of UNESCO-led initiatives such as the Silk Roads Programme, World Nomad Games and International Institute for the Study of Nomadic Civilizations (IISNC) in safeguarding and promoting nomadic heritage,

Reaffirming the need for enhanced international collaboration in research, education and advocacy related to nomadic cultures and their contributions to sustainable development,

Emphasizing that proclaiming an international day of nomadic heritage will contribute to greater visibility, awareness and recognition of nomadic cultures, and of the challenges faced by their communities, at the international level,

Underscoring the importance of nomadic worldviews, knowledge systems and values in fostering alternative epistemologies and knowledge co-production, thereby contributing to global efforts towards equitable and inclusive decision-making,

1. *Requests* the Director-General to strengthen the Secretariat's engagement with nomadic culture and heritage-related initiatives, particularly within the framework of the Culture and Social and Human Sciences Sectors, while ensuring that this does not affect UNESCO's regular budget and will be funded with voluntary contributions;
2. *Proclaims* 22 September of every year International Day of Nomadic Heritage;
3. *Advocates* for the integration of nomadic cultural heritage within national and international sustainable development strategies;
4. *Recommends* that the Director-General facilitate an intersectoral approach to the study and promotion of nomadic heritage, ensuring synergy across UNESCO's cultural, educational, and scientific programmes, subject to the availability of resources mobilized for this purpose;
5. *Encourages* Member States, civil society, non-governmental organizations, academic communities and the private sector to actively participate in organizing and supporting the activities associated with the International Day of Nomadic Heritage, recognizing their potential to support the development and implementation of national and international programmes aimed at the safeguarding, revitalization and promotion of nomadic heritage.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

32 Cyrus Cylinder: an early charter of human rights and cultural diversity

The General Conference,

Recalling the purposes and principles of the Charter of the United Nations, in particular the faith in fundamental human rights and in the dignity and worth of the human person,

Noting that culture – in all its forms – must be protected, safeguarded, promoted and transmitted to future generations so as to inspire genuine dialogue among cultures based on respect for their diversity, pluralism, tolerance and mutual understanding aimed at promoting sustainable peace and development,

Reaffirming that civilizational achievements constitute the shared heritage of humankind, providing a source of inspiration and progress for humanity at large,

Acknowledging the Cyrus Charter, carved in the Cyrus Cylinder, as a valuable historical document that embodies one of the world's oldest models of a State open to different cultures and religions;

Having examined document 43 C/52,

1. *Recognizes* the importance of the Cyrus Cylinder as one of the earliest known accounts embodying principles later associated with human rights, exemplifying the importance of historical texts and records in preserving humanity's shared memory and heritage and fostering intercultural dialogue;
2. *Calls for* leveraging the Cyrus Cylinder and the principles it embodies in efforts to build a world based on peace and tolerance;
3. *Invites* the Director-General to consider the principles enshrined in the Cyrus Cylinder in UNESCO programmes fostering justice, human rights, non-discrimination, tolerance and intercultural understanding;
4. *Invites* Member States to provide appropriate resources on a voluntary basis for the development and implementation of activities related to the Cyrus Cylinder within UNESCO's mandate;
5. *Encourages* Member States to foster greater awareness of the Cyrus Cylinder, through means including multilingual dissemination for educational and knowledge purposes, as one of the earliest accounts embodying principles later associated with human rights.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

33 UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029)

The General Conference,

Recalling 219 EX/Decision 32, 221 EX/Decision 13 and 222 EX/Decision 10,

Having examined document 43 C/62,

Also recalling the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006), and in particular its provisions on accessibility, non-discrimination, participation, reasonable accommodation and international cooperation,

Emphasizing that persons with disabilities are often among the most marginalized and that the comprehensive fulfilment of UNESCO's mandates requires their inclusion in all programmes, policies, structures and operations,

Acknowledging that to be credible, the UNESCO disability inclusion strategy (2026–2029) must include mechanisms for accountability, reporting, adequate resources, capacity building, meaningful participation of persons with disabilities and their representative organizations, and disaggregated data,

Noting that UNESCO's Medium-Term Strategy 2022–2029 (41 C/4) already refers to inclusion and social justice as cross-cutting dimensions, but does not fully operationalize disability inclusion,

1. *Adopts* the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029) as the guiding framework for UNESCO's work on disability across all sectors and at all levels;
2. *Welcomes* the coordination of the intersectoral task team on disability rights and inclusion (ITT) and the Disability Inclusion Champions Network to foster disability inclusion across UNESCO, and *commends* the Secretariat for the work conducted and for building an intersectoral strategy that Member States might replicate elsewhere;
3. *Requests* the Director-General, in consultation with Member States, UNESCO sectors, relevant stakeholders including category 1 and 2 institutes and centres, UNESCO Chairs and organizations of persons with disabilities (OPDs), to develop a detailed and time-bound action plan to operationalize the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029), to be presented to the Executive Board at its 226th session (spring 2027);
4. *Calls upon* the Director-General to strengthen disability inclusion across all workstreams of the Organization's programmes and to ensure that all of its internal systems, operations and policies are gradually made disability-inclusive;
5. *Encourages* Member States to mainstream disability inclusion in their own national educational, scientific, cultural, communication and social policies, and to align with the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029);
6. *Requests* the Executive Board to review, at the session preceding each ordinary session of the General Conference, the implementation of the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029) and its Action Plan, and to recommend to the General Conference adjustments or additional measures as necessary;
7. *Decides* that the Director-General shall submit to it at each ordinary session a report on progress in implementation of the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029) and its Action Plan, including challenges, lessons and proposals for further improvements;
8. *Encourages* UNESCO to mobilize partnerships with United Nations agencies, development banks, foundations, civil society, organizations of persons with disabilities, academia and the private sector to support implementation of the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029), especially in resource-constrained settings;
9. *Calls upon* Member States and other partners to provide financial, technical and in-kind voluntary contributions to support UNESCO's disability inclusion work to support and advance the implementation of the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029).

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025

34 Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 29, 216 EX/Decision 9 and 220 EX/Decision 32,

Having examined document 43 C/30 and its Annex,

Conscious of the opportunities offered by neurotechnology as well as the ethical challenges it raises,

Thanking the members of the International Bioethics Committee (IBC) of UNESCO, who prepared the “Ethical Issues of Neurotechnology” report, and the members of the ad hoc expert group, who prepared the first draft of the recommendation on the ethics of neurotechnology,

1. *Commends* the Member States, international partner organizations, experts and stakeholders that have contributed to the consultation process on the draft text of the recommendation on the ethics of neurotechnology and supported UNESCO in this important task;
2. *Adopts* the Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology as set out in Annex II to the present volume;
3. *Recommends* that Member States apply the provisions of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology by taking appropriate steps, including legislative steps, in conformity with the constitutional practice and governing structures of each State, to give effect within their territories to the principles of the Recommendation;
4. *Decides* that the periodicity of the reports of Member States on the measures taken by them to implement the Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology will be every four years;
5. *Invites* the Director-General to transmit to it, at its 45th session, the first consolidated report on the implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology, and *also decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

35 Major Programme IV – Culture

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:
 - (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for Major Programme IV, contributing to the Organization’s four strategic objectives and its seven outcomes within the framework of the Medium-Term Strategy (41 C/4), by aiming to support the realization of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), including SDG target 11.4 and taking into account the transversal role of culture for sustainable development;
 - (b) to contribute to the Organization’s global priorities to address the needs of Africa and promote gender equality, paying particular attention to least developed countries (LDCs) and small island developing States (SIDS), and to meet the needs of youth and the most vulnerable segments of society, including Indigenous Peoples, persons with disabilities and marginalized groups;
 - (c) to resort also in the implementation of the plan of action for Major Programme IV to North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation and to continue to develop partnerships with other organizations of the United Nations system and international and regional organizations, UNESCO Chairs, cities networks, civil society, academia and the private sector at all stages of programme implementation, in order to:
 - (i) safeguard cultural and natural heritage and promote culture and the creative economy in response to the global challenges addressed by the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development as well as global crises triggered by the COVID-19 pandemic, by implementing the six UNESCO culture conventions and the three international recommendations in the field of culture, and supporting Member States in translating their provisions into national policies and strategies;
 - (ii) strengthen Member States’ capacities to prepare and address the negative effects and impacts on culture of emergencies, including armed conflicts, disasters and civil unrest, and enhance the fight against illicit trafficking of cultural property through policy advice, capacity building and technical assistance;
 - (iii) harness the potential of heritage and the creative economy to build more inclusive, just and peaceful societies by supporting the protection, promotion, monitoring and measurement of the contribution of culture to the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and the review and adaptation of cultural policies and strategies, through consolidating networks at the regional, national and local levels and promoting intergovernmental dialogue and cooperation;
 - (iv) support Member States’ efforts, including through intersectoral cooperation, to strengthen the transversal role of culture across other policy domains, notably to advance inclusive quality education by integrating culture in educational pedagogies, curricula and tools; address the impact of climate change on culture while promoting the role of culture for climate change mitigation and adaptation; and promote human rights and fundamental freedoms in UNESCO’s fields of competence for open, inclusive and pluralistic societies, and as a

prerequisite to the creation of and access to diverse cultural expressions, particularly in the digital environment including artificial intelligence (AI);

- (d) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests the Director-General:*

- (a) to implement the various activities authorized by this resolution, including through intersectoral cooperation, to achieve the outcomes and the outputs pertaining to Major Programme IV;
- (b) to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 4: A world where culture in all its forms is protected and promoted

Output 4.1.CLT Member States supported in anchoring culture in public policies for inclusive, sustainable development at local, national, regional and international levels, including in the post-2030 development agenda and other international fora

Output 4.2.CLT Capacities of Member States and communities strengthened to protect, safeguard and promote natural and cultural heritage, including tangible, intangible and underwater heritage

Output 4.4.CLT Capacities of Member States and civil society strengthened to protect and promote the diversity of cultural expressions through dynamic, inclusive cultural industries, Creative Cities and museums

Output 4.5.CLT Capacities of Member States strengthened to better prepare for, mitigate and respond to emergencies affecting culture, including armed conflict

Output 4.6.CLT Institutional, legal and technical capacities of Member States strengthened to fight against illicit trafficking of cultural property and to promote its return and restitution, leveraging international coordination mechanisms

Intersectoral Output 4.7 Member States' capacities and awareness raised to protect, safeguard and promote Indigenous knowledge, cultures and languages through inclusive policies and targeted action

Intersectoral Output 4.8 Member States supported in implementing and monitoring the UNESCO Framework for Culture and Arts Education

Outcome 7: A world where new technologies are developed and applied ethically for sustainable development and in respect of human rights and dignity

Intersectoral Output 7.4 Knowledge and capacities of Member States and stakeholders enhanced for inclusive digital transformation, advancing sustainable AI and data governance, equitable access to quality education and diversity of contents.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

36 Jerusalem and the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 32

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 32, as well as the provisions of the four Geneva Conventions (1949), the Hague Convention for the Protection of Cultural Property in the Event of Armed Conflict (1954) and its Protocols, and the Convention for the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage (1972), the inscription of the Old City of Jerusalem at the request of Jordan on the World Heritage List (1981) and on the List of World Heritage in Danger (1982), and the recommendations, resolutions and decisions of UNESCO on the protection of cultural heritage,

Affirming that nothing in the present resolution, which is aimed at the safeguarding of the cultural heritage of the Old City of Jerusalem and its Walls, shall in any way affect the relevant United Nations resolutions and decisions, in particular the relevant Security Council resolutions on the legal status of Jerusalem,

Having examined document 43 C/16,

1. *Expresses its sincere thanks* to the Director-General for her sustained efforts for the safeguarding of the cultural heritage of the Old City of Jerusalem, in compliance with the General Conference resolutions, and *reiterates its concern* as to the obstacles and practices, unilateral or otherwise, affecting the preservation of the distinctive character of the Old City of Jerusalem and its Walls;
2. *Thanks* international donors for their generous contributions to the UNESCO Action Plan for the Safeguarding of the Cultural Heritage of the Old City of Jerusalem, and *calls upon* Member States and the international donor community to further support, through extrabudgetary funding, activities aimed at the safeguarding of the cultural heritage of the Old City of Jerusalem, in particular in the context of the Action Plan;
3. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Director-General for the progress made in the implementation of conservation, restoration and training activities in the Old City of Jerusalem and its Walls, in particular with regard to the development of the Al-Aqsa Centre for the Restoration of Islamic Manuscripts in al-Ashrafiya Madrasa, thanks to the generous financial contribution and coordination of Jordan and Norway, and the refurbishment and revitalization of the Islamic Museum of al-Haram ash-Sharif, thanks to the generous financial contribution from Saudi Arabia;
4. *Recognizes* the concerns raised about the Israeli archaeological excavations and works in the “Old City and on both sides of the walls” of the Old City of Jerusalem and its Walls;
5. *Invites* the Director-General to pursue efforts with the parties concerned for the safeguarding of the outstanding universal value of the Old City of Jerusalem and its distinctive character;
6. *Recalls* that this item is included in the agenda of the 224th session of the Executive Board;

7. *Also invites* the Director-General to present to it at its 44th session a progress report on the implementation of the UNESCO Action Plan for the Safeguarding of the Cultural Heritage of the Old City of Jerusalem, and *decides* to inscribe this item on the agenda of its 44th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

37 **Three Cultures of the Mediterranean Foundation (Spain)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.VII,

Having examined document 43 C/18.VII,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of Spain to designate the Three Cultures of the Mediterranean Foundation (F3C), in Seville, Spain, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the deviation between, on the one hand, the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and, on the other hand, the draft agreement between UNESCO and the Government of Spain;
3. *Approves* the designation of the Three Cultures of the Mediterranean Foundation (F3C), in Seville, Spain, as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.VII;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreements.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

38 **Underwater Heritage Institute (Bulgaria)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.VIII,

Having examined document 43 C/18.VIII,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of Bulgaria to designate the Underwater Heritage Institute (UHI), in Sozopol, Bulgaria, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Approves* the designation of the Underwater Heritage Institute (UHI), in Sozopol, Bulgaria, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.VIII;
3. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement and memorandum of understanding.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

39 **International Day for Underwater Cultural Heritage**

The General Conference,

Recalling 220 EX/Decision 37,

Having examined document 43 C/24,

Considering that underwater cultural heritage holds essential information on the history of humankind and constitutes a precious resource that must be protected for future generations,

Also recalling UNESCO's efforts to safeguard this heritage, notably through the Convention on the Protection of the Underwater Cultural Heritage (2001),

Reaffirming UNESCO's mandate as the only United Nations agency responsible for culture, as set out in the Medium-Term Strategy for 2022–2029 (41 C/4), and *recognizing* the interconnectedness between underwater cultural heritage and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), in particular SDGs 4, 11, 13, 14, 16 and 17,

Welcoming UNESCO's and States Parties' commitments and actions taken within the framework of the 2001 Convention to safeguard and promote underwater cultural heritage,

Underlining the growing threats to underwater cultural heritage and the need for greater global awareness thereof,

Also recognizing the unique potential of an international day to raise awareness, mobilize stakeholders and promote efforts to preserve underwater cultural heritage,

Also considering that 21 August marks the anniversary of the launch of the first multilateral underwater archaeological mission under the auspices of UNESCO,

Further recalling that in 2026, the Convention on the Protection of the Underwater Cultural Heritage (2001) celebrates its 25th anniversary,

Further recognizing UNESCO's leadership role in the field of culture and the importance of mechanisms under the Convention on the Protection of the Underwater Cultural Heritage (2001) in the protection of this heritage, in its understanding and in promoting international cooperation in this regard,

Noting that the proclamation of an international day for underwater cultural heritage will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization,

Proclaims 21 August of every year International Day for Underwater Cultural Heritage.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

40 **Examination of the recommendations concerning public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly-traded cultural object from its country of origin pursuant to paragraph 5 of 40 C/Resolution 42**

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 42, resolutions 6.MSP 9 and 8.MSP 10 of the Meeting of States Parties to the Convention on the Means of Prohibiting and Preventing the Illicit Import, Export and Transfer of Ownership of Cultural Property (1970) and decisions 8.SC 6, 10.SC 10, 11.SC 16 and 12.SC 9 of its Subsidiary Committee,

Also recalling that, in accordance with Article 17, paragraph 5, of the Convention on the Means of Prohibiting and Preventing the Illicit Import, Export and Transfer of Ownership of Cultural Property (1970), at the request of at least two States Parties to the Convention which are engaged in a dispute over its implementation, UNESCO may extend its good offices with a view to reaching an agreement between them,

Having examined document 43 C/26,

Approves the recommendations concerning the modalities of implementation of 40 C/Resolution 42.II, paragraph 5, as regards the criteria and procedure to be followed for public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly traded cultural object from its country of origin, as set out in the Annex to document 43 C/26.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

41 **International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development**

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 45,

Having examined document 43 C/56 Rev,

Considering the intrinsic value of culture as a global public good and a human right, as well as its essential contribution to peacebuilding, inclusive economic growth, education, climate action, resilience, intercultural dialogue, social cohesion and sustainable development,

Noting with appreciation the outcomes of the UNESCO World Conferences on Cultural Policies and Sustainable Development MONDIACULT 2022 (Mexico City, Mexico) and MONDIACULT 2025 (Barcelona, Spain), which, inter alia, reaffirmed the collective commitment of Member States to firmly anchor culture as a component and pillar of just, peaceful, inclusive and sustainable development,

Emphasizing UNESCO's unique mandate in the field of culture, and its responsibility for the promotion, protection and safeguarding of cultural heritage, cultural rights, cultural diversity and the creative economy, in close synergy with education, science, communication and information,

Noting that the Director-General, recognizing the relevance of this initiative, has underlined that no financial or human resources are foreseen for this initiative in the Programme and Budget for 2026–2027 (43 C/5) and that any activities related to the international decade and its possible preparation will need to rely on voluntary contributions and that, at this stage, the cost cannot be estimated,

1. *Stresses* that the costs of all activities that may arise from preparation works and the implementation of the international decade should be met from voluntary contributions, including from the private sector, unless the General Conference decides otherwise;
2. *Notes* that the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development was adopted by the United Nations in 2015, as a shared blueprint for peace and prosperity for the people and the planet, with 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to be achieved by 2030, where culture is reflected across many of the goals and targets; and that the United Nations General Assembly has not yet decided on the extension or further development of the SDGs beyond 2030;
3. *Acknowledges* that notwithstanding the decisions to be taken by the United Nations General Assembly regarding the future of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), culture will continue to contribute significantly to sustainable development;
4. *Decides* to propose to the United Nations General Assembly that it consider the proclamation of an international decade of culture for sustainable development as soon as possible, preferably for the period 2027–2036, within existing structures and with voluntary contributions raised for the decade, to represent a unique opportunity for humanity to use the critical role that culture plays in the pursuit of sustainable development as well as in responding to the complex challenges of our time to ensure a safe and prosperous future for all;
5. *Also decides* to invite the United Nations General Assembly to consider UNESCO to serve as the lead United Nations agency for an international decade of culture for sustainable development, in collaboration with other relevant organizations of the United Nations system as well as other stakeholders;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to prepare a mid-term progress report to be submitted to it at its 46th session in 2031, if the United Nations General Assembly agrees to proclaim an international decade of culture for sustainable development for the period 2027–2036, on the implementation of the international decade, for examination and appropriate action, taking into account, inter alia, its progress, its impacts, the funding situation, resources of UNESCO and the United Nations General Assembly's decisions regarding the future of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs);
7. *Also requests* the Director-General to support the proclamation of an international decade of culture for sustainable development.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025

Major Programme V – Communication and Information*The General Conference*1. *Authorizes the Director-General:*

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for Major Programme V, contributing to the Organization's four strategic objectives and its seven outcomes within the framework of the Medium-Term Strategy (41 C/4), by aiming to support the realization of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), in particular SDG target 16.10, "ensure public access to information and protect fundamental freedoms, in accordance with national legislation and international agreements", and its related SDG indicators 16.10.1 and 16.10.2;
- (b) to contribute to the Organization's global priorities to promote gender equality and address the needs of Africa, paying particular attention to least developed countries (LDCs) and small island developing States (SIDS), and to meet the needs of youth and the most vulnerable segments of society, including Indigenous Peoples, persons with disabilities and marginalized groups;
- (c) to resort also, in the implementation of the plan of action for Major Programme V, to North-South, South-South and triangular cooperation as complementary modalities for delivery of the programme, and to continue to develop partnerships with civil society, academia, UNESCO Chairs, professional organizations, the private sector, organizations of the United Nations system and other international and regional organizations at all stages of programme development and implementation, in order to:
 - (i) promote freedom of expression, safety of journalists and the right to information, both online and offline, and spearhead the implementation of the United Nations Plan of Action on the Safety of Journalists and the Issue of Impunity, with a particular focus on women journalists, as well as foster the development of free, pluralistic and independent media, with an emphasis on promoting media viability and gender equality in and through the media, and supporting environmental journalism by implementing the Global roadmap for information as a public good in the face of the environmental crisis;
 - (ii) promote media and information literacy and digital competencies for all, including to empower citizens, in particular youth, to adopt a critical mindset when engaging with information and digital technologies, and to build their resilience in the face of disinformation, hate speech, violent extremism and radicalization;
 - (iii) foster the building of inclusive knowledge societies underpinned by universal access to information and information integrity, through the promotion of open solutions (open educational resources, open access and open data); the preservation and accessibility of documentary heritage; and the promotion of multilingualism and linguistic diversity, including in the framework of the International Decade of Indigenous Languages (2022–2032);
 - (iv) promote an inclusive digital transformation and an ethical and rights-based development and use of frontier technologies, such as artificial intelligence (AI), in line with the concept of Internet universality with an Internet that respects the principles of human rights, openness, accessibility and multi-stakeholder participation, with a view to bridging digital and knowledge divides, and to enabling stakeholders to actively participate in, and benefit from, innovation and digital technologies, as well as fostering data governance policies;
- (d) to allocate for this purpose for the period 2026–2027 the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests the Director-General:*

- (a) to implement the various activities authorized by this resolution, including through intersectoral cooperation, to achieve the outcomes and the outputs pertaining to Major Programme V;
- (b) to report periodically to the governing bodies, in statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 2: A world where biodiversity, geodiversity, water and the ocean are valued and sustainably managed, in order to face the challenges posed by climate change and contribute to climate action

Intersectoral Output 2.5 Capacity, risk awareness, prevention and preparedness of Member States and communities strengthened for inclusive climate adaptation, disaster risk reduction and resilient societies in line with the Sendai Framework

Outcome 4: A world where culture in all its forms is protected and promoted

Output 4.3.CI Capacity of memory institutions strengthened to identify, preserve and promote documentary heritage and its accessibility among Member States

Intersectoral Output 4.7 Member States' capacities and awareness raised to protect, safeguard and promote Indigenous knowledge, cultures and languages through inclusive policies and targeted action

Outcome 5: A world where freedom of expression and the right and access to information are guaranteed to allow societies to manage today's transitions in a just and inclusive way

Output 5.1.CI Capacities of Member States, duty bearers and right holders enhanced, and public awareness and engagement increased on freedom of expression and access to information, including in crisis settings

Output 5.2.CI Capacities and awareness of key stakeholders enhanced to promote the safety of journalists, particularly women journalists and in conflict and emergency contexts, through United Nations and relevant intergovernmental agreements

Output 5.4.CI Capacities of media organizations strengthened to adopt policies or practices promoting independence, pluralism, diversity and viability, empowering them to address challenges and seize opportunities in the digital age

Output 5.5.CI Multi-stakeholder engagement and collaboration strengthened to ensure information integrity to promote a human rights-based approach to digital platforms governance

Outcome 6: A world of peace and inclusion, free from discrimination, disinformation and hate speech

Intersectoral Output 6.3 Member States, education institutions, youth organizations and media supported in adopting inclusive media and information literacy policies and digital initiatives to build resilience to disinformation, misinformation and hate speech in particular targeting women and girls

Outcome 7: A world where new technologies are developed and applied ethically for sustainable development and in respect of human rights and dignity

Intersectoral Output 7.1 Member States and other stakeholders supported in developing and implementing ethical AI governance frameworks, policies and institutions incorporating human rights, gender equality and sustainability, building on the Recommendation on the Ethics of AI

Output 7.3.CI Policies and guidelines developed and implemented with Member States and stakeholders to expand access to reliable and accurate information through digital public goods, including open solutions

Intersectoral Output 7.4 Knowledge and capacities of Member States and stakeholders enhanced for inclusive digital transformation, advancing sustainable AI and data governance, equitable access to quality education and diversity of contents.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CI Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

43 International Media and Information Literacy Institute (Nigeria)

The General Conference,

Recalling 40 C/Resolution 99 and 222 EX/Decision 19.IX,

Having examined document 43 C/18.IX,

1. *Welcomes* the proposal of Nigeria to designate the International Media and Information Literacy Institute (IMILI), in Abuja, Nigeria, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2);
2. *Takes note* of the tripartite model agreement for institutes and centres under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as endorsed by means of 40 C/Resolution 99, and the draft agreement between UNESCO, the Government of Nigeria and the International Media and Information Literacy Institute (IMILI);
3. *Approves* the designation of the International Media and Information Literacy Institute (IMILI), in Abuja, Nigeria, as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2), as recommended by the Executive Board in 222 EX/Decision 19.IX;
4. *Authorizes* the Director-General to sign the corresponding agreement.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CI Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

44 Report by the Director-General on implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes

The General Conference,

Recalling 39 C/Resolution 42, 40 C/Resolution 58, 41 C/Resolution 39 and 42 C/Resolution 40,

Also recalling resolution 70/125 adopted by the United Nations General Assembly on 16 December 2015 on the overall review of the implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes,

Having examined document 43 C/19,

1. *Welcomes* the report by the Director-General on UNESCO's implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes and its strategic vision for the future, highlighting the importance of ensuring that digital transformation remains inclusive, ethical, human-centric and human rights-based;
2. *Acknowledges* UNESCO's leading role in implementing the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes, its proactive contributions to the twenty-year review process (WSIS+20), and its key efforts to leverage existing mechanisms to advance the Global Digital Compact, with a view to accelerating the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) while avoiding duplication and strengthening coherence across the United Nations system;
3. *Invites* the Director-General to continue reinforcing UNESCO's leadership in the United Nations system within its role and mandate with regard to the green and digital transformations, in line with the outcomes of the twenty-year review of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS+20), by:
 - (i) focusing on normative action, capacity-building and policy advice that foster digital inclusion and help bridge the digital divides;
 - (ii) promoting digital literacy, media and information literacy and lifelong learning to empower all individuals to participate meaningfully in the digital transformation;
 - (iii) advancing a human-centric, human rights-based, open, inclusive and multi-stakeholder approach to digital technologies, strengthening international and regional cooperation in its fields of competence;
 - (iv) integrating environmental and sustainability dimensions into digital transformation efforts;
4. *Takes note* of the relevant United Nations General Assembly resolutions related to artificial intelligence (AI) within the scope of UNESCO's role and mandate, and *also invites* the Director-General to ensure that

UNESCO provides leadership and substantive contributions to international AI processes within its fields of competence, in harmony with the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) mechanisms, and within the limits of existing resources, to include continued leadership of the Inter-Agency Working Group on Artificial Intelligence (IAWG-AI);

5. *Urges* Member States to continue ensuring that UNESCO's role and mandate, and its human-centric vision for technology, are strongly reflected in all international digital cooperation platforms and that the Organization continues to be entrusted with relevant responsibilities in the digital realm within its mandate;
6. *Invites* Member States to enhance their support for the Organization's critical work in this domain and *calls upon* Member States to mobilize voluntary contributions to support the Organization's efforts to ensure its leading role in the follow-up to the twenty-year review of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS+20);
7. *Requests* the Director-General to submit to it at its 44th session a report for debate on the Organization's follow-up to the twenty-year review of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS+20), including progress made in promoting digital literacy, ethical and human-centric approaches to technology, and the integration of environmental sustainability in digital development;
8. *Requests* the President of the General Conference to transmit the report and this resolution to the President of the General Assembly of the United Nations, also as a contribution to the high-level meeting of the General Assembly for the twenty-year review of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS+20), which will take place on 16–17 December 2025.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CI Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)

45 UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)

The General Conference,

Taking note of the report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS) for 2024–2025 (43 C/REP/8),

1. *Requests* the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS) to ensure that the Institute's programme, with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) at its core, maintains emphasis on the needs of Africa, gender equality, youth, least developed countries (LDCs) and small island developing States (SIDS) as well as the most vulnerable segments of society, and focuses on the following priorities:
 - (a) apply the highest professional standards based on the Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics, guided by the United Nations Statistical Commission and the UNESCO Conference on Education Data and Statistics, while attending the challenges of modernizing UIS as UNESCO's statistical agency, to ensure organizational adaptability and resilience to the changing environment whilst promoting quality, comparability and efficiency of data and statistical production in the areas of its mandate;
 - (b) develop standards, protocols, frameworks, tools and guidelines and provide technical assistance to all Member States to strengthen the capacity of their national statistical systems in generating and using the data needed to fuel policies and investments required by the SDGs, as well as UNESCO priorities;
 - (c) support and scale-up innovative approaches to increase ownership by and decrease burden on Member States, while supporting and expanding the use of different sources with the adequate policy frameworks, ensuring the production and use of high quality, accessible, reliable and disaggregated data and statistics by all stakeholders;
 - (d) compile, harmonize and report data expanding the modernization effort by adopting new data sources, analyses, conceptual frameworks, methods, data access and integration techniques, including modern modelling strategies and data science generative AI, with the objective of meeting the evolving user needs for both data production and dissemination, while ensuring the promoting and branding of UNESCO as a trusted data provider and the engagement and capacity development of Member States;
 - (e) facilitate and promote open access to and use of data for evidence-based decision-making using a variety of tools, channels and formats to reach different audiences, with the objective of informing decision-making by countries and other stakeholders, and allow monitoring progress using national benchmarks for SDG indicators, while implementing a strategic communications framework to maximize UIS' full potential;
2. *Authorizes* the Director-General to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
3. *Invites* Member States, international organizations, development and donor agencies, foundations and the private sector to contribute financially or by other appropriate means to the implementation and expansion of the activities of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS);
4. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the achievement of the following outcomes and outputs:

Outcome 1: A world where inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning opportunities are ensured, while strengthening international cooperation for the achievement of SDG 4

Output 1.11.UIS Global leadership in monitoring the SDG 4-Education 2030 agenda sustained to track progress towards SDG4, including with gender-disaggregated data

Outcome 3: A world where the sciences, technology, and innovation are responsive to current and emerging challenges and accessible to all

Output 3.5.UIS Evidence-based policy formulation and monitoring of progress towards SDG 9 facilitated through the provision of timely, globally comparable and gender-disaggregated data for science

Outcome 4: A world where culture in all its forms is protected and promoted

Output 4.9.UIS Evidence-based policy formulation and monitoring of progress towards SDG 11 facilitated through the provision of timely, globally comparable and gender-disaggregated data for culture

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

Programme-related services

46 Priority Africa and External Relations Sector

The General Conference

1. Authorizes the Director-General:

- A. to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for the Priority Africa and External Relations Sector (PAX) in order to:
 - (a) coordinate and ensure cohesion and complementarity of activities and actions carried out across the Priority Africa and External Relations Sector and their alignment with the Organization's vision, strategic direction and programmatic priorities;
 - (b) strengthen strategic, programmatic and operational responses for crisis preparedness, emergency response and support to reconstruction and early recovery in countries affected by natural disasters, conflicts or emergencies;

Priority Africa

- (c) implement Global Priority Africa and the Operational Strategy for Priority Africa (2022–2029) ensuring the consistency and complementarity of programmes to benefit Africa, developed in accordance with the relevant decisions of the governing bodies, and within the frameworks of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want, in order to:
 - (i) strengthen and improve the coordination of actions within UNESCO to the benefit of UNESCO Member States from the African Union, in line with Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy;
 - (ii) enhance future-oriented reflection and foresight initiatives regarding the development challenges and opportunities of UNESCO's Member States from the African Union through analysis and identification of these challenges and opportunities within the frameworks of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want;
 - (iii) strengthen strategic partnerships to support Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy with UNESCO Member States, the African Union Commission (AUC), Regional Economic Communities (RECs) and United Nations agencies, including through the Regional Collaborative Platform (RCP) for Africa, and other key stakeholders including the private sector and civil society;
 - (iv) mobilize and reinforce the partnerships, networks and engagements that foster a culture of peace in Africa, including through the joint organization by UNESCO, the African Union and the Angolan Government of the Pan-African Forum for a Culture of Peace in Africa, "Biennale of Luanda" and through engaging with other initiatives such as the "African School for Peace" in Côte d'Ivoire;
 - (v) broaden and bolster, on the basis of comparative advantages, the complementarity of action with other United Nations system agencies, funds and programmes active in Africa;
 - (vi) promote social mobilization and outreach for the enhancement of Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy, including their increased visibility and strengthened partnerships with traditional and non-traditional donors;
 - (vii) ensure that Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy, including the flagship programmes, are implemented as an integral component of major programmes in collaboration with National Commissions for UNESCO in the African region and feature within sectoral planning processes;
 - (viii) monitor the prioritization of initiatives contributing to Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy by programme sectors, at all stages of programming and implementation;
 - (ix) enhance the monitoring and reporting on Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy to reflect the impact and progress achieved, based on implementation by the programme sectors, including the monitoring of all funds allocated to Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy through a clear and transparent budget tracking mechanism;
 - (x) mobilize voluntary contributions for the implementation of Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy, with specific attention to the establishment of strategic partnerships, including with the private sector, with the engagement of field offices in Africa;

External relations

- (d) consolidate relations with Member States, and to that end:
 - (i) develop relations with Member States, Associate Members, observers and territories including in crisis and emergency situations;
 - (ii) monitor relations with the host country and provide protocol services to members of the Secretariat and the diplomatic community accredited to UNESCO;
 - (iii) continue to support and encourage non-Member States to join the Organization so as to ensure the greatest possible degree of universality;

- (iv) pursue close cooperation with Permanent Delegations and established groups of Member States at UNESCO, which will receive support to organize their plenary meetings, as well as certain groups of countries at the subregional and regional levels having special needs, such as least developed countries (LDCs), countries in crisis and emergency situations and small island developing States (SIDS), which will receive particular attention;
- (v) hold information meetings with Permanent Delegations on a regular basis on major issues and priority activities, and consultation meetings with Member States on strategic issues;
- (vi) continue to provide transparent and easy access to analysis, information and data on cooperation with each Member State, including through a specific website that is updated regularly;
- (e) strengthen intersectoral, timely and adequate response to ensure efficient and effective support to countries affected by crisis and emergency situations, and to that end:
 - (i) monitor crisis and emergency situations; coordinate and provide strategic guidance for the identification of priority interventions and translate those into intersectoral, contextual and timely crisis-responsive programmes;
 - (ii) ensure consistent positioning of the Organization's crisis response and crisis preparedness, in alignment with UNESCO's global priorities and target groups, secure UNESCO's proactive participation in all relevant crisis-response mechanisms at the global and country levels;
 - (iii) provide technical backstopping and expertise to countries and field offices, maintain and pursue partnerships; and build internal institutional and human capacity to address crisis and emergency situations;
 - (iv) support engagement in initial rapid needs assessments, post-disaster needs assessments (PDNA), recovery and peacebuilding needs assessments (RPBA), flash appeals, as well as United Nations coordination mechanisms;
 - (v) lead multisectoral crisis task forces, identify new solutions to improve administrative procedures for crisis response;
- (f) consolidate relations with National Commissions for UNESCO, and to that end:
 - (i) reinforce the capacities of National Commissions for UNESCO including through the organization of the annual interregional meeting, training seminars and workshops for Secretaries-General and other officials of National Commissions;
 - (ii) strengthen cooperation with National Commissions for UNESCO in support of the implementation of the Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5), including through a review of best practices and gaps to identify areas where more systematic collaboration would add value;
 - (iii) strengthen the partnership of National Commissions for UNESCO with the wider UNESCO family and civil society networks, including Clubs and Associations for UNESCO;
 - (iv) reinforce the training of staff of the Secretariat to foster cooperation with National Commissions for UNESCO and partners of the wider UNESCO family; ensure that onboarding of UNESCO staff across all sectors includes information on National Commissions and the wider UNESCO family; and update regularly National Commissions for UNESCO on relevant UNESCO activities;
 - (v) support improved coordination within the Secretariat among units that are managing networks of the wider UNESCO family;
 - (vi) strengthen cooperation with National Commissions for UNESCO to improve the involvement of UNESCO's networks with international cooperation and dialogue;
 - (vii) promote consultations, knowledge sharing and international cooperation between the National Commissions for UNESCO, in support of UNESCO's Secretariat at Headquarters and in the field offices and in support of coordination and information sharing between Member States and partners of the wider UNESCO family; support the reinforcement and pooling of capacities with a view to strengthening intersectorality; and promote and develop best practices in that area;
 - (viii) create, coordinate and share with National Commissions for UNESCO, at the subregional, regional and global levels, a database of experts in UNESCO's different fields;
 - (ix) strengthen support for the UNESCO Associated Schools Network (ASPnet) and the University Twinning and Networking Programme (UNITWIN);
 - (x) encourage Member States to strengthen support for their National Commissions for UNESCO;
- (g) strengthen relations with the United Nations system and other intergovernmental organizations, and to that end:
 - (i) enhance integration and strengthen UNESCO's role within the United Nations development system (UNDS), and its cooperation with other United Nations specialized agencies, funds and programmes, as well as relevant global intergovernmental organizations;

- (ii) lead and coordinate UNESCO's participation in and contribution to United Nations system activities in line with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and other international development and cooperation frameworks, including those aiming to enhance system-wide coherence, globally, regionally and at the country levels in the context of the United Nations reform and as part of the new resident coordinator system (RCS), and in accordance with the specific characteristics and needs of each region and subregion and with UNESCO's global priorities and priority groups;
- (iii) coordinate UNESCO's participation in the United Nations system-wide discussions and collaboration to ensure that the Organization's priorities are adequately reflected in relevant global policy and development agenda setting frameworks as well as in United Nations integrated Common Country Programming Processes, in close coordination with programme sectors, the Sector for Administration and Management (ADM), Bureau of Strategic Planning (BSP) and the field/liaison offices;
- (iv) participate actively in United Nations intergovernmental bodies and inter-agency coordination mechanisms, including in particular the United Nations General Assembly, and the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC), as well as the United Nations Chief Executives Board for Coordination (CEB);
- (v) coordinate UNESCO's participation in the relevant interagency cooperation mechanisms and platforms with the United Nations system as well as with other global intergovernmental organizations, including through North-South, South-South or triangular cooperation initiatives where UNESCO has demonstrated added value;
- (vi) undertake regular monitoring of implementation of memorandums of understanding signed with United Nations agencies and other intergovernmental organizations, and possibly sign new agreements;

Field Coordination

- (h) enhance the ability to respond efficiently and effectively to the needs of Members States in the field through a sustainable field network and to that end:
 - (i) ensure the overall management of the field network in coordination with ADM;
 - (ii) provide support as well as strategic and political guidance to field offices through guidance, coordination, communication and backstopping;
 - (iii) enhance interaction between Headquarters and field offices and among field offices themselves;
 - (iv) ensure strategic engagement in the rollout of the overall strategy for UNESCO's presence in the world, as decided by the governing bodies, in order to ensure effective planning and implementation of the Organization's programmes and actions at the country and regional levels through the UNESCO field offices and to ensure their active participation in United Nations joint programming exercises and initiatives at the country and regional levels in response to national, subregional and regional priorities, as appropriate;

- B. to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and outputs:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.3.PAX Analysis capacity and engagement with Member States strengthened, with a focus on fostering closer collaboration through their Permanent Delegations to UNESCO, established Member State groups, National Commissions, relevant regional intergovernmental organizations, and associate partners

Output 8.4.PAX United Nations interagency collaboration and reform processes as well as partnership with global intergovernmental organizations actively leveraged in support of UNESCO's mandate in line with the 2030 Agenda and other global development and cooperation frameworks, and coordination with the resident coordinator system (RCS) further strengthened for enhanced United Nations country results

Output 8.5.PAX Corporate coordination strengthened to ensure efficient and effective support to UNESCO's field network

Output 8.6.PAX Enhanced coordination, robust monitoring and reporting mechanisms, and strategic partnerships to ensure the implementation of an impactful and visible Global Priority Africa and its Operational Strategy for Priority Africa (2022–2029) across UNESCO's programmes

Output 8.7.PAX Intersectoral, timely and adequate crisis and emergency coordination strengthened to ensure efficient and effective support to countries affected by emergency and conflict situations

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

47 Coordination and monitoring of action to implement gender equality

The General Conference

1. Authorizes the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 UNESCO's Global Priority Gender Equality that is mainstreamed throughout the Medium-Term Strategy for 2022–2029 (41 C/4) and the Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5), and to ensure that this global priority becomes "everyone's business" by:
 - (i) supporting senior management and governing bodies with a strategic function to strengthen UNESCO's normative and policy frameworks, processes and tools and to implement and roll out the Global Priority Gender Equality Framework across all UNESCO fields of competence;
 - (ii) strengthening UNESCO's gender equality structure and programming through a coordination function which creates new opportunities for the implementation of intersectoral action between programme sectors, at Headquarters and in the field, and with corporate services;
 - (iii) supporting the design of flagship initiatives, undertaking research and producing new knowledge on gender equality across UNESCO's mandate through an innovation function that can inspire new policies and programmes as well as inform global-, regional- and national-level debates, advocacy and communication campaigns;
 - (iv) equipping staff with the competencies and skills they need to fully implement Global Priority Gender Equality in Headquarters and in the field through a capacity development function that will lead to policy and legislative technical assistance initiatives, new modalities for peer-to-peer learning, knowledge exchange mechanisms and tools;
 - (v) reporting and communicating on the impact of UNESCO's action for gender equality through a monitoring function that builds on the implementation of the United Nations system-wide tools, the collection of sex-disaggregated data and lessons learned from sharing best practices generated by programme sectors, at Headquarters and in the field, and at the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS);
 - (vi) representing UNESCO in the work of the United Nations and other multilateral and bilateral organizations and forging partnerships for gender equality with UNESCO Chairs and National Commissions for UNESCO, civil society organizations, academia and the private sector;
- (b) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. Requests the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and output:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.8.GE UNESCO's programmes and organizational processes reflect its commitment to Global Priority Gender Equality

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

48 Strategic planning

The General Conference

1. Authorizes the Director-General:

- (a) to implement, during the period 2026–2029, the strategic planning process to define the Organization's focus and orientations, ensuring that its mandate, strengths and comparative advantages are effectively leveraged; this effort will be guided by the priorities set by the Director-General, ensuring alignment and synergies with relevant global development frameworks; in particular, it will articulate and position UNESCO's programmatic contributions within the context of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) for which UNESCO has a leading and coordinating role, while remaining responsive to Member States' needs and emphasizing results-oriented approaches;
- (b) to deliver on this mandate by:
 - (i) carrying out strategic planning, monitoring and reporting for improved programme design and delivery, including coordinating the preparation of the Organization's Programme and Budget and the statutory reports on programme implementation; coordinating quality programming standards, results analysis and foresight for continuous learning and adaptation; facilitating results-based management application; and supporting field offices in the development, validation and monitoring of their regional/country strategies, as well as their engagement in United Nations common country cooperation frameworks with timely technical support and fund allocations;
 - (ii) leveraging partnership and resource mobilization to strengthen the impact and visibility of the Organization's programmes and contributing to the continued development of an enabling environment for partnerships by: strategic partner engagement, including through regular partner consultations and partnerships offerings; maintaining staff capacities in liaison offices in support of partnerships and resource mobilization; elaborating knowledge resources; and refining systems and processes;

- (c) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
- 2. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and outputs:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.9.BSP Strategic planning, monitoring, reporting, learning and related capacities further strengthened to ensure robust programme design, efficient implementation and measurable impact

Output 8.10.BSP UNESCO's partnerships and resource mobilization efforts further enhanced and strategically leveraged to amplify the impact and visibility of the Organization's programmes

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

49 Communication and public engagement

The General Conference

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General:
 - (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for communication and public engagement, and to that end:
 - (i) inform Member States, partners, journalists and the general public about UNESCO's programme and activities, to inspire them and encourage their engagement;
 - (ii) produce editorial content reflecting the impact of the Organization's programme and activities and that of its networks, and disseminate it through all relevant channels;
 - (iii) reinforce collaboration with the media and promote media opportunities for UNESCO leaders and experts;
 - (iv) develop communications partnerships to create multiplier effects and enhance UNESCO's image and outreach and those of its networks, in consultation with Member States and their National Commissions for UNESCO;
 - (v) develop public information and outreach at Headquarters, in particular through the visitors' service;
 - (vi) support the communication and promotion of UNESCO events;
 - (vii) by means of the Publications Board, ensure the quality and relevance of publications, which are intellectual products of the Organization;
 - (viii) develop the dissemination of publications by developing co-publishing partnerships and improving the online sales mechanism;
 - (ix) pursue the open-access policy to provide current, future and past content in an available format compatible with the concept;
 - (x) publish quarterly and in six languages the UNESCO Courier in print and digital versions with the voluntary contributions' funds allocated for that purpose;
 - (xi) continue to provide the book and gift shop services, ensuring that they meet customers' needs;
 - (xii) foster graphical, editorial and technical coherence of the integrated unesco.org web platform, so as to meet the needs of the audiences concerned;
 - (xiii) streamline and coordinate communications expenses across the house, notably regarding communication in emergencies and crisis preparedness and response, to ensure that voluntary contributions contribute to coordinated communication efforts, maximizing the visibility of partners and UNESCO's impact;
 - (xiv) pursue the mobilization of partners, voluntary contributions and other funding sources to accelerate several key communication strategic initiatives, notably in the area of audiovisual content production and broadcasting, as well as publications planning, storage and outreach;
 - (b) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
2. *Requests* the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and output:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.11.CPE UNESCO's reputation strengthened and its role acknowledged as a leading solution provider across its areas of expertise, driving progress toward the Sustainable Development Goals

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

50 Field offices programme management and support services

The General Conference

1. Authorizes the Director-General:

- (a) to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for the management of the field offices in order to:
 - (i) pursue the optimization of UNESCO's field network in alignment with the United Nations key system-wide strategic policy orientations and operational modalities for development cooperation and with relevant resolutions adopted by the General Conference at its 41st session, and any other relevant decisions of UNESCO's governing bodies;
 - (ii) ensure strategic engagement in the rollout of the overall strategy for UNESCO's presence in the world, and implementation of the reorganization of the field network, as decided by the governing bodies, including carrying out the planning and implementation of the Organization's programmes and actions at the country and regional levels through the UNESCO field offices and ensure their active participation in United Nations joint programming exercises and initiatives at the country and regional levels in response to national, subregional and regional priorities, as appropriate;
 - (iii) ensure increased accountability of field offices;
 - (iv) manage the staffing of field offices as regards the posts of directors/heads and core support staff;
 - (v) manage, administer and monitor the implementation of field offices' security and operating expenditures, and reinforce their capacities through support, training and assessment of staffing needs;
 - (vi) provide targeted support and strengthen the capacity of field offices and liaison offices for resource mobilization and partnerships development;
 - (vii) orient, implement and comply with United Nations security management system (UNSMS) field security policies, directives and procedures;
- (b) to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. Requests the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and output:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.12.FLD UNESCO's field network fully equipped and empowered to engage effectively with Member States and the United Nations system, ensuring the implementation of UNESCO's mandate in a manner that is responsive to the specific needs of Member States

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

V Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme

51 Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme

The General Conference

A. Participation Programme

1. *Authorizes* the Director-General to implement, during the period 2026–2029, the Programme of Participation in the activities of Member States, in accordance with the principles and conditions approved by the General Conference at its 39th session;
2. *Invites* the Director-General:
 - (a) to communicate, in order to enhance the presentation, follow-up to and evaluation of the projects submitted under the Participation Programme, to the National Commissions for UNESCO or, where there is no National Commission, through the designated government channel, the reasons for modifying or denying the requested amounts;
 - (b) to inform the National Commissions for UNESCO or, where there is no National Commission, the designated government channel, of all projects and activities undertaken by international non-governmental organizations in their respective countries with support from the Participation Programme;
 - (c) to submit a biennial report on the implementation of the Participation Programme and emergency assistance as part of the statutory report on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference to the Executive Board at its session directly preceding the General Conference session;
 - (d) to ensure that the percentage of the Participation Programme funds for emergency assistance, international non-governmental organizations and regional activities does not exceed 7%, 5% and 3% respectively of the allocated amount for the Participation Programme for a given biennium;
 - (e) to seek voluntary contributions to supplement the emergency assistance programme for 2026–2027 as needed;
 - (f) to identify ways and means of strengthening the Participation Programme in the forthcoming biennium for the benefit of the least developed countries (LDCs), developing countries, post-conflict and post-disaster countries, small island developing States (SIDS) and countries in transition;

B. Fellowships Programme

Authorizes the Director-General to implement, during the period 2026–2029, the plan of action for the Fellowships Programme in order to:

- (a) contribute to the enhancement of human resources and national capacity building in areas that are closely aligned to UNESCO's strategic objectives and programme priorities, in particular Africa and gender equality as well as youth and small island developing States (SIDS), through the award and administration of fellowships;
- (b) negotiate cost-sharing arrangements either in cash or in kind with interested donors to fund fellowships through co-sponsored fellowship programmes;
- (c) explore possibilities of strengthening the Fellowships Programme through partnerships with civil society and non-governmental organizations, with support provided by National Commissions for UNESCO;

C. Reporting

Requests the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and output:

Enabling Outcome 8: A UNESCO where reinforced programming, partnerships and advocacy support programme effectiveness

Output 8.13.PPF Management of the Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme enhanced to better support Member States as well as the achievement of all UNESCO programmes, advancing global priorities and addressing the needs of priority groups

D. Appropriation for the Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme

Authorizes the Director-General:

- (a) to allocate for the period 2026–2027 for the Participation Programme the regular budget amount to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;
- (b) to allocate also for the period 2026–2027 for the Fellowships Programme in order to honour UNESCO obligations under cost-sharing arrangements with donors in the framework of the co-sponsored fellowships programmes the regular budget amount to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

- (c) to allocate further for the period 2026–2027 for staff and operating costs of the Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme the regular budget amount to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

VI Support for Programme Execution and Administration

52 Corporate services

The General Conference

1. Authorizes the Director-General:

- A. to implement during the period 2026–2029 the plan of action for the Sector for Administration and Management in order to:

- (a) be accountable for and enable transparent, efficient and effective management in pursuit of the Organization's results; the Sector will continue to improve services provided to support programme implementation, in all locations, and where possible, improvements in efficiency, quality and timely delivery of services will be made by adopting a risk-based approach;

UNESCO archives and works of art

- (b) strengthen the conservation, restoration and use of the UNESCO archives and the collection of works of art ensuring that proper resources are provided under the Organization's responsibility;

Human resources management

- (c) assess periodically the progress made in the implementation of the Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027 in line with organizational priorities and available financial and human resources;

Financial services

- (d) ensure prudent financial management, maintain internal financial controls and ensure compliance and the production of consolidated financial statements compliant with International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS);

Budget management

- (e) coordinate the preparation of the integrated budget framework, ensure effective budget management, and provide timely reporting to support programme implementation;

Digital business solutions

- (f) ensure resilient global digital operations and quality service delivery, within an enhanced cyber security environment, that correspond to the needs of internal and external stakeholders;

Organization of conferences, languages and documents

- (g) ensure a client-oriented management of conferences, translation, interpretation, production and distribution of documents and publications;

Operational support

- (h) provide support for programme implementation and procurement and the management of premises, including renovation, subject to funding, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee;

Management of safety and security

- (i) reinforce security arrangements at Headquarters and field offices, where appropriate;

Headquarters common costs

- (j) ensure the effective and transparent management of costs for Headquarters maintenance, utilities and common information technology (IT) costs;

- B. to allocate for this purpose, for the period 2026–2027, the integrated budget amount under all sources of funds including the regular budget to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board;

2. Requests the Director-General to report periodically to the governing bodies, in the statutory reports, on the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and the achievement of the following outcome and outputs:

Enabling Outcome 9: A UNESCO where accountable, efficient and effective management and governance help deliver results

Output 9.4.ADM Operational models and practices strengthened to ensure environmental and social sustainability, ensure accessibility, strengthen business continuity, embed robust risk management processes, and enhance organizational resilience

Output 9.5.HRM Effective recruitment, development and employee well-being enhanced for a more diverse, inclusive, efficient and agile working environment

Output 9.6.FIN Prudent financial management and timely financial reporting ensured, maintaining internal controls and ensuring compliance

Output 9.7.DBM Sound budget management carried out in line with UNESCO's results-based and risk management approaches, ensuring compliance with UNESCO's strategic orientations, financial regulations, rules and governing bodies decisions

Output 9.8.DBS Modern and secure digital apps, IT infrastructure and related services to enable data-driven insights, optimize business processes and enhance workforce productivity

Output 9.9.CLD Conference and language services optimized to facilitate efficient programme implementation and strengthen governance processes

Output 9.10.OPS Procurement and contracting functions improved, alongside effective management and sustainable financing of facilities, to support cost-efficient and streamlined operations across the Organization

Output 9.11.SSM Staff security and safety of the work environment strengthened to ensure a secure, sustainable foundation for effective programme implementation and governance

Output 9.12.HCC Global maintenance and utilities

Output 9.13.HCC General IT licenses

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

VII General resolutions

53 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 49, as well as Article 26 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights with regard to the right to education, Articles 24, 50 and 94 of the Fourth Geneva Convention with regard to the denial of the right of children to education, as well as the UNESCO Convention for the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage (1972) and the Hague Convention (1954) and its Protocols,

Having examined document 43 C/17,

Also recalling the role that UNESCO is called upon to act in order to help fulfil the right to education for all, and to meet the need for Palestinians to have safe access to the education system,

Committed to the protection and the safeguarding of monuments, works of art, manuscripts, books and other historical and cultural properties to be protected in the event of conflicts,

1. *Supports* the efforts made by the Director-General with a view to the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49, and *requests* the Director-General to do everything possible to ensure that it is fully implemented in the framework of the Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5);
2. *Expresses its appreciation* for the substantial contributions of all concerned Member States, intergovernmental organizations and non-governmental organizations to UNESCO's action in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, and *appeals* to them to continue assisting UNESCO in this endeavour;
3. *Thanks* the Director-General for the results that have been obtained in relation to the implementation of a number of current educational and cultural activities, and *invites* the Director-General to strengthen UNESCO's financial and technical assistance to the Palestinian educational and cultural institutions in order to address new needs and problems resulting from recent developments;
4. *Also thanks* the Director-General for UNESCO's response to the situation in the Gaza Strip and for the initiatives that have already been implemented with the generous financial support of Member States and donors, and *calls upon* the Director-General to further expand the early recovery programme, within the Organization's fields of competence;
5. *Expresses* its continuing concern at any actions undermining the cultural and natural heritage, and cultural and educational institutions, as well as at any impediments which prevent Palestinian and all other schoolchildren and students from being an integral part of their social fabric and from exercising fully their right to education, and *calls* for the observance of the provisions of the present resolution;
6. *Encourages* the Director-General to continue to reinforce his action in favour of the reconstruction, rehabilitation and restoration of the Palestinian archaeological sites and cultural heritage;
7. *Encourages* the Israeli-Palestinian dialogue, and *expresses the hope* that the Arab Israeli peace negotiations will succeed, and that a just and comprehensive peace will be brought about speedily, in accordance with the Constitution of UNESCO and the United Nations resolutions on this matter, particularly the relevant Security Council resolutions;
8. *Also invites* the Director-General:
 - (a) to continue the efforts he is making to preserve the human, social and cultural fabric of the occupied Syrian Golan, in accordance with the relevant provisions of this resolution;
 - (b) to undertake efforts to offer appropriate curricula, and to provide more grants and adequate assistance to the educational and cultural institutions of the occupied Syrian Golan;
9. *Recalls* that this item is inscribed on the agenda of the 224th session of the Executive Board, and *decides* to include this item in the agenda of the 44th session of the General Conference.

Resolution adopted on the reports of the ED and CLT Commissions at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

54 Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week”

The General Conference,

Recalling 36 C/Resolution 38, 40 C/Resolution 51 and 219 EX/Decision 5.I.F,

Having examined document 43 C/21,

Recognizing the contribution of International Arts Education Week, observed since 2012, in raising global awareness of the importance of arts education and promoting international cooperation in this field,

Considering the adoption of the UNESCO Framework for Culture and Arts Education at the UNESCO World Conference on Culture and Arts Education in Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates (13–15 February 2024), which recognizes culture including the arts as critical to education,

Affirming the role of culture and arts education in fostering creativity, critical thinking and innovation as fundamental competencies for addressing complex sustainability challenges,

1. *Decides* to rename “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week”;
2. *Reaffirms* that UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week will continue to be observed annually during the fourth week of May;
3. *Invites* the Director-General to:
 - (a) promote UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week in accordance with the guiding principles, objectives and strategic goals set forth in the UNESCO Framework for Culture and Arts Education;
 - (b) encourage Member States, Associate Members, UNESCO-affiliated institutes and networks and civil society partners to organize relevant activities in observance of UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week;
 - (c) mobilize voluntary contributions to support the implementation of relevant initiatives and activities;
 - (d) ensure that the revised designation is reflected in all relevant UNESCO documentation, digital platforms and public communications;
4. *Encourages* Member States and Associate Members to:
 - (a) actively participate in UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week through national, regional and local initiatives that reflect an inclusive and holistic understanding of culture and arts education;
 - (b) strengthen cross-sectoral cooperation among ministries of education, culture and other relevant sectors to enhance the integration of culture and the arts into formal, non-formal and informal education;
 - (c) share experiences, diverse practices and innovative approaches in culture and arts education through UNESCO’s platforms, networks and reporting mechanisms.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED and CLT Commissions at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

55 Celebration of anniversaries in 2026–2027

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/15 and Corr.,

Recalling 195 EX/Decision 25 and 206 EX/Decision 30,

1. *Encourages* Member States to improve geographical representation and to promote gender equality in order to improve the quality, representativeness and visibility of the anniversaries programme;
2. *Decides* that UNESCO will be associated in 2026–2027 with the celebration of the anniversaries contained in the Annex to documents 43 C/15 and Corr.;
3. *Also decides* that any contribution by the Organization to these celebrations shall be financed under the Participation Programme, in accordance with the rules governing that Programme.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

56 UNESCO’s emergency assistance programme for Ukraine

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 52,

Having examined document 43 C/20,

Reaffirming the fundamental UNESCO mission of constructing the defences of peace in the minds of all humankind, *Also reaffirming* UNESCO’s key role in ensuring education for all, in protecting the cultural, historical and natural heritage of humanity, in promoting science as a lever for international cooperation, the sustainable development of societies and their well-being, and in facilitating the free flow of ideas,

Also recalling resolution 68/262 of the United Nations General Assembly, adopted on 27 March 2014, resolutions ES-11/1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 and 8 of the United Nations General Assembly, adopted at its eleventh emergency special session between March 2022 and February 2025, United Nations Security Council resolution 2774, adopted on 24 February 2025, and resolution 49/1 of the United Nations Human Rights Council, adopted on 4 March 2022,

Further recalling 7 X EX/Decision 2, 215 EX/Decision 5.I.F, 216 EX/Decision 5.I.H, 217 EX/Decision 4.I.H, 219 EX/Decision 5.I.G, 220 EX/Decision 5.I.H, 221 EX/Decision 5.I.H and 222 EX/Decision 4.I.L,

Reiterating concerns about the deteriorating situation in Ukraine following the invasion by the Russian Federation and the ongoing war and its impact on the people of Ukraine in all of UNESCO’s fields of competence,

1. *Welcomes* the efforts deployed by the Director-General in support of Ukraine and the wide-ranging actions taken and planned by UNESCO in its fields of competence to bolster its emergency assistance programme for Ukraine, within the context of the United Nations system response;
2. *Notes with appreciation* the increased support provided by Member States and partners for UNESCO’s action in Ukraine, in particular through voluntary contributions, in-kind support and loans/secondments of personnel, and *calls for* such support to be strengthened;

3. *Invites* the Director-General to ensure the continued implementation of UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine and, to that end, to continue mobilizing all relevant partners;
4. *Requests* the Director-General to actively monitor the situation in Ukraine in order to ensure direct UNESCO participation in the implementation of relevant actions within the mandate of the Organization;
5. *Also invites* the Director-General to submit to it at its 44th session a report on the implementation of UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

57

Recognition and observance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha at UNESCO

The General Conference,

Recalling 219 EX/Decision 37,

Having examined document 43 C/23,

1. *Emphasizes* UNESCO's commitment to promoting inclusivity and diversity, intercultural dialogue, mutual understanding, tolerance and respect for cultural and religious diversity, in line with the Organization's mandate to foster global peace and mutual respect among nations, thereby contributing to a more inclusive and respectful global environment;
2. *Acknowledges* the profound cultural, social and religious importance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha observances;
3. *Endorses* the designation of these occasions, ensuring that no official meetings under its purview are scheduled during these periods, and *recommends* that all other intergovernmental entities of UNESCO refrain from scheduling any official UNESCO meetings within these timeframes;
4. *Requests* the Director-General to annually disseminate a message underscoring the significance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

58

Revised timeline for reporting on programme implementation – strategic results report (SRR)

The General Conference,

Recalling 38 C/Resolution 99, 41 C/Resolution 75 and 220 EX/Decision 4,

Endorses the revised timeline of future strategic results reports of UNESCO, as provided in document 220 EX/4-INF.2 in accordance with 220 EX/Decision 4 as annexed to this resolution.

ANNEX

220 EX/Decision 4 – Execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference: strategic results report 2024 (SRR24) (220 EX/4 and Corr.; 220 EX/4-INF.2; 220 EX/4-INF.3; 220 EX/PG/1-INF.3; 220 EX/50)

The Executive Board,

1. Recalling 38 C/Resolution 99, 202 EX/Decision 19, 40 C/Resolution 2, 40 C/Resolution 21, 40 C/Resolution 34, 40 C/Resolution 41, 40 C/Resolution 52, 209 EX/Decision 4.I.B and 41 C/Resolution 75,
2. Having examined documents 220 EX/4 and Corr. and 220 EX/4-INF.2,
3. Noting that the strategic results report 2024 (SRR24) covering the period 2020–2023 constitutes an important element for decision-making and programme priority setting with a view to the preparation of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5),
4. Welcomes the presentation of the results against the four strategic objectives of UNESCO's Medium-Term Strategy for 2022–2029 (41 C/4), which provides a more integrated picture of how UNESCO is leveraging its expertise to address some of today's defining challenges;
5. Acknowledges the challenges that the Secretariat faced in assessing results across two separate medium-term strategies, and as a result of the absence of outcome-level performance indicators in the respective monitoring frameworks, and notes with appreciation the Secretariat's effort to provide, to the extent possible, an assessment of the high-level changes to which the Organization contributed;
6. Decides to keep the timing of publication of the strategic results report (SRR) unchanged, namely, in the autumn session of the Executive Board in the third year of the programme and budget (C/5) quadrennium;
7. Also decides to align the strategic results report (SRR) cycle with the C/5 cycle as follows:
 - the first SRR in the eight-year medium-term strategy (C/4) period will report on the outcomes of the two first years only and will include the lessons learned from the preceding quadrennium;
 - the second SRR in the eight-year C/4 period will report on the outcomes of the six preceding years;
8. Expresses appreciation to the Director-General for the Member State survey conducted as part of the strategic results review and consultations for the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5), and takes note of the responses provided by Member States;
9. Also expresses appreciation to the Director-General for the results accomplished during the period 2020–2023;
10. Takes note with appreciation that the Member State responses to the survey and lessons learned contained in the strategic results report 2024 (SRR24) have informed the Director-General's preliminary proposals for the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5);

11. Requests the Director-General to ensure that the lessons learned from the strategic results report 2024 (SRR24), and the Executive Board's debate and its decision thereon are duly taken into account in the preparation of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5).

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

59 World Greek Language Day

The General Conference,

Recalling 221 EX/Decision 39,

Having examined document 43 C/38,

Also recalling United Nations General Assembly resolution 71/328, "Multilingualism", adopted on 11 September 2017,

Further recalling that linguistic diversity is an important element of cultural diversity, and *stressing* the particular importance of the Convention on the Protection and Promotion of the Diversity of Cultural Expressions, which entered into force on 18 March 2007,

1. *Proclaims* 9 February of every year World Greek Language Day;
2. *Invites* the Director-General to promote the celebration of World Greek Language Day, with no financial impact on UNESCO's regular budget, and to encourage Member States, as well as other stakeholders, to participate actively in this event.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

60 Enhancing cooperation with and between National Commissions for UNESCO

The General Conference,

Having examined document 43 C/53,

Taking into account the need to enhance the active role and impact of National Commissions within UNESCO's structure and communication strategy on the eve of its 80th anniversary,

Recalling Article VII of the UNESCO Constitution, which provides for the establishment of National Commissions acting as "agencies of liaison in all matters of interest" to the Organization,

Also recalling the Charter of National Commissions for UNESCO approved by the General Conference by means of 20 C/Resolution 7.4 (1978), and *recognizing* the ongoing relevance of this document in defining their structure, responsibilities and functions,

Further recalling 23 C/Resolution 18.3, 29 C/Resolution 61, 31 C/Resolution 46, 34 C/Resolution 65 and the Medium-term Strategy for 2022–2029 (41 C/4),

Recalling 189 EX/Decision 16, 190 EX/Decision 37, 191 EX/Decision 33, 196 EX/Decision 5.III, 201 EX/Decision 5.II and 222 EX/Decision 48,

Also recognizing the vital and multifaceted role of National Commissions in supporting the coordination of national implementation of UNESCO's programmes and priorities, fostering international cooperation and mobilizing intellectual communities,

Acknowledging the growing role of National Commissions in the pre-selection, designation and review of networks associated with UNESCO which were previously the responsibility of the UNESCO Secretariat,

Noting with concern that the currently unbalanced calendar of initiatives requiring simultaneous action from National Commissions places a disproportionate burden on those operating with limited human and financial resources, and that such structural constraints pose additional challenges to their ability to fully represent the interests of their societies within UNESCO,

Underscoring the strategic importance of enhancing the visibility and capacities of National Commissions in relation to the Secretariat and the governing bodies, and the necessity of embedding their presence more explicitly in UNESCO's global narrative, engagement, partnership and implementation activities,

Highlighting the importance of both interregional and regional cooperation and exchanges among National Commissions for more effective promotion of UNESCO's values and ideals at all levels,

Also recalling the relevance of measures to reinforce the strategic role, visibility and institutional engagement of National Commissions within UNESCO,

Acknowledging with satisfaction the increase in the quality and quantity of regional consultations, online meetings and training workshops for Secretaries-General, other staff and members of National Commissions, organized both by the Secretariat and National Commissions themselves, over recent years,

1. *Decides* that there is a need to ensure the organization of annual interregional meetings of National Commissions, as far as possible in an in-person format, in collaboration with and with the support of the relevant host country's National Commission;
2. *Recalls* the vital importance of the active and regular engagement of the Director-General in consultations with the National Commissions, through means including traditional and interregional meetings and other mechanisms;
3. *Requests* the Director-General:
 - (a) to report every biennium, through means including existing reporting mechanisms, on the international coordination of National Commissions' activities, including the Secretariat's efforts and results as regards fostering, coordinating and supporting such activities;

- (b) to ensure that National Commissions are regularly and visibly referenced in official UNESCO communication materials and press releases, where appropriate, to reflect their contribution to UNESCO's actions and initiatives;
 - (c) to review, in consultation with Member States, the calendar of UNESCO initiatives requiring the support and action of National Commissions, with a view to ensuring a more even distribution of calls for nominations for prizes, fellowships, funds and programmes throughout the calendar year;
 - (d) to promote closer dialogue and cooperation between field offices and the National Commissions of the countries and regions where they are established, thereby strengthening the implementation of UNESCO's programme;
4. *Also requests* the Director-General to establish and maintain a dedicated section for National Commissions on the UNESCO website, providing updated information, best practices, success stories, tools and contact points to enhance transparency and accessibility, depending on the availability of resources;
 5. *Encourages* Member States to strengthen the legal, financial and operational capacities of their National Commissions in line with the provisions of Article VII of the Constitution of UNESCO and the Charter of National Commissions and other relevant statutory documents;
 6. *Invites* National Commissions to contribute to intergovernmental and international civil-society dialogue by sharing innovations, national experiences and good practices that reinforce UNESCO's strategic goals;
 7. *Invites* the Director-General to consider ways of enhancing the capacities and resources of National Commissions in support of their activities and tasks for the implementation of UNESCO programmes at the country level;
 8. *Further requests* the Director-General to report to the Executive Board at its 225th session on the progress of the implementation of this resolution.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

61 World Turkic Language Family Day

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 46,

Having examined document 43 C/57,

Also recalling United Nations General Assembly resolution 71/328, "Multilingualism", adopted on 11 September 2017,

Aware of the Turkic language family's role in and contribution to the preservation and dissemination of human civilization and culture,

Also aware that languages of the Turkic language family are spoken natively by more than 200 million people in several UNESCO Member States in an area of approximately 12 million square kilometres,

Understanding the need to implement more wide-ranging cooperation between people through multilingualism, cultural rapprochement and dialogue among civilizations, in line with the Constitution of UNESCO,

Appreciating the assurances provided by Turkic-speaking States concerning the safeguarding, conservation and celebration of the language family and their active engagement in the promotion of a world Turkic language family day,

1. *Proclaims* 15 December of every year World Turkic Language Family Day;
2. *Invites* the Director-General to include World Turkic Language Family Day, on 15 December of every year, as one of the international days marked by UNESCO, it being understood that this will have no financial impact on the regular budget of the Organization.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

62 Support to Yemen in safeguarding cultural heritage, education, higher education and media in the context of the ongoing conflict

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 47,

Having examined document 43 C/58,

Also recalling the relevant United Nations resolutions and international conventions, recommendations and declarations, including the Hague Convention for the Protection of Cultural Property in the Event of Armed Conflict (1954) and its two Protocols, Convention on the Means of Prohibiting and Preventing the Illicit Import, Export and Transfer of Ownership of Cultural Property (1970), Convention for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage (2003), Convention on the Protection and Promotion of the Diversity of Cultural Expressions (2005), Global Convention on the Recognition of Qualifications concerning Higher Education (2019), Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997) and Windhoek+30 Declaration (2021),

Recognizing that the ongoing conflict in Yemen has resulted in the severe destruction and looting of cultural heritage, the collapse of educational infrastructure at primary, secondary and higher education levels, and the targeting of the media sector,

Noting with deep concern the repeated damage to world heritage properties in Yemen, including the Old City of Sana'a, the Old Walled City of Shibam and the Historic Town of Zabid, and the increasing risks of illicit trafficking of cultural property,

Emphasizing that education at all levels is a fundamental human right and a foundation for peace, resilience and sustainable development, and that digital education and remote learning solutions must be urgently expanded,

Expressing concern about the closure and destruction of more than 3,500 schools and over 50 universities and higher education institutions, as well as the displacement of large numbers of teachers and professors,

Expressing deep concern about the deterioration of Yemen's media sector, the targeting of journalists and restrictions on freedom of expression,

1. *Takes note of* Yemen's adherence to a wide range of UNESCO conventions and related international instruments across the fields of culture, education and communication, as set out in the Annex to document 222 EX/47, which provides the legal foundation for UNESCO's action in support of Yemen;
2. *Calls upon* UNESCO and its Member States to support Yemen's efforts to safeguard cultural heritage, strengthen mechanisms for the recovery and return of looted artefacts, and enhance international cooperation to prevent illicit trafficking;
3. *Encourages* enhanced regional cooperation to support cultural and educational reconstruction efforts,
4. *Urges* the Director-General to mobilize resources for the restoration of Yemen's education sector, including:
 - (a) supporting distance learning and digital education initiatives;
 - (b) assisting Yemeni schools, universities and vocational institutions in acquiring necessary technical and financial means;
 - (c) providing emergency educational support and capacity building for displaced students, teachers and professors;
 - (d) strengthening technical and vocational education programmes essential for post-conflict reconstruction;
5. *Encourages* the use of innovative technologies such as artificial intelligence and virtual reality in heritage preservation and digital education development;
6. *Condemns strongly* the detention of United Nations personnel including UNESCO staff by the Houthi militias, *calls for* their immediate release, and *stresses* that the safety and security of United Nations personnel must be guaranteed at all times;
7. *Requests* the Director-General to implement initiatives to support Yemen's media sector, protect journalists, and revive independent media platforms to ensure access to credible information;
8. *Also urges* the Director-General to prepare a comprehensive action plan covering culture, education, higher education and media in Yemen, in coordination with other United Nations agencies and international partners, with clear sustainability criteria to ensure programme continuity beyond the international support period;
9. *Emphasizes* the need for urgent specialized technical support for the documentation and preservation of damaged cultural sites and the development of emergency conservation protocols;
10. *Also requests* the Director-General to establish a Special Account for Yemen to receive voluntary contributions for the implementation of the aforementioned action plan;
11. *Further requests* the Director-General to report to the Executive Board at its 224th session on progress made regarding the above-mentioned initiatives.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025

63 Impact and consequences of the current situation in the Gaza Strip/Palestine in all aspects of UNESCO's mandate

The General Conference,

Recalling resolutions and decisions on this subject,

Having examined document 43 C/59,

1. *Deeply deplores* the appalling toll of civilian deaths and casualties caused by the ongoing armed conflict, including students, teachers, scientists, journalists, culture professionals and United Nations staff;
2. *Also deplores* the damage to and destruction of infrastructure, media centres, schools, universities and cultural institutions and heritage sites in the Gaza Strip, and *urges* full respect of international humanitarian law with regard to remaining schools, universities, media premises and cultural heritage;
3. *Acknowledges* the progress achieved by the Secretariat in the implementation of UNESCO's Programme of Emergency Assistance for Gaza and *also acknowledges* the importance of the cessation of hostilities and the free and sustained movement of personnel and humanitarian relief items for the successful implementation of the emergency assistance programme;
4. *Welcomes* the financial contributions received from Member States to date and *calls upon* all Member States and relevant donors to scale up funding to the Programme of Emergency Assistance for Gaza;
5. *Requests* the Secretariat to continue to monitor the situation in all areas of UNESCO's mandate and to continue to update the Action Plan with Immediate Implementation for Gaza towards the reconstruction process, taking into consideration proposals made by Member States as well as evolving needs, in order to ensure the implementation of all relevant actions within the mandate of UNESCO;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to organize an information meeting prior to the 224th session of the Executive Board, to provide Member States with an update on this matter and further planning within the fields of competence of UNESCO;

7. *Also requests* the Director-General to report to the Executive Board at its 224th session on the progress made towards the implementation of this resolution and *decides* to include this item in the agenda of the 44th session of the General Conference if the situation necessitates it.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

64

Conclusions of the Youth Forum

The General Conference,

Having examined document 43 C/INF.13,

Takes note of the conclusions of the 14th UNESCO Youth Forum.

Resolution adopted on the reports of the APX, ED, SC-IOC, SHS, CLT and CI commissions at the 13th, 15th and 16th plenary meetings, on 11 and 12 November 2025.

VIII Administrative and financial questions

Financial questions

65 Financial report and audited consolidated financial statements relating to the accounts of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024, and report by the External Auditor

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/40 and Add.,

1. *Expresses its appreciation* to the External Auditor for the high standard of her work;
2. *Notes* the opinion of the External Auditor that the consolidated financial statements give a fair view, in all material respects, of the consolidated financial position of UNESCO as at 31 December 2024, and its consolidated financial performance and consolidated cash flows for the year then ended, in conformity with International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS) and the requirements of the Financial Regulations of the Organization;
3. *Takes note* of the recommendations of the External Auditor and requests the Director-General to ensure the implementation thereof in a prompt and timely manner;
4. *Receives and accepts* the report of the External Auditor and the audited consolidated financial statements of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024;
5. *Confirms* the transfer of all other revenue to the General Fund (GEF), amounting to \$0.9 million, to the Special Account for Capital and Strategic Investments (CSI) in accordance with Article 7.1 of the Financial Regulations of the Organization;
6. *Also confirms* the transfer of the finance revenue to the General Fund (GEF), amounting to \$3.7 million, to the Special Account for Capital and Strategic Investments (CSI) in accordance with Article 7.2 of the Financial Regulations of the Organization;
7. *Approves* the insertion of a new paragraph 11 in the Appropriation Resolution for 2024–2025 (42 C/Resolution 80):
“11. Budgetary commitments related to the 42 C/5 appropriated regular budget (2024–2025) made before 31 December 2025 to be delivered in the subsequent calendar year (2026) shall, in accordance with Article 4.2 of the Financial Regulations of the Organization, remain available and valid during that calendar year (2026)”.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

66 Member States' contributions

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 02 concerning all payment plans agreed upon between UNESCO and Member States in arrears with their contributions,

Having examined the report of the Director-General on Member States' contributions (43 C/41 and Add.),

I

1. *Expresses its gratitude* to Member States that have settled their contributions, in particular those that have paid their contributions in advance or have renounced their respective incentive schemes for prompt payment of contributions to make them available to UNESCO's activities instead, and those that have made efforts to reduce their arrears;
2. *Recalls* that the prompt payment of contributions is an obligation incumbent on Member States under the Constitution and Article 5.5 of the Financial Regulations of the Organization;
3. *Notes* in particular the failure of seven Member States to pay on time the amounts due by them against payment plans approved by the General Conference for settlement of their accumulated arrears in annual instalments;
4. *Urges* Member States, on receipt of the Director-General's request for payment of assessed contributions, to inform him, as promptly as possible, of the probable date, amount and method of payment of the forthcoming contribution in order to facilitate the management of the Organization's liquidity needs;

5. *Urgently appeals* to those Member States that are behind with the payment of their regular contributions, mandatory advances to the Working Capital Fund (WCF) and instalments under payment plans to pay their arrears without delay, bearing in mind:
 - (a) the risk of loss of voting rights at the sessions of the General Conference and of loss of eligibility/voting rights as a Member of the Executive Board;
 - (b) that prompt payment will enable the Organization to manage and implement its programmes as foreseen in the Programme and Budget (C/5 document);
6. *Resolves* that the authorized level of the Working Capital Fund (WCF) shall be fixed at \$36.6 million for the year 2026 and temporarily at \$28,546,536 for the year 2027 and *requests* the Director-General to present a proposal on the level of the WCF to it at its 44th session;
7. *Also resolves* to:
 - (a) approve the carry-forward of budgetary surplus under the regular budget to the financial period 2026–2027 if the 2025 assessed contributions from the United States of America are received by the end of 2025;
 - (b) request the Director-General to present to the Executive Board at its 224th session a detailed proposal on the use of such funds if received, the Executive Board being authorized to approve the use of such funds;

II

Collection of contributions – Afghanistan

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Afghanistan to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Afghanistan that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$76,695 from the contributions due in the current biennium and prior years shall be partially paid in two equal annual instalments of \$1,000 from 2026 to 2027, all payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Also notes* that the Government of Afghanistan shall be required to submit a progress report to the General Conference at its 44th session for the purpose of reconsideration of the scheduling of its arrears amounting to \$74,695 in the light of its capacity to pay at that time;
4. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Afghanistan during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
5. *Calls upon* the Government of Afghanistan to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Comoros

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Comoros to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Comoros that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$365,600 from the payment plan approved at its 40th session shall be partially paid in six equal annual instalments of \$12,000 from 2026 to 2031, all payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Also notes* that the Government of Comoros shall be required to submit a progress report to the General Conference at its 46th session for the purpose of reconsideration of the scheduling of its arrears amounting to \$293,600 in the light of its capacity to pay at that time;
4. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Comoros during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
5. *Calls upon* the Government of Comoros to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Guinea

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Guinea to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Guinea that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$45,641 from the advance due to the Working Capital Fund and from the contributions due in the current biennium and prior years shall be fully paid in one instalment of \$45,641 in 2026, payable by 30 June;
3. *Calls upon* the Government of Guinea to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
4. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Guinea-Bissau

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Guinea-Bissau to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Guinea-Bissau that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$172,533 from the advance due to the Working Capital Fund, from the payment plan approved at its 39th session and from the contributions due in the current biennium and prior years shall be fully paid in three equal annual instalments of \$43,133 from 2026 to 2028, and one instalment of \$43,134 in 2029, payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Guinea-Bissau during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
4. *Calls upon* the Government of Guinea-Bissau to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
5. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Libya

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Libya to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Libya that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$1,031,930 from the advance due to the Working Capital Fund, from the payment plan approved at its 42nd session and from the contributions due in the current biennium shall be fully paid in five equal annual instalments of \$171,988 from 2026 to 2030, and one instalment of \$171,990 in 2031, all payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Libya during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
4. *Calls upon* the Government of Libya to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
5. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Sierra Leone

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Sierra Leone to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Sierra Leone that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$8,266 from the advance due to the Working Capital Fund and from the contributions due in the current biennium and prior years shall be fully paid in two equal annual instalments of \$4,133 from 2026 to 2027, all payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Sierra Leone during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
4. *Calls upon* the Government of Sierra Leone to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;
5. *Requests* the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution;

Collection of contributions – Somalia

Having been advised of the desire of the Government of Somalia to find an acceptable solution for settlement of arrears of contributions due,

1. *Notes* the amount outstanding as shown in documents 43 C/41 and Add.;
2. *Accepts* the proposal as set forth by the Government of Somalia that the balance of arrears remaining due of \$375,123 from the payment plan approved at its 42nd session shall be partially paid in two equal annual instalments of \$3,000 from 2026 to 2027, all payable by 30 June of each year;
3. *Also notes* that the Government of Somalia shall be required to submit a progress report to the General Conference at its 44th session for the purpose of reconsideration of the scheduling of its arrears amounting to \$369,123 in the light of its capacity to pay at that time;
4. *Decides* that payments of contributions received from the Government of Somalia during the second year of each biennium shall be credited first against annual instalments due, secondly to the Working Capital Fund, and then to the contributions due in the order in which the Member was assessed;
5. *Calls upon* the Government of Somalia to ensure that the assessed contributions due which are not under the payment plan are paid promptly on a regular basis;

6. Requests the Director-General to report to it at each forthcoming ordinary session on the implementation of this resolution.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

Staff issues

67 Staff Regulations and Staff Rules

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 4.IV.A and 222 EX/Decision 4.IV.D,

Having examined documents 43 C/42 and addenda,

1. Takes note of the information provided in these documents;
2. Decides to amend Staff Regulation 4.4.1 as follows (*deletions in strikethrough*):
Regulation 4.4.1.
Recruitment and appointments shall be made on a competitive basis following formal advertisement of ~~the vacant~~ posts for a minimum of one month. Subject to the provisions of Regulations 4.2, 4.3 and 4.3.1, and without prejudice to the recruitment, at all levels, of fresh talent, staff members (and former staff members with at least one year's service, separated during the previous two years owing to the abolition of posts) shall be given priority of consideration for vacant posts, on the basis of equal competence. Next priority, with regard to advertised posts, shall be given, subject to reciprocity, to applicants already in the service of the United Nations and other Specialized Agencies, on the basis of equal competence.
3. Also decides to amend Staff Regulation 6.2 as follows (*insertions in bold italic; deletions in strikethrough*):
Regulation 6.2
The Director-General shall operate a system of social security for the staff, including provisions for the preservation of health, sick leave and ~~maternity~~ **parental** leave, and reasonable compensation in the event of illness, accident or death attributable to the performance of official duty on behalf of the Organization.
4. Further decides to amend the Statutes of the Appeals Board as follows (*insertions in bold italic; deletions in strikethrough*):

Procedure before the Appeals Board

[...]

18. If the Appellant has requested a hearing, the Secretary of the Board shall convene the Board to hear the Appeal as soon as possible and not later than six months after receiving the Administration's Reply under paragraph 15 (or, failing such a reply, after the expiry of the time limit for its submission). **As an alternative to a hearing, the Appellant may request that the Chairperson, at his or her discretion, grant a further round of pleadings consisting of a rejoinder and surrejoinder.**

[...]

21. On completion of the hearing **or of the additional round of pleadings, as the case may be**, the Board shall deliberate in private.
22. At the end of these deliberations, the Board shall, by a majority vote, adopt a Report summarizing the Board proceedings and advising the Director-General on what action, if any, he or she should take. Dissenting votes, and dissenting opinions (if the dissenting members desire) shall be stated in the Report. The Report of the Board and the Board's recommendations ~~should~~ **shall** be based on the relevant Staff Regulations and Staff Rules of UNESCO and any other administrative issuance governing the conditions of service of staff members of the Organization.
23. The Secretary of the Board shall forward the Report to the Director-General and a copy to the Appellant, within 60 calendar days following the ~~end of the session of the Board~~ **date of the hearing or of the receipt of the surrejoinder, as the case may be.**

[...]

General Provisions, Records and Reports

[...]

26. The Board shall normally hold two sessions per calendar year **and may convene additional sessions as circumstances may require.**
27. Hearings **of the Board** may be held in person, ~~or via remote facilities~~ **or in hybrid format.** ~~The Chairperson and the Board members may attend the hearings of the Board either in person or remotely.~~ **Having duly informed the Chairperson, the Board Members, as well as the Appellant or his or her representative have the right to choose to participate remotely in the hearing. Any other person whose presence is foreseen by these Statutes may request the Chairperson to be authorized to attend the hearing in person or remotely.**
28. **Both Parties** ~~Neither Party~~ shall have the right to external legal representation before the Board, **at their own cost, by legal counsel registered with the Bar of a Member State of the Organization. Alternatively, the Appellant may designate an active or retired staff member to represent him or her in the Board proceedings during the hearing before the Board.**
29. All proceedings of the Board shall be confidential. Records of the Board shall be confidential and shall be kept by the Secretary of the Board. The report of the Board shall be confidential unless otherwise

decided by the Director-General. An appellant may disclose the report to the Administrative Tribunal. ~~Reports of the Board and decisions of the Director-General thereon shall be communicated for information to the members of the Executive Board in private meetings. Intending appellants who have requested an administrative review under paragraph 9, members of the Board appointed for any particular case and the President or Presidents of the staff association or associations may examine all previous reports of the Board, and decisions made thereon by the Director-General.~~ **Intending appellants who have requested an administrative review under paragraph 9 above, and, when applicable, their representatives who were duly authorized to that end shall be granted access to anonymized summaries of the Board's reports, along with the corresponding final decisions issued by the Director-General. The President(s) of the staff association(s) shall be entitled to consult, on site, the complete Reports of the Board and the related decisions issued by the Director-General, as communicated to the Chairperson of the Board.**

30. **The Director-General shall report annually on the functioning of the Appeals Board to the Executive Board. The Chairperson of the Appeals Board will report annually in an ordinary session of the Executive Board.**
- 31.30. The time limits contained in these Statutes shall run from the day following the receipt of the relevant decision or notification. The Chairperson may extend **the** time limits **under paragraphs 13 and 15 of these Statutes** in exceptional circumstances.
- 32.34. When the Chairperson considers that an Appeal is manifestly irreceivable or without merit, he or she recommends to the Director-General that the Appeal be dismissed. The Secretary of the Board shall convey the Director-General's decision on the matter to the Appellant.
- 33.32. Failure by the Appellant to observe the time limits set out in these Statutes will render the Appeal irreceivable.
- 34.33. In case the Parties agree to engage in informal resolution, the Chairperson may suspend the Board proceedings and the applicable time limits as may be necessary.
- 35.34. All decisions, notifications, rulings and reports referred to in these Statutes may be conveyed to the Parties by electronic means of communication.
36. **Clerical or arithmetical mistakes, or errors arising from any accidental slip or omission, may at any time be corrected by the Board, either on its own motion or on the application of any of the Parties.**
- 37.35. The Director-General may delegate his or her authority under these Statutes.

Appeals by staff members in field duty stations away from Headquarters

- 38.36. ~~The Appellant and his or her representative have the right to attend the hearing either remotely or in person.~~ **When the Chairperson has decided that the hearing would take place in person or in hybrid format, an appellant who is away from Headquarters, as well as his or her representative, may participate in the hearing in person,** provided that they ~~do so travel~~ at their own expense. Upon request from the Appellant, special leave with pay shall be granted, **if necessary,** for the purpose of attending **participating in** the hearing ~~either in person or remotely.~~

Amendment of the Statutes

- 39.37. Paragraphs 2, 6, 7 and 8 may be amended only by the General Conference. The remainder of the Statutes, and the Appendix, may be amended only by the General Conference or the Executive Board.

Appendix to the Statutes of the Appeals Board

[...]

Form

- (a) Surname and first name of the Appellant.
- (b) Nationality of the Appellant
- (c) The Appellant's mailing and e-mail addresses **and telephone number** for the purpose of the proceedings.
- (d) **The Appellant's present or former status with the Organization** (~~Grade of the Appellant, Sector, Service or Bureau to which he or she belongs, his or her duty station, title of post and grade~~ and a statement of his or her duties).
- (e) **Where applicable, the name and contact details of the Appellant's representative accompanied by his or her mandate.**
- (f)(e) The administrative decision or disciplinary measure against which the Appeal is directed, including its **issuing Authority** and date.
- (g)(f) ~~The Date~~ **The Date** of the request for administrative review submitted under paragraph 9.
- (h)(g) ~~The Date~~ **The Date** of the Director-General's ruling under paragraph 10 (or, **in the absence of a ruling, the date by which such ruling should have been communicated**).
- (h) ~~A signed list of documents submitted. These documents must include a copy of the Appellant's request for administrative review, and a copy of the Director-General's ruling on the request for administrative review (or a statement that no ruling was made within the statutory time limit). Additional documents may be included by the Appellant.~~
- (i) A ~~short~~ statement of facts and arguments advanced.
- (j) A statement indicating whether the Appellant requests a hearing, **subject to the possibility of substituting such hearing with an additional round of pleadings in accordance with paragraph 18 of these Statutes.**

- (k) ~~A~~ List of witnesses whom the Appellant wishes to ~~hear-present~~, **if any, specifying the capacity of each witness and the subject matter of his or her testimony.**
- (l) Conclusions and Relief sought by the Appellant.
- (m) **A signed list of the documents submitted in annexes, which must necessarily include a copy of the Appellant's request for administrative review, and, if any, a copy of the Director-General's ruling on such request.**
- (n)(m) Date and Appellant's signature.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

68 Staff salaries, allowances and benefits

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/43 and addenda,

Taking note of the recommendations and decisions of the United Nations General Assembly and the International Civil Service Commission (ICSC) covering the salaries, allowances and other benefits of staff of organizations that participate in the United Nations common system of salaries, allowances and conditions of service,

Noting the possibility that the International Civil Service Commission (ICSC) may, on its own initiative and by virtue of the authority conferred upon it by Articles 10 and 11 of its Statute, adopt, decide on or recommend to the United Nations General Assembly measures affecting staff salaries, allowances and benefits,

1. *Takes note of the measures already taken by the Director-General pursuant to the decisions and recommendations of the United Nations General Assembly and the International Civil Service Commission (ICSC), as set out in document 43 C/43;*
2. *Also takes note of the proposal to authorize the Director-General to decide upon International Civil Service Commission (ICSC) recommendations relating to future salary surveys for staff members in Paris in the General Service and related categories;*
3. *Requests the Director-General to present a detailed proposal in this regard to the Executive Board at its 226th session with a view to its submission to the General Conference at its 44th session;*
4. *Also requests the Director-General to report to the Executive Board on measures taken to implement International Civil Service Commission (ICSC) decisions; and, if there are budgetary difficulties in applying the measures to implement these decisions, to submit proposals to the Board for approval.*

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

69 United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF)

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/44 and Add.,

1. *Takes note of the report by the Director-General on the United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF) contained therein;*
2. *Also takes note of the strongly funded position of the United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF) according to the actuarial valuation thereof as at 31 December 2023;*
3. *Further takes note of the performance of the investments of the United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF) in 2024 and its strong financial position to meet its obligations to all current and future beneficiaries;*
4. *Appoints the representatives of the following six Member States to the UNESCO Staff Pension Committee for the period from 1 January 2026 to 31 December 2029:*

As members

Chile
Philippines
Poland

As alternates

France
Honduras
Rwanda

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

70 Report by the Director-General on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF)

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/45 and Corr. and Add.,

Having taken note of the current financial situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF),

1. *Requests the Director-General to report to it at its 44th session on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF) and the After-Service Health Insurance (ASHI) liability;*
2. *Designates the following two Member States to act as observers on the Board of Management of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF) for the period from 1 January 2026 to 31 December 2027: Egypt and South Africa.*

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

71 Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 65, 221 EX/Decision 5.III.A and 222 EX/Decision 4.IV.A,

Having examined documents 43 C/46 and Corr. and Addenda,

1. *Takes note* of the report contained in documents 43 C/46 and Corr. on the implementation of the Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027;
2. *Endorses* the proposal to transition from a twice-yearly report to an annual report to the Executive Board on the implementation of the Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027;
3. *Requests* the Director-General to submit the annual report on the implementation of the Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027 to the Executive Board at each of its spring sessions as from its 224th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

Headquarters questions

72 Report by the Director-General, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO complex

The General Conference,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 66 and 222 EX/Decisions 34.I and 34.II,

Also recalling the mandate of the Headquarters Committee set forth in Rule 38 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference and in 25 C/Resolution 45 and 38 C/Resolution 92, and its purpose which is essentially to “frame and coordinate with the Director-General the management policy of the Organization’s Headquarters, and to this end give the Director-General all guidelines or recommendations that it deems useful”,

Having examined document 43 C/49,

I

1. *Recalls* that UNESCO Headquarters premises continue to be subject to multiple maintenance and conservation challenges relating to the obsolescence of its buildings as well as its equipment, which exposes the Organization to significant security, safety and business continuity risks;
2. *Acknowledges* that ensuring the long-term viability of UNESCO’s premises requires sustained investment and a dedicated long-term investment fund as this directly affects the Organization’s business continuity;
3. *Expresses its gratitude* to the Headquarters Committee and to its Chairpersons, H.E. Mr Mounir Anastas, Ambassador and Permanent Delegate of the State of Palestine to UNESCO, and H.E. Ms Rosa Batoréu, Ambassador and Permanent Delegate of Portugal to UNESCO, for the decisions taken and the results achieved between the 42nd and 43rd sessions of the General Conference;

II

Takes note with satisfaction of the main maintenance and conservation works completed during the period;

III

1. *Acknowledges* the advancements made on various priority renovation projects of Building V (Miollis), Building VI (Bonvin), restoration of the façades and roofs of Buildings I and III, restoration of the patios, the Piazza and main entry of Fontenoy, renovation of the Miró Hall and replacement of lighting in Buildings I and VI as well as outdoor areas of the Fontenoy site;
2. *Takes note* that phase 3 of the renovation project for Building V (Miollis) is expected to be delivered in October 2025, and that a proposal will be submitted to the Headquarters Committee to establish a provision corresponding to the final amount of validated claims relating to the delay in the execution of the works;
3. *Also takes note* that the renovation project of the Bar, Delegates’ Circle and Gymnasium in Building V (Miollis), initially not included in the renovation plan, is estimated at €5.7 million, to be financed by the Special Account for Capital and Strategic Investments (CSI), and is expected to begin in early 2026, with a scheduled duration of 12 months;
4. *Takes into consideration* the extensive and costly studies relating to the renovation of Building VI (Bonvin) undertaken since 2003;
5. *Expresses its profound gratitude* to the French Government for funding the feasibility study undertaken by the consulting firm Arte Charpentier relating to the Building VI (Bonvin) renovation project, to the tune of €420,250;
6. *Expresses its high concern* regarding the deteriorated condition of Building VI (Bonvin) and the potential risks associated with it, which may give rise to technical difficulties that could impact the proper functioning of the building, in particular due to the following factors:
 - (a) obsolescence of the space and equipment, in particular the heating and air-conditioning systems, the electrical terminals, the plumbing networks and the elevators;
 - (b) non-compliance with French and European regulations in several areas, including fire safety, accessibility for persons with reduced mobility and energy consumption;

- (c) significant presence of asbestos at all levels in a wide range of structures (façades, ventilation, insulation of ducts, car parks, fire safety systems, etc.);
- (d) increasing risk of failure of essential equipment for which replacement parts are no longer available;
- 7. *Further takes note* of the two scenarios 1-A and 4-A retained following the feasibility study by the consulting firm Arte Charpentier, detailed schedules and estimated costs at current prices, pertaining to the complete renovation of Building VI (Bonvin);
- 8. *Endorses* the proposal approved by the Headquarters Committee at its 4th extraordinary session and by the Executive Board at its 222nd session for the complete renovation of Building VI (Bonvin) presented in scenario 4-A (optimization of the core structures, work on a vacated site);
- 9. *Authorizes* the Director-General to:
 - (a) explore the most favourable and appropriate funding mechanisms, including the possibility of taking out a bank loan of an estimated amount of €134.42 million, or other forms of funding such as public-private partnerships;
 - (b) present alternatives for the relocation of the permanent delegations and the UNESCO Day Nursery and Children's Club affected by the renovation work of Building VI (Bonvin), including through the use of all available spaces at UNESCO's Miollis-Bonvin site;
- 10. *Invites* the Director-General to start discussions with the host country with a view to re-examining the adequacy of the current agreement with regard to future financing and lease requirements;

IV

- 1. *Expresses its satisfaction* with the information provided in relation to the financial management of the Headquarters complex;
- 2. *Takes note* of the contents of the financial report relating to the Headquarters Utilization Fund (HQF) for the financial period ended 31 December 2024;
- 3. *Also takes note*, with regret, of the high level of arrears with regard to revenue-generating activities as at 30 April 2025 for a total amount of €3.9 million, 86% of which was relating to arrears in office/parking rents, and *requests* all tenants that have arrears above one year to settle them promptly, to respect their payment plans or to establish a payment plan for this purpose and respect it;
- 4. *Notes with concern* that the level of arrears as at 30 April 2025 represents an increase of 8.33% compared with arrears as at 30 April 2024;
- 5. *Acknowledges* the efforts made by the tenants that have taken steps to settle their rent arrears;
- 6. *Recalls* the importance of respecting the commitments made by all tenants and *requests* the Director-General to pursue efforts in recovering debts owed to the Organization relating to revenue-generating activities;
- 7. *Requests* the Secretariat to continue to disseminate information to Permanent Delegations on the financial implications of rent arrears and on existing provisions in the event of non-payment and *invites* the Director-General to report to it at its next session on the collection of rents;
- 8. *Takes note with satisfaction* of the progress made in the project for automation of invoicing of revenue-generating activities (ARGA) with the latest enhancement concerning the implementation of the "dunning" module of the SAP software system for sending reminders to all tenants with unpaid invoices;

V

Acknowledges the Secretariat's ongoing efforts to provide improved audiovisual and information technology (IT) services to the buildings at the Miollis-Bonvin and Fontenoy sites and to ensure digital security and provide quality IT services to delegations;

VI

- 1. *Acknowledges* the efforts undertaken by the Secretariat to reinforce operational capacity for events management, including the use of the exceptional funding approved at the 218th session of the Headquarters Committee, to ensure business continuity, safeguard service quality and staff well-being and ensure timely delivery during surge periods, particularly in the context of preparations for sessions of the General Conference;
- 2. *Welcomes* the projects to introduce digital tools to support more agile, transparent and user-centred planning processes and *requests* the Secretariat to report on the advancement and implementation thereof;
- 3. *Takes note* of the need to upgrade some conference facilities and *requests* the Director-General to present to the Headquarters Committee a budgeted renovation project as soon as feasible;
- 4. *Also takes note* of the need to assess the staffing model to ensure a sustainable capacity for events management and the proposal to review the business model of the Headquarters Utilization Fund (HQF) and its mechanisms relating to events management to ensure financial sustainability in the medium and long term and *also requests* the Director-General to report to the Headquarters Committee as appropriate during the 2026–2027 biennium and to provide adequate information as required;

VII

Acknowledges the work carried out to update the terms of reference for the tendering exercise for restaurant and catering services in order to have a service provider in place by January 2026;

VIII

Appreciates the progress achieved with respect to improving UNESCO's environmental performance and to integrating environmental sustainability considerations into all policies, operations and management practices;

IX

1. *Thanks* the Director-General for the progress in the conservation of works of art in the UNESCO collection and *encourages* the Director-General to continue developing a comprehensive policy regarding the management of works of art and to report to Headquarters Committee thereon;
2. *Takes note* of the prospective reflection initiated by the Secretariat towards the development of an integrated strategy aimed at the preservation, management and valorization of UNESCO heritage legacy encompassing the UNESCO Headquarters buildings, the works of art collection and the documentary archives, and *requests* the Director-General to associate Member States with this process and to report thereon to the Headquarters Committee;

X

1. *Welcomes* the progress made on the follow-up of the accessibility audit;
2. *Acknowledges* the importance of linking the operational and logistic aspects of accessibility to UNESCO premises with the UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029);
3. *Recognizes* the strategic importance of accessible infrastructure as a cross-cutting enabler of institutional effectiveness and disability inclusion;
4. *Requests* the Director-General to continue integrating accessibility considerations into all renovation and infrastructure projects, to include remedial and enhancing actions within the multi-year investment plan and the Capital Master Plan, as well as into related monitoring mechanisms and system-wide coordination efforts, and to submit the proposed measures to the Headquarters Committee for consideration and to the Executive Board for approval;

XI

Invites the Director-General to report to it at its 44th session, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO Headquarters complex.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

IX Constitutional and legal questions

73 Preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997)

The General Conference,

Recalling that the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers was adopted on 5 October 1966 by a special intergovernmental conference and that the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel was adopted on 11 November 1997 by the General Conference at its 29th session,

Also recalling 215 EX/Decision 24.II, 219 EX/Decision 17.II, 220 EX/Decision 9 and 221 EX/Decision 8,

Having examined document 43 C/31, containing the preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997),

Appreciating the collaboration between UNESCO and the International Labour Organization (ILO) in examining the potential revision of the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966), as well as the work of UNESCO in examining the potential revision of the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997),

1. *Decides* that the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997) should be revised;
2. *Invites* the Director-General to prepare the revision of both the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997), in collaboration with the International Labour Organization (ILO) and in consultation with Member States and other stakeholders and their representative organizations, through various cost-effective measures that combine physical and digital exchanges;
3. *Approves* the ILO/UNESCO final joint procedural framework for the revision and adoption of the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966), as set out in Annex II to document 43 C/31, subject to its approval by the Governing Body of the International Labour Office (ILO) at its 355th session in November 2025;
4. *Also decides* to convene in 2027, *in praesentia*, in collaboration with the International Labour Organization (ILO), a special intergovernmental conference (category I meeting) to adopt the revised text of the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966), subject to the approval by the Governing Body of the International Labour Office (ILO) of the ILO/UNESCO final joint procedural framework for the revision and adoption of this Recommendation;
5. *Authorizes* the Executive Board to take appropriate measures, if necessary, for the successful convening of a special intergovernmental conference to adopt the revised text of the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966);
6. *Further decides* to convene in 2027, *in praesentia*, the special committee (category II meeting) referred to in Article 10, paragraphs 4 and 5, of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution, to review the final report containing one or more draft texts of the revised UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997);
7. *Also invites* the Director-General to submit to it, at its 44th session, a draft revised UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997);
8. *Encourages* Member States to support the revision process of the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997), including through the provision of voluntary contributions.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

74 **Summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 68 and 222 EX/Decision 25.II,

Having examined document 43 C/32,

Bearing in mind that the submission by Member States of periodic reports on the implementation of conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference is an obligation under Article VIII of the Constitution of UNESCO and Article 17 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution,

Reaffirming the importance of the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) and of their implementation by Member States in order to make the full exercise of the right to education a reality for all,

Also reaffirming the centrality of the right to education in the context of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the key role that the implementation of the Convention against Discrimination in Education (1960) plays in achieving Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4,

1. *Notes* that 94 reports, including 92 from Member States, were received for the eleventh consultation on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960), and *strongly encourages* the other Member States to submit their reports as soon as possible;
2. *Commends* the efforts of Member States to ensure the right to education for all, as well as the measures undertaken at the national level to address the continuing challenges faced in implementing the right to education;
3. *Encourages* all Member States to strengthen their efforts to ensure the full and comprehensive implementation of the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) and *urges* Member States that have not acceded to the Convention to consider doing so;
4. *Invites* the Director-General to disseminate widely the results of the eleventh consultation of Member States on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) with networks and specialized agencies through relevant forums, and online through UNESCO's Right to Education Global Database;
5. *Also invites* the Director-General, in close collaboration with the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) and the United Nations Special Rapporteur on the right to education, to support Member States in their efforts to realize the right to education, and *welcomes* the organization of the upcoming international symposium on the future of the right to education (UNESCO Headquarters, 9 December 2025) to advance the agenda on the evolving right to education;
6. *Requests* the Director-General to take the appropriate follow-up action to address the findings of the eleventh consultation on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960), and to initiate the twelfth consultation of Member States;
7. *Also requests* the Director-General to transmit to it, at its 45th session, the next summary of the reports on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960), and *decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

75 **Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978)**

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 70, 215 EX/Decision 24.III and 220 EX/Decision 21.II,

Having examined document 43 C/33,

Bearing in mind that the submission by Member States of periodic reports on the implementation of conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference is an obligation under Article VIII of the Constitution of UNESCO and Article 17 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution,

Reaffirming the importance of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978), as well as of the International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED), its revised versions of 2011 (ISCED-P and ISCED-A) and 2013 (ISCED-F), and ISCED-T, adopted in 2021,

1. *Takes note* of the work undertaken on the implementation of ISCED-P (education programmes) and ISCED-A (educational attainment) (2011), ISCED-F (fields of education and training) (2013), and ISCED-T (teacher-training programmes) (2021) since their respective adoption;
2. *Notes with satisfaction* that the majority of Member States are now using the aforementioned ISCED classifications in their reporting of education and educational attainment data;
3. *Encourages* those Member States which have not yet taken measures to implement the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978) to do so and to provide the required reports on its implementation;
4. *Receives with satisfaction* the report of the ISCED Review Panel and *acknowledges* the recommendations contained therein;
5. *Invites* the Director-General:

- (a) to continue to provide training and capacity-building support to Member States needing assistance to adopt the International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED) and its revised versions;
 - (b) to submit to the Executive Board biennial progress reports of the work accomplished, the next being due at the 225th session;
6. *Also invites* the Director-General:
- (a) to convene the technical task forces to develop proposals addressing the key areas identified for the enhancement or revision of ISCED-P (2011) and ISCED-F (2013);
 - (b) to present the revised ISCED frameworks, incorporating the outputs of the technical task forces, to the General Conference for adoption at its 44th session;
7. *Further invites* the Director-General to transmit to it at its 45th session the next consolidated report on the implementation of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978), and *decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the ED Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

76

Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021)

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 26 and 222 EX/Decision 25.IV,

Having examined document 43 C/35,

Bearing in mind that the submission by Member States of periodic reports on the implementation of conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference is an obligation under Article VIII of the Constitution of UNESCO and Article 17 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution,

Reaffirming the importance of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021) and of its implementation by Member States,

1. *Notes* that 77 Member States submitted their reports for the first consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021), and *strongly encourages* the other Member States to submit their reports as soon as possible;
2. *Invites* all Member States to strengthen their efforts to ensure the full and comprehensive implementation of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021);
3. *Also invites* all Member States to further support the Director-General's efforts to promote and implement the Recommendation on Open Science (2021);
4. *Requests* the Director-General to continue supporting Member States in the implementation of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021);
5. *Also requests* the Director-General to take the appropriate follow-up action to address the findings of the first consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021) and to initiate the second consultation of Member States thereon;
6. *Further requests* the Director-General to transmit to it, at its 45th session, the next consolidated report on the implementation of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021) and *decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SC-IOC Commission at the 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

77

Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017)

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 71 and 222 EX/Decision 25.V,

Having examined document 43 C/34,

Bearing in mind that the submission by Member States of periodic reports on the implementation of conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference is an obligation under Article VIII of the Constitution of UNESCO and Article 17 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution,

Reaffirming the importance of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017), and of its implementation by Member States, in particular in the context of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development,

1. *Notes* that 60 Member States submitted their reports for the second consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017), and *strongly encourages* the other Member States to submit their reports as soon as possible;
2. *Invites* all Member States to strengthen their efforts to ensure the full and comprehensive implementation of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017);
3. *Also invites* all Member States to further support the Director-General's efforts to promote and implement the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017);

4. *Calls on* Member States to support financially or in-kind the efforts of the Director-General to scale up the implementation of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017);
5. *Requests* the Director-General to take the appropriate follow-up action to address the findings of the second consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017), notably through UNESCO's Programme on the Freedom and Safety of Scientists, and to initiate the third consultation of Member States thereon;
6. *Also requests* the Director-General to transmit to it, at its 45th session, the next consolidated report on the implementation of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017), and *decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025

78

Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021)

The General Conference,

Recalling 41 C/Resolution 34 and 222 EX/Decision 25.VI,

Having examined documents 43 C/36 and 43 C/INF.15,

Bearing in mind that the submission by Member States of periodic reports on the implementation of conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference is an obligation under Article VIII of the Constitution of UNESCO and Article 17 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the Constitution,

Reaffirming the importance of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021) and of its implementation by Member States,

1. *Notes* that 71 reports were received from Member States for the first consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021), and *strongly encourages* the other Member States to submit their reports as soon as possible;
2. *Commends* the Secretariat for its multistakeholder and intersectoral actions in implementing the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021), particularly its support to countries in Africa and to small island developing States (SIDS);
3. *Invites* all Member States to strengthen their efforts to ensure the full and comprehensive implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021);
4. *Also invites* all Member States to further support the Director-General's efforts to promote and implement the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021);
5. *Encourages* all Member States to undertake the readiness assessment methodology (RAM) exercise;
6. *Calls on* Member States to support financially or in-kind the efforts of the Director-General to scale up the implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021);
7. *Requests* the Director-General to take the appropriate follow-up action to address the findings of the first consultation on the implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021), and to initiate the second consultation of Member States thereon;
8. *Also requests* the Director-General to transmit to it, at its 45th session, the next consolidated report on the implementation of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021) and *decides* to include an item on this matter in the agenda of its 45th session.

Resolution adopted on the report of the SHS Commission at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

X Methods of work of the Organization

79 Recognition of Kiswahili as an official language of the General Conference of UNESCO

The General Conference,

Having examined document 43 C/54,

Recalling United Nations General Assembly resolution 56/262 recognizing the importance of multilingualism in promoting multilateralism, cultural diversity and international understanding,

Acknowledging United Nations General Assembly resolution 71/328 on multilingualism,

Also recalling United Nations General Assembly resolution 74/135 proclaiming the period 2022–2032 as the International Decade of Indigenous Languages to preserve, revitalize and promote Indigenous languages,

Further recalling 41 C/Resolution 53 and United Nations General Assembly resolution 78/312 on the proclamation of 7 July of each year as World Kiswahili Language Day,

Cognizant of the adoption of Kiswahili as an official language of the African Union in February 2022, fostering regional integration and African identity,

Noting that Kiswahili is also an official language of the East African Community (EAC) and the Southern African Development Community (SADC),

Recognizing the importance of the Kiswahili language as a unifying factor, beacon for peace and enhanced multiculturalism, a tool for multilingual education and shared cultural identities and an instrument for growing diplomatic relations,

Pursuant to Rule 52, paragraph 2 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, which stipulates that Member States are entitled to request the recognition of a language as an official language of the General Conference,

Decides to add the Kiswahili language to the list of official languages of the General Conference of UNESCO.

Resolution adopted on the report of the LEG Committee at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

80 Follow-up to 42 C/Resolution 35 and prospects for the UNESCO conventions in the field of culture

The General Conference,

Having examined document 43 C/28,

Recalling 39 C/Resolution 87, 41 C/Resolution 74, 42 C/Resolution 35 and the recommendations of the open-ended working group on governance, procedures and working methods of the governing bodies of UNESCO contained in document 39 C/70 related to UNESCO's conventions in the field of culture,

Also recalling that Recommendation 96 of the working group on governance invites governing bodies of the conventions, through broad consultations, to further explore, as appropriate, harmonization of rules of procedure and coherence in decision-making procedures, taking into account their respective mandates and specificities,

Takes note of the processes conducted by the assemblies of UNESCO's conventions in the field of culture to revise their rules of procedure.

Resolution adopted on the report of the CLT Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

81 Revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee

The General Conference,

Recalling 35 C/Resolution 101, 217 EX/Decision 18, 220 EX/Decision 28 and 221 EX/Decision 28,

Having examined document 43 C/29,

1. *Welcomes* the revised Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC) proposed by the Director-General, and the Executive Board's endorsement thereof;
2. *Adopts* the revised Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC) as annexed to the report of the APX Commission in Chapter XIII to the present volume.

Resolution adopted on the report of the APX Commission at the 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025.

82 Report by the Executive Board on its own activities and programme implementation: activities in 2024–2025, including its methods of work

The General Conference,

Having examined documents 43 C/9.I and corrigenda,

Recalling 30 C/Resolution 81, 31 C/Resolution 71, 33 C/Resolution 92, 156 EX/Decision 5.5 paragraph 6.C(a), 180 EX/Decision 26, 186 EX/Decision 17.I(IV), 197 EX/Decision 28, 197 EX/Decision 44,

Also recalling 39 C/Resolution 87, 40 C/Resolution 95 and 41 C/Resolution 72 related to “governance, procedures and working methods of the governing bodies of UNESCO”, especially the follow-up and implementation of the recommendations endorsed by it in 39 C/Resolution 87,

1. *Endorses* the report by the Executive Board on its own activities and on programme implementation in 2024–2025, including its methods of work, contained in documents 43 C/9.I and corrigenda;
2. *Emphasizes* the need for an assessment of the implementation of the aforementioned resolutions, in particular 39 C/Resolution 87, and a review and improvement of the procedures and methods of work of the governing bodies, resource allocation and the role of the Secretariat in all its aspects in supporting their work;
3. *Decides* to establish, for this purpose an open-ended working group co-chaired by the President of the General Conference and the Chairperson of the Executive Board;
4. *Also decides* that the open-ended working group shall:
 - (i) Assess the implementation of the recommendations endorsed by the General Conference in 39 C/Resolution 87;
 - (ii) review the procedures and methods of work of the governing bodies of UNESCO, taking into account the recommendations in documents 43 C/9.I and corrigenda;
 - (iii) consider the information provided by the Director-General, pursuant to paragraph 5 of this resolution, and make use of relevant reports of the external auditors, Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) and Joint Inspection Unit (JIU) to enable informed deliberations and decisions;
 - (iv) also consider the report of the Chairperson of the Executive Board on the informal meeting on methods of work of the Executive Board (26 May 2025);
5. *Invites* the Director-General to provide information regarding the Secretariat’s support in terms of, *inter alia*, staffing and budget of the governing bodies, and his views on enhancing support extended by the Secretariat to the governing bodies, and *requests* him to provide appropriate Secretariat support to the open-ended working group;
6. *Further decides* that the open-ended working group will work within available resources and appoint Vice-Chairpersons from all the regional groups at its first meeting;
7. *Requests* the open-ended working group to submit its recommendations to the Executive Board at its 225th session with a view to:
 - (i) the adoption of the recommendations pertaining to the working methods of the Executive Board at the 225th session of the Board;
 - (ii) the finalization of the recommendations for the working methods of the General Conference for submission to it at its 44th session.

Resolution adopted at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

83 Report by the Executive Board on its own activities and programme implementation: implementation of the current Programme and Budget (42 C/5) with results achieved in 2022–2025

The General Conference,

Having examined document 43 C/9.II,

Endorses the report contained therein by the Executive Board on the implementation of the current Programme and Budget (42 C/5) with results achieved in 2022–2025.

Resolution adopted at the 1st plenary meeting, on 30 October 2025.

XI Budget 2026–2027

84 Appropriation resolution for 2026–2027

The General Conference

Resolves that:

1. For the financial period 2026–2027, an integrated budget framework (IBF) of \$1,813,935,670, after offsetting, and including all sources of funds is approved.
2. The budget under document 43 C/5 will not determine the budget ceiling for document 44 C/5.
3. The above-mentioned integrated budget framework (IBF) shall be financed as follows:
 - (a) by regular budget appropriations amounting to \$610,045,936 to be financed by assessments on Member States; and
 - (b) by other funds amounting to \$1,203,889,734 (after offsetting) consisting of revenue-generating funds and voluntary contributions, including the management costs charged thereon, on the understanding that the amounts for these funds represent estimates of planned expenditures, which are to be funded by resources available to spend as well as resources subject to being earned or mobilized in alignment with document 43 C/5.
4. In accordance with paragraph 3 (a) above, Member States shall be assessed \$342,722,436 in 2026 and \$267,323,500 in 2027. The General Conference takes the decision to assess different amounts on Member States in 2026 and 2027, arising from the exceptional circumstance of a reduced budget ceiling to account for the contribution for which two Member States withdrawing from the Organization would have been assessed in 2027.
5. The regular budget for the 2026–2027 financial period shall be supplemented with a one-off appropriation of \$23 million from the residual balance of the Special Account for Management Costs (MCA) and the use of \$8,053,464 constituted by the Working Capital Fund (WCF) advance of the two Member States withdrawing from the Organization. The Director-General shall present for approval by the Executive Board at its 224th session the proposed mechanism and allocations for the use of these funds.
6. The Director-General shall also present to the Executive Board at its 224th session the complete revised 43 C/5 documentation, including updates to the results framework, milestones and targets corresponding to the approved budget ceiling, an expenditure plan, and resource distribution by output and source of funds.
7. The Executive Board, as a one-time exception, is given delegated authority to approve at its 224th session the 2026–2027 Budget by appropriation line within the overall budget ceiling approved by the General Conference.
8. The Director-General shall further present for approval by the Executive Board at its 224th session the full details of an expenditure plan of \$534.6 million for the 2026–2027 regular budget to be implemented in the event of non-payment of assessed contributions by the Member States withdrawing from the Organization.

Budgetary commitments

9. With regard to the appropriated regular budget, the Director-General is authorized to enter into commitments during the financial period 1 January 2026 to 31 December 2027, within the limits of the amounts authorized. The budgetary commitments related to the appropriated regular budget (2026–2027) under document 43 C/5 made before 31 December 2027 to be delivered in the subsequent calendar year (2028) shall, in accordance with Article 4.2 of the Financial Regulations, remain available and valid during that calendar year.
10. The Director-General is authorized to make an initial allocation of funds of a maximum amount of \$100 million at the beginning of the biennium to cover mission-critical activities to ensure the effective functioning of the Organization, pending the approval by the Executive Board of the budget by appropriation line and the expenditure plan.

Budget adjustments and transfers

11. With the prior approval of the Executive Board, the Director-General is authorized to make transfers from Part V (contingency reserve) of the appropriated regular budget to the relevant appropriation lines in Parts I–IV, for the purpose of meeting increases in staff costs, the cost of goods and services, and additional requirements that may arise during the financial period 2026–2027.
12. With regard to the appropriated regular budget, the Director-General may make transfers between appropriation lines up to an amount of 5% of the initial appropriated regular budget line from which the transfers are made, without prejudice to any major programme. The Director-General shall inform the Executive Board, in writing at the session following such action, of the details and reasons for these transfers. If such transfers entail an outgoing amount exceeding 5% of the initial appropriated regular budget line, the Director-General shall obtain prior approval of the Executive Board. The prior approval of the Executive Board

shall also be required for transfers exceeding 5% of the initial appropriated regular budget funding of each outcome under the major programmes and the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC).

13. The Director-General is authorized to transfer from the regular budget appropriations such amounts¹ as approved by the Executive Board at its 224th session.

Special Account for Management Costs

14. In relation to the Special Account for Management Costs (MCA), the Director-General is authorized to make budget increases of up to 2% of the total amount of the approved management costs budget, informing the Executive Board in writing, through the annual C/5 Implementation Report, of the details and reasons for such increases. If such increases exceed 2%, the Director-General shall obtain prior approval of the Executive Board.

Established posts

15. The established posts by grade foreseen for the 2026–2027 biennium shall be presented in revised document 43 C/5, to be approved by the Executive Board. The Director-General shall present to the Executive Board for prior approval any change in respect of the total number of posts of grade D-1 and above.
16. In accordance with their specific statutes and regulations, posts may be established at the category 1 institutes of UNESCO.

Currency of assessment

17. Where the annual assessed contribution for a Member State is less than \$200,000, that Member State's contribution to the budget shall be assessed in United States dollars only.
18. Where the annual assessed contribution for a Member State is \$200,000 or more, that Member State's contribution shall be assessed in both euros and United States dollars in accordance with the split percentage, which is determined by the estimated costs to be incurred in the respective currencies.
19. In view of the estimated euro requirements for document 43 C/5, the regular budget is assessed in accordance with the same split percentage as for document 42 C/5, that is, 47% in euros and 53% in United States dollars, calculated at the budget rate.

Budget rate

20. The estimates for the appropriated regular budget used in preparing the budget have been calculated at \$1 equal to 0.913 euro. From a budgetary perspective, expenditure incurred in euros shall be recorded against the budget at the same budget rate of \$1 to 0.913 euro.

Resolution adopted on the report of the joint meeting of commissions at the 17th plenary meeting, on 13 November 2025.

85 Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles

The General Conference,

Recalling 222 EX/Decision 21,

Having examined document 43 C/64,

I

1. *Requests* the Director-General to prepare for the consideration of the Executive Board at its 224th session:
 - (a) a strategic plan for the Organization taking into account the guidelines provided herein and aligning with the ongoing UN80 initiative of the Secretary-General of the United Nations for identifying efficiencies, reviewing how mandates are implemented and examining potential structural changes;
 - (b) a comprehensive strategy to reduce non-mission-critical administrative costs across the Organization while preserving programme delivery, and proposed budgetary reductions;
 - (c) a transition plan to a long-term, sustainable regular budget once the supplementary funds from the residual reserves of the Special Account for Management Costs (MCA) and Working Capital Fund (WCF) advance have been fully disbursed;
2. *Notes* the options presented in Annex II of document 222 EX/21 for the development of a detailed expenditure plan;
3. *Requests* that, under a reduced regular budget, cuts to programmes and programme-related services should take into consideration each programme's capacity to absorb cost reductions in consultation with Member States;
4. *Underscores* the importance of ensuring sharper programme focus on areas of recognized comparative advantage and on lead roles in the multilateral field, and in this regard to guarantee the proper functioning as in document 42 C/5 for the statutory meetings of the UNESCO conventions and their respective secretariats;
5. *Recalls* that by means of 216 EX/Decision 44 the Executive Board recommended that the General Conference at its 42nd session agree to an increase in the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission's (IOC) share of the UNESCO regular budget of [1%], not to be decreased by transfers of funds to other parts of the budget and that a baseline be identified and agreed for IOC's share of UNESCO's regular budget under document 42 C/5 and future C/5 documents and that no reduction to this baseline be made in the future unless agreed

¹ Such amounts include transfers to the Special Accounts for: Management Costs, category 1 institutes, After-Service Health Insurance, Terminal Payments Fund, Capital and Strategic Investments, Environmental Action, Staff Compensation Fund and UNESCO Children's Club and Day Nursery.

- by the General Conference; and *recommits* to 216 EX/Decision 44 in order to ensure that IOC receives no less than 3% of the available overall regular budget;
6. *Also requests* the Director-General to maintain the current proportion of resources committed to advancing UNESCO's global priorities Africa and gender equality and priority groups small island developing States (SIDS) and youth, as well as to reinforcing intersectoral cooperation to respond better to the complexities of today's challenges;
 7. *Decides* that, in a constrained financial environment, the limited resources available in the regular budget shall be allocated to the priorities enshrined in the approved Programme and Budget unless the Executive Board decides otherwise, and *also decides* that decisions adopted by the Executive Board with the understanding that they are to be financed solely with voluntary contributions cannot be implemented with resources from the regular budget, unless the Executive Board decides otherwise;
 8. *Invites* the Director-General to:
 - (a) continue to apply an After-Service Health Insurance (ASHI) charge of 1% and to postpone the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 64, which called for a progressive increase of the percentage for one biennium, until the financial situation of the Organization improves;
 - (b) maintain the overall target of 3% of programme expenditure from both regular budget resources and voluntary contributions for evaluation in accordance with the UNESCO evaluation policy 2022–2029;
 - (c) reconsider the level of the lapse factor;
 - (d) maintain the proposed contingency reserve of \$3.5 million;
 - (e) review the level of assessment for the financing of capital expenditure and maintain the principle of including a capital assessment in the C/5 document to build a reserve of \$100 million over five biennia in the Special Account for Capital and Strategic Investments (CSI);
 - (f) continue applying prudent financial management and efficiency-increasing measures in respect of temporary assistance, consultancies, travel, meetings and conferences, publications and other printed materials;
 - (g) step up significantly the coordinated mobilization of voluntary contributions, which remain unpredictable and tightly earmarked, and ensure that sufficient resources are allocated to fundraising activities to complement regular budget resources available for core priority programmes;
 - (h) leverage the use of modern digital tools to simplify business processes, including through the development of a "One UNESCO" approach;
 - (i) identify innovative solutions to finance the development of digital business solutions, stressing the importance of fully implementing the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) audit recommendations regarding the Core Systems Redesign Programme (UNESCORE), and to cover the recurrent operational costs, including through applying a proportional charge on all license users;
 9. *Also invites* the Director-General to:
 - (a) fully implement the human resources strategy in the implementation of document 43 C/5 (UNESCO Competency Framework, workforce planning and upskilling) particularly with regard to equitable geographical distribution and gender balance at grade D-1 and above, based on merit;
 - (b) consider conducting a review of operational requirements and of the competencies and skills of the available workforce and, as appropriate, redefine posts based on skills and operational needs, with a view to shifting resources to mission-critical functions and increasing efficiency as well as productivity;
 - (c) within the context of the UN80 Initiative and in consultation with staff associations, consider reviewing and restructuring operational and programmatic structures to strengthen the Organization's effectiveness, efficiency and relevance for today's challenges;
 10. *Further requests* the Director-General to:
 - (a) pursue efforts to further decentralize UNESCO's work and resource mobilization activities to strengthen the field network in line with the overall strategy for UNESCO's presence in the world, taking into consideration the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) recommendations;
 - (b) present innovative solutions to pursue the reinforcement of the field network and to improve programme delivery on the ground and provide more responsive support to Member States while implementing a clearly defined accountability framework for field offices and Headquarters;
 11. *Invites* the governing bodies, in the light of the current challenging financial situation, to continue streamlining their working methods in order to rationalize the operational costs of intergovernmental committees, without jeopardizing the quality of the work;

II

Recognizing that the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) is established as a body with functional autonomy within UNESCO, with the IOC Assembly being the principal organ under the IOC Statutes adopted by the General Conference at its 30th session,

1. *Takes note* of IOC Assembly Resolution A-33/3.II on the Draft Programme and Budget for the first biennium (2026–2027) of the 2026–2029 quadrennium (43 C/5) and *decides* to include in document 43 C/5 Approved the relevant elements of the IOC Results Framework, as determined by the IOC Assembly and presented in Part II of document IOC/A-33/5.1.Doc(1);
2. *Also takes note* of IOC Assembly Resolution A-33/3.III on the assessment of governance and management processes;

3. *Invites* the Director-General to contribute to the full implementation of the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission's (IOC) functions as established in its Statutes as well as the tasks assigned to the IOC Secretariat, including by the delegation of authority to the Executive Secretary of IOC, when applicable;
4. *Invites* the Executive Secretary of IOC to submit draft sections relating to the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) in Volumes 1 and 2 of future draft Programme and Budget documents (draft C/5 documents) to the IOC Assembly;
5. *Also invites* the Director-General to forward the IOC Assembly's recommendations concerning the sections relating to the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) in Volumes 1 and 2 of future draft Programme and Budget documents (draft C/5 documents) to the Executive Board for transmission to the General Conference as part of the C/6 document.

Resolution adopted on the report of the joint meeting of commissions at the 17th plenary meeting, on 13 November 2025

XII 44th session of the General Conference

86 Venue of the 44th session of the General Conference

The General Conference,

Having regard to the provisions of Rules 2 and 3 of its Rules of Procedure,

Considering that, on the date fixed by Rule 3, no Member State had invited the General Conference to hold its 44th session in its territory,

Recalling 42 C/Resolution 82 (2023) requesting the Director-General to conduct, following its 43rd session, an evaluation and performance audit on the organization of the General Conference session away from Headquarters, to be presented to the Executive Board at its 224th session,

Decides to hold its 44th session at the Headquarters of the Organization in Paris.

Resolution adopted at the 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

XIII Reports of the programme commissions, the APX Commission (Finance, administration and general questions, programme support and external relations), the joint meeting of commissions and the Legal Committee

NOTE

The reports of the APX Commission and the five programme commissions (sections A-F below) were submitted to the General Conference, in plenary meeting, in the following documents: 43 C/70, 43 C/71, 43 C/72, 43 C/73, 43 C/74 and 43 C/75.

The proposals of the joint meeting of the programme commissions and the APX Commission (section G below) were submitted to the General Conference, in plenary meeting, in document 43 C/76.

The 10 reports of the Legal Committee (43 C/81 – 43 C/90) are presented in section H below.

The final text of the resolutions adopted by the General Conference on the recommendation of the commissions and the committees is reproduced in full in the preceding chapters of this volume. The numbers finally given to the resolutions are shown in parentheses. Other decisions taken by the General Conference on the recommendation of the commissions and the committees are reflected in their respective reports, which are contained in this chapter.

A. Report of the APX Commission (Financial, Administrative and General Questions, Programme Support and External Relations)¹

INTRODUCTION

ORGANIZATION OF THE SESSION

- Item 1.2 Report by the Director-General on communications received from Member States invoking the provisions of Article IV.C, paragraph 8(c), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
- Part I General policy and direction
 - Part II.A UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)
 - Part II.B Programme-related services
 - Priority Africa and External Relations Sector
 - Coordination and monitoring of action to implement gender equality
 - Strategic planning
 - Communication and public engagement
 - Field offices - programme management and support services
 - Part II.C Participation Programme and fellowships
 - Part III Corporate services
 - Part III.A Sector for Administration and Management
 - Part III.B Headquarters common costs
 - Part IV Loan repayment for capital expenditure
 - Part V Contingency reserve
 - Part VI Assessment for the financing of capital expenditure

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.1 Proposals by Member States concerning the celebration of anniversaries with which UNESCO could be associated in 2026–2027
- Item 4.6 UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine
- Item 4.9 Recognition and observance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha at UNESCO
- Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
- Item 4.12 Revised timeline for reporting on programme implementation – strategic results report (SRR)
- Item 4.16 World Greek Language Day
- Item 4.22 Enhancing cooperation with and between National Commissions for UNESCO
- Item 4.25 World Turkic Language Family Day
- Item 4.26 Support to Yemen in safeguarding cultural heritage, education, higher education and media in the context of the ongoing conflict

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025 and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.20.

- Item 4.27 Impact and consequences of the current situation in the Gaza Strip/Palestine in all aspects of UNESCO's mandate

METHODS OF WORK OF THE ORGANIZATION

- Item 5.2 Revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC)

ADMINISTRATIVE AND FINANCIAL QUESTIONS

- Item 8.1 Financial report and audited consolidated financial statements relating to the accounts of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024, and report by the External Auditor

- Item 8.2 Member States' contributions

STAFF ISSUES

- Item 9.1 Staff Regulations and Staff Rules

- Item 9.2 Staff salaries, allowances and benefits

- Item 9.3 United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF)

- Item 9.4 Report by the Director-General on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF)

- Item 9.5 Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027

HEADQUARTERS QUESTIONS

- Item 10.1 Report by the Director-General, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO complex

- Annex** Revised Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC)

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Dec.24.IV) and the recommendations of the Nominations Committee, on 31 October 2025, at their joint meeting, the Commissions elected Ms Jolanta Balčiūnienė (Lithuania) to the office of Chairperson of the APX Commission.

2. At their joint meeting, the commissions also approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons of the APX Commission. The following persons were elected by acclamation:

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Monique van Daalen (Netherlands (Kingdom of the))

Ms Yeoul Kang (Republic of Korea)

Mr Ali Jabir Mwadini (United Republic of Tanzania)

3. The Commission then adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.APX/1 Prov. Rev.

4. The Commission devoted seven meetings, held between 31 October 2025 and 4 November 2025, to the examination of the 21 items on its agenda.

5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

ORGANIZATION OF THE SESSION

Item 1.2 Report by the Director-General on communications received from Member States invoking the provisions of Article IV.C, paragraph 8(c), Article V.A, paragraph 1(b), and Article V.C, paragraph 14(b), of the Constitution (43 C/10)

6. The APX Commission examined item 1.2 at its first meeting and considered the report of the working group on contributions established as provided by Rule 80 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference¹. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/10, with amendments. Upon the report of the Chairperson of the APX Commission, the resolution was adopted by the General Conference at its fifth plenary meeting (43 C/Resolution 02).

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.1, 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.4, 43 C/DR.5)

7. The APX Commission examined item 3.1 at its third meeting. The representatives of 25 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the following draft resolutions contained in document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), as amended by documents 43 C/6 and Add. and by the Commission, which foresee a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board. Furthermore, the APX Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5, as contained in documents 43 C/6 and Add.

Part I: General policy and direction

8. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 00100 of document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Draft resolution for general policy and direction (43 C/Resolution 1)

Part II.A: UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS)

9. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 07000 of document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Draft resolution for the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS) (43 C/Resolution 45)

Part II.B: Programme-related services

10. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolutions contained in paragraphs 09100, 09200, 09300, 09400 and 09500 of document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), which foresee a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Draft resolution for the Priority Africa and External Relations Sector (43 C/Resolution 46)

Draft resolution for coordination and monitoring of action to implement gender equality (43 C/Resolution 47)

Draft resolution for strategic planning (43 C/Resolution 48)

Draft resolution for communication and public engagement (43 C/Resolution 49)

¹ The Commission decided that the new composition of the working group on contributions to remain in place until the 44th session of the General Conference shall be as follows, in the order of the respective electoral groups: Luxembourg, Poland, Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of), Japan, Rwanda and State of Palestine.

Draft resolution for field offices - programme management and support services (43 C/Resolution 50)

Part II.C: Participation Programme and fellowships

11. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 10000 of document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Draft resolution for the Participation Programme and Fellowships Programme (43 C/Resolution 51)

Part III: Corporate services

12. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 11000 of Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions) of document 43 C/5, which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

Draft resolution for corporate services (43 C/Resolution 52)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.1 Proposals by Member States concerning the celebration of anniversaries with which UNESCO could be associated in 2026–2027 (43 C/15 and Corr.)

13. The APX Commission examined item 4.1 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/15, without amendments. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of three Member States took the floor (43 C/Resolution 55).

Item 4.6 UNESCO's emergency assistance programme for Ukraine (43 C/20)

14. The APX Commission examined item 4.6 at its fifth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/20, without amendments. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of 34 Member States and one observer took the floor to deliver statements (43 C/Resolution 56).

Item 4.9 Recognition and observance of Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha at UNESCO (43 C/23)

15. The APX Commission examined item 4.9 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/23, without amendments. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of three Member States took the floor to deliver statements (43 C/Resolution 57).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

16. The APX Commission examined item 4.11 at its second meeting. The representatives of 12 Member States took the floor. The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/Resolution 64).

Item 4.12 Revised timeline for reporting on programme implementation – strategic results report (SRR) (43 C/25)

17. The APX Commission examined item 4.12 at its second and third meetings. The representatives of nine Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/25, without amendments (43 C/Resolution 58).

Item 4.16 World Greek Language Day (43 C/38)

18. The APX Commission examined item 4.16 at its seventh meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/38, without amendments. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of 20 Member States took the floor (43 C/Resolution 59).

Item 4.22 Enhancing cooperation with and between National Commissions for UNESCO (43 C/53)

19. The APX Commission examined item 4.22 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/53, without amendments. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of 25 Member States took the floor (43 C/Resolution 60).

Item 4.25 World Turkic Language Family Day (43 C/57)

20. The APX Commission examined item 4.25 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/57, without amendments. The representatives of 14 Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 61).

Item 4.26 Support to Yemen in safeguarding cultural heritage, education, higher education and media in the context of the ongoing conflict (43 C/58)

21. The APX Commission examined item 4.26 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/58, without amendments. The representatives of seven Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 62).

Item 4.27 Impact and consequences of the current situation in the Gaza Strip/Palestine in all aspects of UNESCO's mandate (43 C/59)

22. The APX Commission examined item 4.27 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/59, without amendments. The representatives of 50 Member States and one observer took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 63).

METHODS OF WORK OF THE ORGANIZATION

Item 5.2 Revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee (OAC) (43 C/29, 43 C/LEG/10)

23. The APX Commission examined item 5.2 at its fourth meeting. This item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/10). This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/29, as amended (43 C/Resolution 81).

ADMINISTRATIVE AND FINANCIAL QUESTIONS

Item 8.1 Financial report and audited consolidated financial statements relating to the accounts of UNESCO for the financial period ended 31 December 2024, and report by the External Auditor (43 C/40 and Add.)

24. The APX Commission examined item 8.1 at its fifth meeting. The representatives of four Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/40 Add. (43 C/Resolution 65).

Item 8.2 Member States' contributions (43 C/41 and Add.)

25. APX Commission examined item 8.2 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/41 Add. (43 C/Resolution 66).

STAFF ISSUES

Item 9.1 Staff Regulations and Staff Rules (43 C/42 and Addenda; 43 C/LEG/11)

26. The APX Commission examined item 9.1 at its sixth meeting. This item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/11). The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/42, as amended. The representatives of five Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 67).

Item 9.2 Staff salaries, allowances and benefits (43 C/43 and Addenda)

27. The APX Commission examined item 9.2 at its seventh meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/43, as amended. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, the representatives of seven Member States took the floor (43 C/Resolution 68).

Item 9.3 United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund (UNJSPF) (43 C/44 and Add.)

28. The APX Commission examined item 9.3 at its seventh meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/44, as amended. The representatives of five Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 69).

Item 9.4 Report by the Director-General on the financial and administrative situation of the Medical Benefits Fund (MBF) (43 C/45 and Corr. and Add.)

29. The APX Commission examined item 9.4 at its seventh meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/45, with amendments. The representatives of five Member States took the floor after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 70).

Item 9.5 Human Resources Strategy for 2023–2027 (43 C/46 and Corr. and Addenda)

30. The APX Commission examined item 9.5 at its sixth meeting. The representatives of 10 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/46 (43 C/Resolution 71).

HEADQUARTERS QUESTIONS

Item 10.1 Report by the Director-General, in cooperation with the Headquarters Committee, on managing the UNESCO complex (43 C/49)

31. The APX Commission examined item 10.1 at its sixth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/49. The representatives of six Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 72).

ANNEX

REVISED TERMS OF REFERENCE OF THE OVERSIGHT ADVISORY COMMITTEE

Article 1 – Establishment of the Committee

The Oversight Advisory Committee (“the Committee”, or “OAC”) is hereby established within the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (“the Organization” or “UNESCO”).

Article 2 – Purpose

1. The Committee shall be independent and act in an advisory capacity to the Director-General of the Organization and the Executive Board in fulfilling their oversight and governance responsibilities including: (i) internal oversight; (ii) internal audit; (iii) evaluation; (iv) investigations; (v) risk management; (vi) ethics; (vii) external audit; (viii) internal controls; and (ix) other systems, policies and procedures relevant to such matters and related to the Organization’s operations.
2. The Committee shall function as a standing committee.
3. The Committee shall not have any managerial responsibility for any of the functions and responsibilities of the UNESCO Secretariat, including but not limited to those that it has a responsibility to review and advise on under these Terms of Reference.

Article 3 – Responsibilities**Internal oversight**

The Committee shall:

1. Advise on the role and effectiveness of the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) and its strategies, priorities and work plans and make suggestions regarding risk management;
2. Review and discuss with management the internal control and risk management issues that may arise from the audits, evaluations and investigations of the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS);
3. Review and advise on the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) charter and policies, authority, operational independence and resources requirements to carry out effectively the Division of Internal Oversight Services’ (IOS) responsibilities;
4. Provide advice on the evaluation of candidates for the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS), and at the request of the Director-General, for the heads of internal audit, evaluation and investigations; this may include participation of one OAC member in the respective evaluation panels in an advisory capacity;
5. Provide input into the performance appraisal of the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) and advise on the termination of their appointment; the Committee shall also be informed of any allegations of misconduct against the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS) and provide advice on any preliminary assessment conducted by the Organization thereon;

Internal audit

6. Review and provide advice on the annual internal audit plan before it is submitted to the Director-General and the Executive Board;
7. Advise on the adequacy of the IOS internal audit assurance strategy, policies, work plans, resources, quality assurance, and related matters of the internal audit function;
8. Advise on the adequacy of implementation by the management of the IOS internal audit recommendations;
9. Advise on the application of professional standards and quality assurance measures in relation to professional standards, including any external quality assurance review;

Evaluation

10. Review and provide advice on the annual internal evaluation plan before it is submitted to the Director-General and the Executive Board;
11. Advise on the adequacy of the IOS Evaluation Office strategy, policies, work plans and resources;
12. Advise on the adequacy of the implementation of management responses to evaluation recommendations;
13. Advise on the application of professional standards and quality assurance measures in relation to professional standards, including any external quality assurance review;

Investigations

14. Advise on the adequacy of the IOS Investigation Office strategy, policies, work plans and resources;
15. Advise on the implementation by the Director-General of investigation reports;
16. Advise on the application of professional standards and quality assurance measures in relation to professional standards, including any external quality assurance review;

Risk management

17. Review and discuss with the management the Organization's policies and practices with respect to risk assessment, risk management and internal control systems;
18. Advise on the quality and overall effectiveness of risk management policies and procedures;
19. Advise on UNESCO's fraud prevention and detection policies and activities;
20. At least once a year, and as frequently as needed, receive and review a report on information security (including cyber risk), business continuity and disaster recovery, and report accordingly to the Director-General and the Executive Board;

Ethics

21. Advise on UNESCO's code of ethics, ethics function and whistleblower protection policy;
22. Review the arrangements for employees to raise concerns in confidence about fraud, ethics, conflict of interest, violations of rules and regulations, and oversight matters, and how these are addressed;
23. Advise on the adequacy of the ethics function and the application of professional standards; advise on the implementation of ethics reports submitted to the Director-General and to the Executive Board;

External audit

24. Advise on the plans of the External Auditor;
25. Review and advise on relevant reports and management letters issued by the External Auditor, including reports on UNESCO's financial statements and related internal controls;
26. Review the adequacy of the management response to the observations and recommendations of the External Auditor, and assess the status of implementation;

Internal controls

27. Review the policies significantly affecting accounting and financial reporting issues, and the effectiveness of the Organization's internal controls;
28. Advise on potential weaknesses in the internal control system of UNESCO;
29. Review and advise on accounting policies and their likely effect on UNESCO;
30. Review and advise on the annual financial statements of UNESCO, including any major accounting or presentation issues;

Allegations against a Director-General

31. The Committee shall have the responsibility, as stipulated in 42 C/Resolution 76, pertaining to the UNESCO procedure for investigations in case of allegations against a Director-General.

Article 4 – Access

The Committee may request:

1. Through the Director-General, all the information and/or documents necessary to perform its responsibilities;
2. To meet individually, in private meetings, the Director-General, the Deputy Director-General, the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services, the Financial Director, and other senior managers, as well as any UNESCO staff members the Committee wishes to meet;
3. To meet the Chairperson of the Executive Board in private meetings.

Article 5 – Membership

1. The Committee shall be composed of five members, appointed by the Director-General, who will duly inform the Executive Board. Professional competence and integrity shall be of paramount consideration in the selection and appointment of members. The membership of the OAC shall be balanced, in terms of gender and geographical basis, as well as public and private sector experience and professional expertise, to the fullest extent practical.
2. The members, all of whom shall be external to and independent of the Organization, shall reflect the highest level of integrity and professionalism, and shall serve in their private capacity. In performing their duties, they shall not seek or receive instructions from any government. They should not have held a staff and/or consultancy position with the Organization's Secretariat for a consecutive five-year period prior to their appointment, and shall not hold any position or engage in any activity that could impair their independence, in fact or in perception, from the Secretariat or from companies that maintain a business relationship with the Organization, while serving on the Committee.
3. The members of the Committee must have the skills, knowledge and experience to fulfil their responsibilities. In particular, they must have recent and relevant senior-level managerial, financial, audit, evaluation and/or other oversight-related experience and competencies, including:
 - (a) Experience in preparing, auditing, analysing or evaluating financial statements that present a breadth and level of complexity of accounting issues that are generally comparable to the breadth and complexity of issues faced by the Organization, including an understanding of relevant accepted accounting and auditing principles and international standards;

- (b) An understanding of, and, if possible, relevant experience in, the inspection, evaluation, ethics, risk management and investigative processes;
 - (c) An understanding of internal control and fraud and corruption prevention policies and procedures;
 - (d) A general understanding of the Organization and of the structure and functioning of the United Nations system;
 - (e) At least one member should be a professionally qualified accountant, auditor or finance professional, and at least one other should be an evaluation expert.
4. Each member shall serve for a period of three years, renewable once for the second and final term of up to three years after the initial term, on a phased basis so as to provide continuity. In the event of resignation, incapacity, death or any other circumstance in which the term of office of a Committee member is cut short, the Director-General shall appoint a replacement.
 5. The appointed Committee members shall elect their own Chairperson from within their number to serve for the duration of his/her term of office. If the Chairperson is unable to attend a meeting, the members present shall elect an Acting Chairperson for that meeting from among themselves.
 6. Former officials of the Organization shall not be eligible for appointment to the Committee for five years following their separation from service. The members of the Committee shall not be eligible for appointment to the Organization for five years following the expiry of their terms.

Article 6 – Meetings

1. The Committee shall meet at least twice a year, and more frequently if required in person or by videoconference or other virtual means. The Director-General, Chairperson, any Committee member and/or the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services may request additional meetings. It is expected that members will be present for meetings.
2. Three members present, in person or virtually, shall constitute a quorum. Members may not be represented by an alternate.
3. The Committee will prepare an annual work plan that shall reflect the responsibilities set out in these Terms of Reference.
4. Meeting agendas are prepared based on the annual work plan, and in consultation with the Chairperson, the Committee Secretariat will arrange for the relevant UNESCO staff to attend for relevant agenda items. The Chairperson will approve the provisional agenda of the meeting, which should be circulated together with the invitations to UNESCO staff whose presence is requested at least 21 days prior to the date of the session. All supporting documents will be circulated to the Committee members at least 14 days prior to the date of the meeting.
5. The Committee shall function on the basis of consensus. When this is not possible, voting will be used, and should the votes be equally divided, the Chairperson shall have the casting vote. Dissenting opinions may be attached to any report if those in dissent so desire.
6. The Deputy Director-General, the Director of the Office of the Director-General (ODG) and the Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services may attend Committee meetings with the agreement of the Committee. The Financial Director and other management representatives may attend the meetings or parts of the meeting as requested by the Committee via its Chairperson.
7. The Director-General, Director of the Division of Internal Oversight Services, the Financial Director and the Chairperson of the Executive Board shall have unrestricted and confidential access to the Chairperson of the Committee.
8. The Chairperson of the Executive Board shall also have access to the Chairperson of the Committee at any point in time, and may report to the Executive Board, if needed.

Article 7 – Reporting

1. After each meeting, the Committee shall submit to the Director-General a report on its work.
2. The Committee shall also submit its annual report to the Director-General and to the Executive Board. The Director-General may transmit to the Executive Board his/her comments on the annual report.
3. The Chairperson of the Committee shall be invited to attend, in person or in virtual mode, the meeting at which the Committee's annual report is discussed by the Executive Board.

Article 8 – Performance assessment of the Committee

The Committee will conduct an annual self-assessment of its performance and report thereon in its annual report. An independent performance evaluation will be undertaken every three years and the results will be shared with the Director-General and the Executive Board.

Article 9 – Secretariat support

The secretariat service for the Committee shall be provided by the Division of Internal Oversight Services (IOS).

Article 10 – Status of members

Members shall act in an independent, non-executive capacity with no managerial powers while fulfilling these Terms of Reference. Therefore, members shall not be held personally liable for decisions taken by the Committee acting as a whole.

Article 11 – Fees and costs

1. Members shall not receive remuneration for their services.

2. The members of the Committee shall receive a daily subsistence allowance and shall be reimbursed for travel expenses incurred to attend the sessions of the Committee in accordance with the Organization's travel policy.

Article 12 – Confidentiality of meetings and minutes

1. All members of the Committee shall sign a statement of confidentiality at the time of appointment.
2. The deliberations of the Committee and the minutes of its meetings are confidential unless otherwise decided. The documents and informational material circulated for consideration by the Committee shall be used solely for that purpose, and treated as confidential.

Article 13 – Disclosure of conflicts of interest

All Committee members shall submit at the beginning of each meeting provided for in Article 6 of these Terms of Reference a signed declaration of conflict of interest. Where an actual or potential conflict of interest arises during the conduct of a meeting, the interest will be declared and will cause the member(s) to be excused from the discussions and abstain from voting on the matter.

B. Report of the ED Commission (Education)¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
Part II.A: Major Programme I – Education

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.3 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories
- Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres
- Item 4.7 Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week”
- Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
- Item 4.18 Enhancing dialogue with teachers around the world: proposal for an interactive platform
- Item 4.28 Supporting the continuity of UNRWA’s educational activities in the occupied Palestinian territory
- Item 4.30 SDG 4 - Education 2030: global/regional coordination, monitoring and support

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS

A. Preparation and adoption of new instruments

- Item 6.2 Preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997)

B. Monitoring existing instruments

- Item 7.1 Summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960)
- Item 7.2 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978)

REPORTS 1–8:

- Report by the Council of the International Bureau of Education (IBE) on the activities of the Bureau (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025)

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025 and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.21.

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Dec.24.IV) and the recommendation of the Nominations Committee, on 31 October 2025, at their joint meeting, the commissions elected Ms Paula Alves de Souza (Brazil) to the office of Chairperson of the Education Commission (ED Commission).

2. At its first meeting, on 31 October 2025, the ED Commission approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons. The following persons were elected by acclamation:

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Lena Sommestad (Sweden)
Mr Emile Ngoy Kasongo (Democratic Republic of the Congo)
Mr Ahmed Mohamed (Maldives)

3. The Commission then adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.ED/1 Prov.

4. The Commission devoted six meetings, between 31 October 2025 and 4 November 2025, to the examination of the 11 items on its agenda.

5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.5)

Part II.A: Major Programme I – Education

6. The ED Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning Major Programme I – Education, at its second and third meetings. The representatives of 33 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the ED Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 01000 of document 43 C/5, Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions), as amended by documents 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3 and 43 C/DR.5, and as amended by the Commission; the draft resolution foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board. Furthermore, the ED Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5, as contained in documents 43 C/6 and Add.

01000 - Draft resolution for Major Programme I – Education (43 C/Resolution 2)

7. The Commission also recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolutions relating to category 1 institutes proposed in paragraphs 01100 (IBE), 01200 (IIEP), 01300 (UIL), 01400 (IITE), 01500 (IICBA), 01600 (IESALC), 01700 (MGIEP) and 01800 (IISTEM).

01100 - Draft resolution for the International Bureau of Education (IBE) (43 C/Resolution 3)

01200 - Draft Resolution for the International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP) (43 C/Resolution 4)

01300 - Draft Resolution for the UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL) (43 C/Resolution 5)

01400 - Draft Resolution for the UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE) (43 C/Resolution 6)

01500 - Draft Resolution for the UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA) (43 C/Resolution 7)

01600 - Draft Resolution for the UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC) (43 C/Resolution 8)

01700 - Draft Resolution for the Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP) (43 C/Resolution 9)

01800 - Draft Resolution for the UNESCO International Institute for STEM Education (IISTEM) (43 C/Resolution 10)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.3 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories (43 C/17)

8. The ED Commission examined item 4.3 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/17, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 53).

Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres (43 C/18.I-III)

9. The ED Commission examined item 4.4, parts I-III, at its sixth meeting. This item was considered without debate.

Part I: Proposal for the designation of the Learning Planet Institute (France) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

10. The ED Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.I, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 11).

Part II: Proposal for the designation of the Simon Bolivar Musical Foundation (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela) as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

11. The ED Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.II, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 12).

Part III: Proposal for the designation of the Institute for Retraining and Professional Development of Directors and Specialists of Preschool Educational Organizations (Uzbekistan) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

12. The ED Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.III, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 13).

Item 4.7 Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week” (43 C/21)

13. The ED Commission examined item 4.7 at its sixth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt without amendment the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/21 (43 C/Resolution 54).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

14. The ED Commission examined item 4.11 at its second meeting. This item was discussed together with item 3.1, “Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029”. The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum contained in document 43 C/INF.13 and relating to Major Programme I - Education (43 C/Resolution 64).

Item 4.18 Enhancing dialogue with teachers around the world: proposal for an interactive platform (43 C/47)

15. The ED Commission examined item 4.18 at its fifth and sixth meetings. The representatives of 29 Member States and one observer took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/47 (43 C/Resolution 14).

Item 4.28 Supporting the continuity of UNRWA’s educational activities in the occupied Palestinian territory (43 C/61)

16. The ED Commission examined item 4.28 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/61 (43 C/Resolution 15).

Item 4.30 SDG 4 - Education 2030: global/regional coordination, monitoring and support (43 C/63)

17. The ED Commission examined item 4.30 at its third meeting. The representatives of 43 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/63 (43 C/Resolution 16).

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS

A. Preparation and adoption of new instruments

Item 6.2 Preliminary study on the technical and legal aspects relating to the desirability of revising the ILO/UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Teachers (1966) and the UNESCO Recommendation concerning the Status of Higher-Education Teaching Personnel (1997) (43 C/31)

18. The ED Commission examined item 6.2 at its third and fourth meetings. The representatives of 22 Member States and four observers took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/31, as amended (43 C/Resolution 73).

B. Monitoring existing instruments

Item 7.1 Summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (43 C/32, 43 C/LEG/4)

19. The ED Commission examined item 7.1 at its fourth and fifth meetings. This item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/4). The representatives of 22 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/32 and as transmitted by the Legal Committee (43 C/Resolution 74).

Item 7.2 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978) (43 C/33, 43 C/LEG/5)

20. The ED Commission examined item 7.2 at its sixth meeting. The item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/5). The representatives of 19 Member States and one observer took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/33 and as transmitted by the Legal Committee (43 C/Resolution 75).

21. Following the presentations and the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference take note of the following reports:

- Report by the Council of the International Bureau of Education (IBE) on the activities of the Bureau (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/1)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/2)

- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Lifelong Learning (UIL) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/3)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (IITE) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/4)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Higher Education in Latin America and the Caribbean (IESALC) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/5)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO International Institute for Capacity-Building in Africa (IICBA) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/6)
- Report by the Governing Board of the Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (MGIEP) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/7)
- Report by the Governing Board of the UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS) on the activities of the Institute (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/8)

C. Report of the SC-IOC Commission (Natural Sciences and the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission)¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
 Part II.A: Major Programme II – Natural Sciences
 Part II.A: Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres
Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
Item 4.15 International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development
Item 4.17 International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS)
Item 4.23 International Day of Caves and Karst

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS

B. Monitoring existing instruments

- Item 7.4 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021)

REPORTS

- Report of the International Coordinating Council for the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) Programme on its activities (2024–2025)
- Report of the Councils of the International Geoscience and Geoparks Programme (2024–2025)
- Report by the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP) on its activities (2024–2025)
- Report by the Steering Committee of the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) on the Institute's activities (2024–2025)
- Report by the Director-General on the progress of the International Basic Sciences Programme (IBSP) (2024–2025)
- Report of the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) on its activities (2024–2025)

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025, and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.22.

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Dec.24.IV) and the recommendation of the Nominations Committee, on 31 October 2025, at their joint meeting, the commissions elected Mr Samir Addahre (Morocco – Group V(b)) to the office of Chairperson of the SC-IOC Commission.

2. At its first meeting, on 7 November 2025, the SC-IOC Commission approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons. The following persons were elected by acclamation:

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Anne-Marie Boisbouvier (Monaco) – Group I
Ms Ana Elena Pinto Lizano (Costa Rica) – Group III
Ms Xinyu Yang (China) – Group IV
Ms Sekai Irene Nzenza (Zimbabwe) – Group V(a)

3. The Commission then adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.SC-IOC/1 Prov.

4. The Commission devoted three meetings, of which one was extended, on 7 and 8 November 2025, to the examination of the seven items on its agenda.

5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5 and Corr.1–4, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.1, 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.4, 43 C/DR.5, 43 C/REP/9, 43 C/REP/10, 43 C/REP/11, 43 C/REP/12, 43 C/REP/13, 43 C/REP14, 43 C/INF.13)

Part II.A: Major Programme II – Natural Sciences

6. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning Major Programme II – Natural Sciences, at its first and second meetings, together with item 4.11 on the conclusions of the Youth Forum.

7. The following reports were brought to the attention of the SC-IOC Commission: Report of the International Coordinating Council for the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) Programme on its activities (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/10); Report of the Councils of the International Geoscience and Geoparks Programme (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/11); Report by the Intergovernmental Council of the Intergovernmental Hydrological Programme (IHP) on its activities (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/12); Report by the Steering Committee of the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) on the Institute's activities (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/13); and Report by the Director-General on the progress of the International Basic Sciences Programme (IBSP) (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/14).

8. The representatives of 49 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 02000 of Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions) of document 43 C/5 and Corrigenda, as amended by the following documents: 43 C/6 and Add.; 43 C/DR.1; 43 C/DR.2; 43 C/DR.3; 43 C/DR.4.

9. The draft resolution foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

10. Furthermore, the SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5 and Corrigenda, as contained in documents 43 C/6 and Add.

02000 - Draft resolution for Major Programme II – Natural Sciences (43 C/Resolution 17)

11. The Commission also recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution relating to the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) proposed in paragraph 02100.

02100 - Draft resolution for the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) (43 C/Resolution 18)

Part II.A: Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC)

12. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC), at its second and third meetings.

13. The Report of the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) on its activities (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/9) was brought to the attention of the SC-IOC Commission.

14. The representatives of 28 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 03000 of Volume 1 of document 43 C/5 and Corrigenda, as amended by 43 C/6 and Add. The draft resolution foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board.

03000 - Draft resolution for the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) (43 C/Resolution 19)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres (43 C/18.IV-VI and X)

15. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 4.4, parts IV-VI and X, at its third meeting. This item was considered without debate.

Part IV: Proposal for the designation of the Biotechnology Centre for Training in Agamic Seed Production (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela) as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

16. The SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.IV, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 20).

Part V: Proposal for the designation of the International Centre for Integrated River Research and Management (Austria) as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

17. The SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.V, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 21).

Part VI: Proposal for the designation of the Australian Rivers Institute (Australia) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

18. The SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.VI, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 22).

Part X: Proposal for the designation of the African Institute in Indigenous Knowledge Systems (South Africa) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

19. The SC-IOC Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.X, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 23).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

20. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 4.11 together with item 3.1, "Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029", at its first meeting. The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum contained in document 43 C/INF.13 and relating to Major Programme II – Natural Sciences and the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) (43 C/Resolution 64).

Item 4.15 International Day of Engagement in Science for Sustainable Development (43 C/37)

21. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 4.15 at its third meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/37 (43 C/Resolution 24).

Item 4.17 International Day for Small Island Developing States (SIDS) (43 C/39)

22. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 4.17 at its third meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/39 (43 C/Resolution 25).

Item 4.23 International Day of Caves and Karst (43 C/55)

23. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 4.23 at its third meeting. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/55 (43 C/Resolution 26).

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS

B. Monitoring existing instruments

Item 7.4 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021) (43 C/35; 43 C/LEG/7)

24. The SC-IOC Commission examined item 7.4 at its third meeting. The representatives of 35 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/35 as examined by the Legal Committee at its first meeting (43 C/Resolution 76)

D. Report of the SHS Commission (Social and Human Sciences)¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
Part II.A: Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.8 Commemoration of the International Day of Vesak at UNESCO
Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
Item 4.14 Fit for Life: Advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education, including through the promotion of cycling
Item 4.19 International Taijiquan Day
Item 4.20 International Day of Nomadic Heritage
Item 4.21 Cyrus Cylinder: an early charter of human rights and cultural diversity
Item 4.29 UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029)

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS

A. Preparation and adoption of new instruments

- Item 6.1 Draft recommendation on the ethics of neurotechnology

B. Monitoring existing instruments

- Item 7.3 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017)
Item 7.5 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the 2021 Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

REPORTS

- Report by the Director-General on the work of the International Bioethics Committee (IBC) and of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC) (2024–2025)
- Report by the Intergovernmental Council on the activities of the Management of Social Transformation (MOST) Programme (2024–2025)
- Report by the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS) (2024–2025)
- Report by the Director-General on the work of the World Commission on the Ethics of Scientific Knowledge and Technology (COMEST) (2024–2025)

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025, and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.23.

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Decision 24.IV) and the recommendation of the Nominations Committee, at their joint meeting, the commissions elected, on 31 October 2025, Mr Philemon Mjwara (South Africa – Group V(a)) to the office of Chairperson of the SHS Commission.
2. At its first meeting, on 5 November 2025, the SHS Commission approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons and Rapporteur. The following persons were elected by acclamation:
 Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Rodulfo Humberto Pérez Hernández (Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela – Group III)
 Mr Takehiro Kano (Japan – Group IV)
3. The Commission then adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.SHS/1 Prov.
4. The Commission devoted four meetings, on 5 and 6 November 2025, to the examination of the 11 items on its agenda.
5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/INF.12, 43 C/INF.14)

Part II.A: Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences

6. The SHS Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences, at its first and second meetings. The representatives of 39 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the SHS Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 04000 of Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions) of document 43 C/5, as amended by documents 43 C/6 and Add., which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board. Furthermore, the SHS Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5, as contained in documents 43 C/6 and Add.

04000 - Draft resolution for Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences (43 C/Resolution 27)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.8 Commemoration of the International Day of Vesak at UNESCO (43 C/22)

7. The SHS Commission examined item 4.8 at its fourth and last meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/22, as amended. The representatives of four Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 28).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

8. The SHS Commission examined item 4.11 at its first meeting. This item was discussed together with item 3.1, “Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029”. The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum contained in document 43 C/INF.13 and relating to Major Programme III – Social and Human Sciences (43 C/Resolution 64).

Item 4.14 Fit for Life: Advancing inclusive, equitable and safe sport and quality physical education, including through the promotion of cycling (43 C/27 and Add., 43 C/COM.SHS/DR.1 Rev.)

9. The SHS Commission examined item 4.14 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/COM.SHS/DR.1 Rev., as amended. The representatives of 21 Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 29).

Item 4.19 International Taijiquan Day (43 C/48)

10. The SHS Commission examined item 4.19 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/48. One Member State representative took the floor to deliver a statement after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 30).

Item 4.20 International Day of Nomadic Heritage (43 C/51)

11. The SHS Commission examined item 4.20 at its third meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/51. The representatives of six Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 31).

Item 4.21 Cyrus Cylinder: an early charter of human rights and cultural diversity (43 C/52)

12. The SHS Commission examined item 4.21 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/52, as amended. The representatives of 16 Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 32).

Item 4.29 UNESCO Disability Inclusion Strategy (2026–2029) (43 C/62)

13. The SHS Commission examined item 4.29 at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt by acclamation, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/62. The representatives of 34 Member States took the floor to make statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 33).

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS**A. Preparation and adoption of new instruments****Item 6.1 Draft recommendation on the ethics of neurotechnology (43 C/30)**

14. The SHS Commission examined item 6.1 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt by acclamation, for *in extenso* inclusion in the records of the General Conference, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/30. The representatives of 48 Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 34).

CONVENTIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTRUMENTS**B. Monitoring existing instruments****Item 7.3 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017) (43 C/34, 43 C/LEG/6)**

15. The SHS Commission examined item 7.3 at its third meeting. This item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/6). This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/34, as amended. The representatives of 18 Member States and one observer took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 77).

Item 7.5 Consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the 2021 Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (43 C/36, 43 C/INF.15, 43 C/LEG/8)

16. The SHS Commission examined item 7.5 at its third meeting. This item was also examined by the Legal Committee (43 C/LEG/8). This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/36, as amended. The representatives of 33 Member States took the floor to deliver statements after the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 78).

17. In addition, the following reports were brought to the attention of the Commission:

- Report by the Director-General on the work of the International Bioethics Committee (IBC) and of the Intergovernmental Bioethics Committee (IGBC) (2024-2025) (43 C/REP/15)
- Report by the Intergovernmental Council on the activities of the Management of Social Transformation (MOST) Programme (2024-2025) (43 C/REP/16)
- Report by the Intergovernmental Committee for Physical Education and Sport (CIGEPS) (2024-2025) (43 C/REP/17)
- Report by the Director-General on the work of the World Commission on the Ethics of Scientific Knowledge and Technology (COMEST) (2024-2025) (43 C/REP/18).

E. Report of the CLT Commission (Culture)¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
Part II.A: Major Programme IV – Culture

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.2 Jerusalem and the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 32
- Item 4.3 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories
- Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres
- Item 4.7 Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week”
- Item 4.10 International day for underwater cultural heritage
- Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum
- Item 4.13 Examination of the recommendations concerning public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly traded cultural object from its country of origin pursuant to paragraph 5 of 40 C/Resolution 42
- Item 4.24 International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development

METHODS OF WORK OF THE ORGANIZATION

- Item 5.1 Follow-up to 42 C/Resolution 35 and prospects for the UNESCO conventions in the field of culture

REPORTS

- Report of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage on its activities
- Report on the activities of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to Its Countries of Origin or Its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (2024–2025)
- Report of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage on its activities (2022–2023)

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 15th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025, and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.24.

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Dec.24.IV) and the recommendation of the Nominations Committee, on 31 October 2025, at their joint meeting, the commissions elected Mr Georgios Koumoutsakos (Greece) to the office of Chairperson of the CLT Commission.

2. At its first meeting, on 7 November 2025, the CLT Commission approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons and Rapporteur. The following persons were elected by acclamation:

Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Mykola Movchan (Ukraine)
Ms Laura Andrea Guillem Gloria (Colombia)
Ms Nguyen Thi Van Anh (Viet Nam)
Mr Peter K. Ngure (Kenya)

Rapporteur: Mr Salih Abdullah (Libya)

3. The Commission then adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.CLT/1.Prov.

4. The Commission devoted four meetings, between 7 and 10 November 2025, to the examination of the 10 items on its agenda and three reports.

5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5 and Corrigenda, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.5)

Part II.A: Major Programme IV – Culture

6. The CLT Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning Major Programme IV – Culture, at its first and second meetings. The representatives of 52 Member States and two observers took the floor. Following the debate, the CLT Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 05000 of Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions) of document 43 C/5, as amended by 43 C/6 and Add., which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board. Furthermore, the CLT Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5, as contained in documents 43 C/6 and Add. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, two Member States made statements.

05000 - Draft resolution for Major Programme IV – Culture (43 C/Resolution 35)

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.2 Jerusalem and the implementation of 42 C/Resolution 32 (43 C/16)

7. The CLT Commission examined item 4.2 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/16, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 36).

Item 4.3 Implementation of 42 C/Resolution 49 concerning educational and cultural institutions in the occupied Arab territories (43 C/17)

8. The CLT Commission examined item 4.3 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/17, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 53).

Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres (43 C/18.VII, 43 C/18.VIII)

9. The CLT Commission examined item 4.4, parts VII and VIII, at its fourth meeting. This item was considered without debate. Six Member States made statements after the endorsement of the respective draft resolutions in parts VII and VIII.

Part VII: Proposal for the designation of the Three Cultures of the Mediterranean Foundation (Spain) as a centre under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

10. The CLT Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.VII, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 37).

Part VIII: Proposal for the designation of the Underwater Heritage Institute (Bulgaria) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

11. The CLT Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.VIII, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 38).

Item 4.7 Renaming “International Arts Education Week” as “UNESCO Culture and Arts Education Week” (43 C/21)

12. The CLT Commission examined item 4.7 at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/21. Six Member States took the floor to make statements following the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 54).

Item 4.10 International day for underwater cultural heritage (43 C/24)

13. The CLT Commission examined item 4.10 at its third meeting. This item was considered without debate. The Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/24. Twenty-six Member States took the floor to make statements following the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 39).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

14. The CLT Commission examined item 4.11 at its first meeting. This item was discussed together with item 3.1, "Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029". The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum contained in document 43 C/INF.13 and relating to Major Programme IV – Culture (43 C/Resolution 64).

Item 4.13 Examination of the recommendations concerning public statements condemning the sale of an illicitly traded cultural object from its country of origin pursuant to paragraph 5 of 40 C/Resolution 42 (43 C/26)

15. The CLT Commission examined item 4.13 at its fourth meeting. The representatives of 29 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/26 (43 C/Resolution 40).

Item 4.24 International Decade of Culture for Sustainable Development (43 C/56 Rev.)

16. The CLT Commission examined item 4.24 at its second and third meetings. The representatives of 31 Member States and one observer took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/56 Rev., as amended. One Member State made a statement following the endorsement of the draft resolution (43 C/Resolution 41).

METHODS OF WORK OF THE ORGANIZATION**Item 5.1 Follow-up to 42 C/Resolution 35 and prospects for the UNESCO conventions in the field of culture (43 C/28)**

17. The CLT Commission examined item 5.1 at its fourth meeting. The representatives of 14 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/28 (43 C/Resolution 80).

18. Following the presentations and statements made by nine Member States, the Commission recommended that the General Conference take note of the following reports:

- Report of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage on its activities (43 C/REP/19)
- Report on the activities of the Intergovernmental Committee for Promoting the Return of Cultural Property to Its Countries of Origin or Its Restitution in Case of Illicit Appropriation (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/20)
- Report of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage on its activities (2022–2023) (43 C/REP/21)

F. Report of the CI Commission (Communication and Information)¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

- Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
Part II.A: Major Programme V – Communication and Information

GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

- Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres
- Item 4.5 Report by the Director-General on implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes
- Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum

REPORTS

- Report of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC) on its activities (2024–2025)
- Report on the implementation of the Information for All Programme (IFAP) (2024–2025)

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 16th plenary meeting, on 12 November 2025, and approved the decisions recommended by the Commission therein. The oral report of the Chairperson of the Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.25.

INTRODUCTION

1. Upon the report of the Executive Board (221 EX/Dec.24.IV) and the recommendation of the Nominations Committee, on 31 October 2025, at their joint meeting, the commissions elected Ms Mumtaz Zahra Baloch (Pakistan) to the office of Chairperson of the CI Commission.

2. At its first meeting, on 5 November 2025, the CI Commission approved the proposals submitted by the Nominations Committee for the offices of Vice-Chairpersons. The following persons were elected by acclamation:

Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Raúl Fernández Daza (Chile)
Mr Mariusz Lewicki (Poland)
Ms Hajo Sani (Nigeria)
Ms Monique van Daalen (Kingdom of the Netherlands)

3. The Commission then adopted the timetable of work proposed in document 43 C/COM.CI/1.Prov., as amended in the room.

4. The Commission devoted three meetings, on 5 and 6 November 2025, to the examination of the four items on its agenda.

5. The present report includes only the recommendations of the Commission, which were presented orally by the Chairperson of the Commission to the General Conference for adoption.

ITEM 3 DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.5, 43 C/INF.16)

Part II.A: Major Programme V – Communication and Information

6. The CI Commission examined item 3.1, part II.A, concerning Major Programme V – Communication and Information, at its first and second meetings. The representatives of 44 Member States and one observer took the floor. Following the debate, the CI Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in paragraph 06000 of Volume 1 (Draft Resolutions) of document 43 C/5, as amended by 43 C/6 and Add., and 43 C/DR.3, which foresees a budget provision under all sources of funds to be approved at the 224th session of the Executive Board. Furthermore, the CI Commission recommended that the General Conference endorse the recommendations of the Executive Board pertaining to the relevant paragraphs in Volume 2 of document 43 C/5, as contained in document 43 C/6. Regarding document 43 C/DR.5, the Commission recommended that the decision about the proposal be deferred to the joint meeting of commissions.

06000 - Draft resolution for Major Programme V – Communication and Information (43 C/Resolution 42)

ITEM 4 GENERAL POLICY AND PROGRAMME QUESTIONS

Item 4.4 Category 2 institutes and centres (43 C/18.IX)

7. The CI Commission examined item 4.4, part IX, at its second meeting. This item was considered without debate.

Part IX: Proposal for the designation of the International Media and Information Literacy Institute (Nigeria) as an institute under the auspices of UNESCO (category 2)

8. The CI Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/18.IX, without amendments (43 C/resolution 43).

Item 4.5 Report by the Director-General on implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) outcomes (43 C/19, 43 C/COM.CI/DR.1)

9. The CI Commission examined item 4.5 at its second and third meetings. The representatives of 20 Member States took the floor. Following the debate, the Commission recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/19, as amended (43 C/Resolution 44).

Item 4.11 Conclusions of the Youth Forum (43 C/INF.13)

10. The CI Commission examined item 4.11 at its first meeting. The representatives of 11 Member States took the floor. The Commission took note of the conclusions of the Youth Forum contained in document 43 C/INF.13 and relating to Major Programme V – Communication and Information (43 C/Resolution 64).

Report of the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC) on its activities (2024–2025) (43 C/REP/22) and **Report on the implementation of the Information for All Programme (IFAP) (2024–2025)** (43 C/REP/23)

11. The reports on the International Programme for the Development of Communication (43 C/REP/22) and on the Information for All Programme (43 C/REP/23) were presented by their Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson, respectively. The Commission recommended that the General Conference take note of those reports.

G. Report of the joint meeting of commissions¹

INTRODUCTION

DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1	Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029
Item 3.2	Adoption of the Appropriation Resolution for 2026–2027
Item 3.3	Adoption of the provisional budget ceiling
Item 3.4	Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles

¹ The General Conference took note of this report at its 17th plenary meeting, on 13 November 2025, and approved the decisions recommended by the joint meeting of commissions therein, including the Appropriation Resolution for 2026–2027 (43 C/Resolution 84). The oral report of the Chairperson of the APX Commission in plenary is published in document 43 C/INF.27.

INTRODUCTION

1. The joint meeting of the programme commissions and the APX Commission, referred to below as “the joint meeting”, took place on the morning of 31 October and the morning of 13 November 2025, in the presence of the Chairpersons of the five programme commissions and the Chairperson of the APX Commission.
2. Ms Jolanta Balčiūnienė (Lithuania), Chairperson of the APX Commission, chaired the examination of the four items on the agenda of the joint meeting.
3. At its first meeting, on 31 October 2025, the joint meeting adopted its timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.JM/1 Prov.
4. Following a request from Canada and the Bureau's recommendation, the General Conference decided to include additional item 3.4, entitled “Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles”, to be examined by the joint meeting of commissions on 13 November 2025.
5. At its second meeting, on 13 November 2025, the joint meeting adopted the revised timetable of work as set out in document 43 C/COM.JM/1 Prov. Rev.

ITEM 3 DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

Item 3.1 Consideration and adoption of the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8 43 C/DR.1, 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.4, amendment contained in document 43 C/DR.5 was withdrawn)

6. Following the consideration of this item by the five programme commissions and the APX Commission individually, the joint meeting examined the item at its second meeting. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, two Member States took the floor. The joint meeting recommended that the General Conference adopt the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5, 43 C/6 and Add., 43 C/8, 43 C/DR.1, 43 C/DR.2, 43 C/DR.3, 43 C/DR.4) in its entirety, excluding the budgetary elements.

Item 3.2 Adoption of the Appropriation Resolution for 2026–2027 (43 C/13)

7. The joint meeting examined this item at its second and last meeting. Following the endorsement of the draft resolution, six Member States took the floor. The joint meeting recommended that the General Conference adopt the Appropriation Resolution for 2026–2027 (43 C/Resolution 84).

Item 3.3 Adoption of the provisional budget ceiling (43 C/14 Rev. and Add.)

8. The joint meeting examined item 3.3 at its first meeting. Following the debate, nine Member States took the floor. The joint meeting decided to recommend that the General Conference endorse the integrated budget framework for 2026–2027 of \$1,813,935,670, which includes regular budget resources of \$610,045,936 under the zero nominal growth (ZNG) scenario funded by assessed contributions. The joint meeting also decided to recommend that the regular budget be supplemented by a one-off appropriation of \$31,053,464 comprised of \$23,000,000 from the residual balance of the Special Account for Management Costs (MCA) and the use of \$8,053,464 of the Working Capital Fund (WCF) advance of the two withdrawing Member States.

Item 3.4 Recommendations of the Executive Board on the Draft Programme and Budget for 2026–2029 (43 C/5) and future Programme and Budget cycles (43 C/64, 43 C/BUR/3)

9. The joint meeting examined item 3.4 at its second meeting. The joint meeting recommended that the General Conference adopt the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/64, without amendment (43 C/Resolution 85)

H. Reports of the Legal Committee

FIRST REPORT

1. The Legal Committee elected, by acclamation, Mr Pierre Michel Eisemann (France) as Chairperson, Ms Kristine Margret Malang (Philippines) as Vice-Chairperson and Ms Hazar Sassi (Tunisia) as Rapporteur.
2. In accordance with paragraphs 3 to 5 of Rule 35 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, the Legal Committee, acting as a credentials committee, examined the credentials received by the Director-General.
3. At the Chairperson's request, the Legal Adviser and Director of the Office of International Standards and Legal Affairs (DIR/LA), representing the Director-General, informed the Committee of the criteria to be applied in deciding on the validity of credentials submitted under Rule 23 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference. The Rule provided that the credentials of delegates and alternate delegates should be issued by the head of the State, the head of the government, the Minister for Foreign Affairs or another minister authorized by the Minister for Foreign Affairs to issue credentials.
4. The representative of the Director-General also explained the meaning and implications of the expression "provisional credentials" according to the practice established at UNESCO.
5. The Secretariat then informed the Committee of the situation regarding the credentials it had received thus far. The Committee concluded that the credentials of the Member States referred to below had been issued in conformity with Rule 23 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, i.e., the credentials had been issued by either the head of the State, the head of the government, the Minister for Foreign Affairs or another minister authorized by the Minister for Foreign Affairs to issue credentials. It therefore considered that the delegations of the Member States listed in document 43 C/81, paragraph 5, were duly accredited (43 C/Resolution 01).
6. The Committee recommended that the delegations of the above-mentioned Member States be allowed to take part in the work of the General Conference at its 43rd session.
7. The delegations of the following Member States had submitted credentials in the form of notes verbales, letters or other documents issued by a minister other than the Minister for Foreign Affairs and not so authorized by the latter, by the head of a diplomatic mission, by a Permanent Delegate to UNESCO or by a senior government official:

Afghanistan	Cameroon	Cook Islands
Eswatini	Ethiopia	Fiji
Guinea-Bissau	Iraq	Kuwait
Lebanon	Madagascar	Micronesia (Federated States of)
	Mozambique	Nauru
Samoa	Seychelles	Somalia

8. The Committee proposed that those notes verbales, letters and other documents be accepted as the provisional credentials of the delegations of the Member States concerned, subject to later presentation of credentials in due form, and that in the meantime those delegations be allowed to take part in the work of the General Conference at its 43rd session.
9. The Legal Committee noted that the Secretariat had received two sets of documents from two different delegations, each claiming to represent Myanmar at the 43rd session of the General Conference. Bearing in mind resolution 396 (V), adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations on 14 December 1950, the Legal Committee decided to recommend that the General Conference, at its 43rd session, defer a decision on the question of the credentials of Myanmar, pending an opinion from the General Assembly of the United Nations.
10. The delegations of the following Associate Members had submitted credentials: Åland Islands and Sint Maarten.
11. The Committee proposed that those credentials should also be accepted.
12. The following non-Member States had submitted the names of their observers: Holy See and Israel.
13. The delegations of the following Member States had not yet submitted credentials:

Belize	Central African Republic	Dominica
Kiribati	Nicaragua	Niger
Niue	South Sudan	Trinidad and Tobago
United States of America		

14. The delegations of the following Associate Members had not yet submitted credentials:

Anguilla	Aruba	British Virgin Islands
Cayman Islands	Curaçao	Faroe Islands
Macau (China)	Montserrat	New Caledonia
Tokelau		

15. The following non-Member State had not yet sent the names of its observers: Liechtenstein.

16. Finally, the Legal Committee decided to authorize its Chairperson to report directly to the General Conference on any credentials that might be submitted before its following meeting, it being understood that the Chairperson would convene the Committee when deemed necessary.

SECOND REPORT

Item 3.1 of the agenda (document 43 C/5)

CONSIDERATION OF COMMUNICATIONS RELATING TO THE ADMISSIBILITY OF DRAFT RESOLUTIONS FOR THE ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE DRAFT PROGRAMME AND BUDGET FOR 2026–2029 (43 C/5)

1. Since its 29th session, the General Conference has adopted a procedure for processing draft resolutions proposing amendments to the Draft Programme and Budget document (C/5). This procedure derives from an amendment introduced into its Rules of Procedure (see Rules 77 and 78).

2. The established procedure states that the authors of draft resolutions (DRs) that were *prima facie* deemed inadmissible by the Director-General may request the General Conference to pronounce upon their admissibility as a last resort, through its Legal Committee.

3. An Explanatory Note had been prepared by the Legal Committee in November 2000 and communicated to all Member States so that they could submit draft resolutions of this nature in accordance with the requisite criteria. The note was finalized with two “clarifications” adopted respectively by the Legal Committee during its meeting of November 2002 and the General Conference at its 33rd session.

4. Moreover, by 36 C/Resolution 104 on the independent external evaluation of UNESCO, the General Conference had highlighted, in 2011, that the recommendation proposing that draft resolutions with financial implications clearly identify the main line of action from which the resources should be assigned would constitute, from then on, an additional criterion of admissibility for draft resolutions pertaining to the C/5 document.

5. At its 37th session, the General Conference decided to amend Rules 77 and 78 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference to reflect the Explanatory Note and clarifications prepared by the Legal Committee, as well as 36 C/Resolution 104.

6. In view of the above, and in the absence of any appeal under Rule 78 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, the members of the Committee felt that there was no need for the Legal Committee to consider the point further.

THIRD REPORT¹

Item 7.1 of the agenda (document 43 C/32)

SUMMARY OF THE REPORTS RECEIVED FROM MEMBER STATES ON THE MEASURES TAKEN TO IMPLEMENT THE CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION (1960)

1. The Legal Committee examined the summary of the reports received from Member States on the measures taken to implement the Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960).

2. It took note of the report, together with the comments formulated thereon by the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations at the 222nd session of the Executive Board. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General on the implementation of the 1960 Convention and Recommendation.

3. A member of the Committee expressed the wish that Member States include in their reports disaggregated and up-to-date information on the measures taken to ensure the right to education of persons with disabilities, in accordance with the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006) and Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4, giving particular attention to accessibility, inclusion and equality of opportunities at all levels and in all forms of education.

4. The Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 11 of document 43 C/32 (43 C/Resolution 74).

¹ This report was transmitted to the ED Commission.

FOURTH REPORT²Item 7.2 of the agenda (document 43 C/33)**CONSOLIDATED REPORT ON THE IMPLEMENTATION BY MEMBER STATES OF THE REVISED RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING THE INTERNATIONAL STANDARDIZATION OF EDUCATIONAL STATISTICS (1978)**

1. The Legal Committee examined the consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Revised Recommendation concerning the International Standardization of Educational Statistics (1978).
2. It took note of the report, together with the comments formulated thereon by the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations at the 220th session of the Executive Board. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General on the implementation of the 1978 Revised Recommendation.
3. The Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, with amendments, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 9 of document 43 C/33 (43 C/Resolution 75).

FIFTH REPORT³Item 7.3 of the agenda (document 43 C/34)**CONSOLIDATED REPORT ON THE IMPLEMENTATION BY MEMBER STATES OF THE RECOMMENDATION ON SCIENCE AND SCIENTIFIC RESEARCHERS (2017)**

1. The Legal Committee examined the consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017).
2. It took note of the report, together with the comments formulated thereon by the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations at the 222nd session of the Executive Board. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General on the implementation of the 2017 Recommendation.
3. A member of the Committee expressed the wish that Member States be encouraged to redouble their efforts to strengthen the financing, visibility and recognition of women in science, by means including the ensuring of equitable access to research funding, the enhancing of opportunities for the publication and dissemination of their scientific work, and the active promotion of their nomination for the various UNESCO prizes and distinctions in the field of science.
4. The Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, with amendments, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 7 of document 42 C/34 (43 C/Resolution 77).

SIXTH REPORT⁴Item 7.4 of the agenda (document 43 C/35)**CONSOLIDATED REPORT ON THE IMPLEMENTATION BY MEMBER STATES OF THE RECOMMENDATION ON OPEN SCIENCE (2021)**

1. The Legal Committee examined the first consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on Open Science (2021).
2. It took note of the report, together with the comments formulated thereon by the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations at the 222nd session of the Executive Board. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation.
3. A member of the Committee noted the importance of the Director-General promoting exchanges and cooperation among Member States that had successfully implemented the Recommendation on Open Science and those that were still in the process of doing so, with a view to fostering shared learning, capacity-building and the strengthening of national open science ecosystems.
4. The Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, without amendment, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 9 of document 43 C/35 (43 C/Resolution 76).

² This report was transmitted to the ED Commission.

³ This report was transmitted to the SHS Commission.

⁴ This report was transmitted to the SC-IOC Commission.

SEVENTH REPORT⁵

Item 7.5 of the agenda (documents 43 C/36 and 43 C/INF.15)

CONSOLIDATED REPORT ON THE IMPLEMENTATION BY MEMBER STATES OF THE 2021 RECOMMENDATION ON THE ETHICS OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

1. The Legal Committee examined the first consolidated report on the implementation by Member States of the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021).
2. It took note of the report, together with the comments formulated thereon by the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations at the 222nd session of the Executive Board. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation.
3. The Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, with amendments, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 11 of document 43 C/36 (43 C/Resolution 78).

EIGHTH REPORT⁶

Item 5.3 of the agenda (document 43 C/54)

RECOGNITION OF KISWAHILI AS AN OFFICIAL LANGUAGE OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE

1. The Legal Committee examined the item on the recognition of Kiswahili as an official language of the General Conference.
2. It took note of the explanatory note concerning the item proposed by the United Republic of Tanzania. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the United Republic of Tanzania during the presentation of the item to the Committee.
3. In that regard, the Committee took note of the commitment of the United Republic of Tanzania to covering the expenses related to the translation into Kiswahili of texts of the Constitution of UNESCO, resolutions of the General Conference, especially those concerning the Constitution and the legal status of UNESCO, and other essential documents.
4. After recalling the legal framework governing official languages, namely Rules 52 and 53 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, the Committee recalled that it was not within its competence to decide upon the substantive aspects of the proposal of the United Republic of Tanzania. Consequently, if the General Conference were to endorse the proposal, the Committee deemed that it could amend the first paragraph of Rule 52 of its Rules of Procedure as follows:

“Arabic, Bahasa Indonesia, Chinese, English, French, Hindi, Italian, Kiswahili, Portuguese, Russian and Spanish are the official languages of the General Conference.”
5. While recalling Rule 111 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Conference, which provides for a simple majority for any amendment to the Rules of Procedure, the Committee recommended that the General Conference adopt, with amendments, the draft resolution contained in paragraph 8 of document 43 C/54 (43 C/Resolution 79).

NINTH REPORT⁷

Item 5.2 of the agenda (document 43 C/29)

REVISION OF THE TERMS OF REFERENCE OF THE OVERSIGHT ADVISORY COMMITTEE (OAC)

1. This item was submitted to the Legal Committee for examination, as recommended by the Bureau at its first meeting.
2. The Legal Committee examined the draft revised Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee. It also took note of the additional information provided by the representative of the Director-General.
3. The Committee recalled that it fell within the remit of the APX (Finance, Administration and General Questions, Programme Support and External Relations) Commission to decide upon the substantive aspects of the proposed revision of the Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee.
4. At the end of its discussions, the Committee made a number of legal amendments to the proposed new Terms of Reference of the Oversight Advisory Committee annexed to the draft resolution contained in document 43 C/29 (43 C/Resolution 81).

⁵ This report was transmitted to the SHS Commission.

⁶ The General Conference took note of this report at its 13th plenary meeting, on 11 November 2025.

⁷ This report was transmitted to the APX Commission.

TENTH REPORT⁸

Item 9.1 of the agenda (documents 43 C/42 and Addenda)

STAFF REGULATIONS AND STAFF RULES

1. This item was submitted to the Legal Committee for examination, as recommended by the Bureau at its first meeting.
2. The Legal Committee examined the proposed amendments to the Staff Regulations and to the Statutes of the Appeals Board, while taking note of the comments of a staff association contained in the addendum to document 43 C/42. It took note of the additional information on the matter provided by the representative of the Director-General.
3. The Committee recalled that it fell within the remit of the APX (Finance, Administration and General Questions, Programme Support and External Relations) Commission to decide upon the substantive aspects of the proposed amendments.
4. At the end of its discussions, the Committee made a number of legal amendments to the proposed amendments to the Staff Regulations and the Statutes of the Appeals Board. The amendments made by the Legal Committee are in no way intended to alter the substance of the provisions concerned; they aim solely to improve legal legibility. With regard to the amendments to the Staff Regulations set out in the annex to document 43 C/42, the Committee asked the Secretariat to ensure consistency between the English and French terms used in the new Rules 100.2, 105.2 bis and 106.2, particularly the terms concerning remuneration and parental leave, and to ensure the consistency of the Staff Regulations and Staff Rules following those amendments, in order to avoid any possible errors in the entirety of those texts (43 C/Resolution 67).

⁸ This report was transmitted to the APX Commission.

ANNEX I List of officers elected at the 43rd session of the General Conference

The following were the elected officers of the 43rd session of the General Conference:

President of the General Conference

Mr Khondker Mohammad Talha (Bangladesh)

Vice-Presidents of the General Conference

The heads of delegations of the following Member States:

Armenia	France	Norway
Australia	Germany	Poland
Austria	Honduras	Rwanda
Azerbaijan	Iraq	Saint Lucia
Bahrain	Kazakhstan	Seychelles
Brazil	Latvia	South Africa
Canada	Maldives	State of Palestine
Chile	Morocco	Thailand
China	Mozambique	Ukraine
Congo	Netherlands	United Arab Emirates
Costa Rica	(Kingdom of the)	Viet Nam
El Salvador	Nigeria	Yemen

APX Commission: Financial, administrative and general questions, programme support and external relations

Chairperson: Ms Jolanta Balčiūnienė (Lithuania)

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Monique van Daalen (Netherlands (Kingdom of the))
Ms Yeoul Kang (Republic of Korea)
Mr Ali Jabir Mwadini (United Republic of Tanzania)

ED Commission: Education

Chairperson: Ms Paula Alves de Souza (Brazil)

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Lena Sommestad (Sweden)
Mr Emile Ngoy Kasongo (Democratic Republic of Congo)
Mr Ahmed Mohamed (Maldives)

SC–IOC Commission: Natural sciences and Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission

Chairperson: Mr Samir Addahre (Morocco)

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Anne-Marie Boisbouvier (Monaco)
Ms Ana Elena Pinto Lizano (Costa Rica)
Ms Xinyu Yang (China)
Ms Sekai Irene Nzenza (Zimbabwe)

SHS Commission: Social and human sciences

Chairperson: Mr Philemon Mjwara (South Africa)

Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Rodolfo Humberto Pérez Hernández (Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of))
Mr Takehiro Kano (Japan)

CLT Commission: Culture

Chairperson: Mr Georgios Koumoutsakos (Greece)

Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Mykola Movchan (Ukraine)
Ms Laura Andrea Guillem Gloria (Colombia)
Ms Nguyen Thi Van Anh (Viet Nam)
Mr Peter K. Ngure (Kenya)

Rapporteur: Mr Salih Abdullah (Libya)

CI Commission: Communication and information

Chairperson: Ms Mumtaz Zahra Baloch (Pakistan)

Vice-Chairpersons: Mr Raúl Fernández Daza (Chile)
Mr Mariusz Lewicki (Poland)
Ms Hajo Sani (Nigeria)
Ms Monique van Daalen (Netherlands (Kingdom of the))

Nominations Committee

Chairperson: Ms Jiřina Valentová (Czechia)

Vice-Chairpersons: Ms Teresa Salado (Portugal)
Mr Alberto Maverengue Augusto (Mozambique)
Mr Dhia Khaled (Tunisia)

Legal Committee

Chairperson: Mr Pierre Michel Eisemann (France)

Vice-Chairperson: Ms Kristine Margret Malang (Philippines)

Rapporteur: Ms Hazar Sassi (Tunisia)

Headquarters Committee

Chairperson: Ms Rosa Batoréu (Portugal)

ANNEX II RECOMMENDATION ON THE ETHICS OF NEUROTECHNOLOGY

PREAMBLE

The General Conference of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO), meeting in Samarkand from 30 October to 13 November 2025, at its 43rd session,

Mindful of the current and potential, profound and dynamic positive and negative impacts of neurotechnology on human lives, including the human mind, and on human health and well-being, societies, environment and ecosystems,

Recalling that, by the terms of its Constitution, UNESCO seeks to contribute to peace and security by promoting collaboration among nations through education, the sciences, culture and communication and information, in order to further universal respect for justice, for the rule of law and for the human rights and fundamental freedoms which are affirmed for the peoples of the world,

Recognizing the leading role of UNESCO at the forefront of the international dialogue, knowledge production and standard setting on the ethics of science and technology and bioethics,

Convinced that the Recommendation presented here, as a standard-setting instrument developed through a global approach, based on international law, focusing on human dignity and human rights, as well as gender equality, social and global justice and sustainable development, physical and mental well-being and health, diversity, interconnectedness, global solidarity, fairness, non-discrimination, inclusiveness and environmental and ecosystem protection and sustainability, can guide the whole life cycle of neurotechnology in a responsible direction,

Guided by the purposes and principles of the Charter of the United Nations,

Considering the significant and growing global prevalence of neurological and mental health conditions, along with the profound suffering they cause for individuals and societies worldwide,

Acknowledging the potential of neurotechnology to offer innovative solutions for better preventive, predictive, diagnostic, therapeutic or rehabilitative purposes, benefitting humanity as a whole and providing opportunities for health promotion in all countries,

Also considering that the application of neurotechnology raises ethical, legal and societal issues and questions related to human dignity and human rights such as autonomy, privacy, mental and physical integrity, personal identity, freedom of thought, risk of discrimination, inequality and challenges to democracy, as well as challenges related to taking into account the ethically significant distinction between the medical and non-medical use of neurotechnology, and the distinction between its use as treatment or with the aim of enhancement,

Also recognizing that it is ethically imperative to explore and harness the potential of neurotechnology, particularly for medical and assistive use, and that failure to pursue such beneficial applications would raise significant ethical questions,

Reaffirming the importance of promoting and protecting the right of everyone to share in scientific advancement and enjoy its benefits,

Further recognizing the pivotal role of universal and meaningful connectivity and affordable access in unlocking the full potential of digital and emerging technologies to close all digital divides and accelerate progress across the Sustainable Development Goals,

Underlining that justice, trust and fairness must be upheld so that no country and no one should be left behind, either by having fair and equitable access to neurotechnology throughout its whole life cycle and enjoying its benefits or ensuring protection against its risks, while recognizing the different circumstances of different countries and respecting the desire of some people not to take part in all technological developments,

Also mindful of the fact that digital and emerging technologies can be critical enablers of development, and **stressing** the need to close all digital divides with a view to ensuring that the benefits of digital and emerging technologies are available to all, without discrimination of any kind,

Emphasizing that specific attention should be paid to lower-middle-income countries (LMICs), including, but not limited to, least developed countries (LDCs), landlocked developing countries (LLDCs) and small island developing States (SIDS), as they have their capacity but have been underrepresented in the development and access to neurotechnology,

Also underlining that global cooperation and solidarity facilitates fair and equitable access to neurotechnology and enables the realization of the full potential benefits of neurotechnology, while addressing the ethical, legal and societal challenges, mitigating against unintended harmful consequences, risks associated to potential dual use, misuse or malicious use, or unethical practices

and ensuring that national neurotechnology strategies are guided by ethical principles in full respect of international law, including international human rights law,

Noting that ethical guidelines and frameworks and open science can promote responsible innovation, development and policies aligned with international law, including international human rights law,

Also recalling that in November 2023, the General Conference of UNESCO, at its 42nd session, adopted 42 C/Resolution 29, by which it mandated the Director-General “to prepare a standard-setting instrument on the ethics of neurotechnology in the form of a recommendation”, which is to be submitted to the General Conference at its 43rd session in 2025,

Bearing in mind the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948), the instruments of the international human rights framework, including the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (1966), the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (1965), the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment (1984), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989), and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006), relevant international instruments, recommendations and declarations, the Convention relating to the Status of Refugees (1951), the Discrimination (Employment and Occupation) Convention (1958), the Convention against Discrimination in Education (1960) and the Convention on the Protection and Promotion of the Diversity of Cultural Expressions (2005),

Also noting the Declaration on the Responsibilities of the Present Generations Towards Future Generations (1997), the Universal Declaration on Bioethics and Human Rights (2005), the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (2007), the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (A/RES/70/1) (2015), the Declaration of Ethical Principles in relation to Climate Change (2017), the Recommendation on Science and Scientific Researchers (2017), the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021), the Recommendation on Open Science (2021), the Human Rights Council’s resolution on “Neurotechnology and human rights” (A/HRC/RES/58/6) (2025), the Human Rights Council’s resolution on “New and emerging digital technologies and human rights” (A/HRC/RES/53/29) (2023), Human Rights Council’s resolution on “The right to privacy in the digital age” (A/HRC/RES/42/15) (2019), the International Labour Organization (ILO) Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, as amended (2022), the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (2011), the United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection (2015), the Pact for the Future and its Global Digital Compact (A/RES/79/1) (2024), the Nuremberg Code (1947) and the Declaration of Helsinki - Ethical Principles for Medical Research Involving Human Participants (1964), as amended in 2024,

Further recalling that the obligation and the primary responsibility to promote and protect human rights and fundamental freedoms lie with the State, and that business enterprises, including technology companies, have a responsibility to respect human rights, including by carrying out human rights due diligence by, inter alia, assessing actual and potential human rights impacts, integrating and acting upon the findings, tracking responses and communicating how impacts are addressed, in line with the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights,

Further considering the importance of applying the existing human rights framework to address the challenges and realize the opportunities of neurotechnology, while noting that these technologies may lack adequate regulation, and recognizing the need for effective measures to fully address their adverse human rights impacts,

Recalling that the Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence (2021) recognizes ethical questions related to artificial intelligence (AI) powered systems for neurotechnology and brain-computer interfaces, and that the report of UNESCO’s International Bioethics Committee on ethical issues related to neurotechnology recommends that UNESCO and Member States take various measures to address the challenges identified,

Taking into account the existing ecosystem of national policies as well as other frameworks and initiatives elaborated by relevant United Nations entities, intergovernmental organizations, including regional organizations, as well as by the private sector, professional organizations, non-governmental organizations, civil society and the scientific community, related to the ethics and governance of neurotechnology,

1. **Adopts** the present Recommendation on the Ethics of Neurotechnology on this eleventh day of November 2025;
2. **Recommends** that Member States, with the support of UNESCO’s Secretariat, apply the provisions of this Recommendation by taking appropriate steps, including whatever legislative or other measures may be required, in conformity with the constitutional practice and governing structures of each State, to give effect within their jurisdictions to the principles and norms of the Recommendation in conformity with international law, including international human rights law;
3. **Also recommends** that Member States engage the multi-stakeholder community to ensure that they play their respective roles in the implementation of this Recommendation, and bring the Recommendation to the attention of international, regional and national authorities and bodies, research and academic organizations, and institutions and organizations in public, private and civil society sectors involved in neurotechnology, so that the development and use of neurotechnology are guided by both sound scientific research as well as ethical analysis and evaluation.

I. DEFINITIONS AND SCOPE OF APPLICATION

For the purpose of this Recommendation:

1. **Nervous system.** The nervous system includes the central (brain, cerebellum, brainstem and spinal cord) and peripheral (somatic, autonomic and enteric) nervous system. Scientific evidence demonstrates that nervous system activity is the basis of sensory, motor, including neuromuscular, and mental states (which include cognitive, affective and conative states) and supports consciousness, sleep and the experience of pain. The nervous system activity and structure provide information that is specific to the individuals as well as inherent to all human beings and the community, regardless of gender, ethnicity, language or religion. The nervous system activity is also instrumental in social and cultural interactions.

2. **Neurotechnology.** Neurotechnology refers currently to devices, systems and procedures – encompassing both hardware and software – that directly measure, access, monitor, analyse, predict or modulate the nervous system to understand, influence, restore or anticipate its structure, activity and function. Neurotechnology combines elements of neuroscience, engineering, material science and computing, among others.

3. Neurotechnology spans medical and non-medical applications and includes tools that measure, infer and influence nervous system activity, as well as mental states, whether through direct interaction with the nervous system (both invasive and non-invasive) or by interfacing it with devices and systems. Of note, both open-loop (e.g. fixed-parameter brain stimulation) and closed-loop (e.g. state dependent stimulation) systems introduce complex ethical issues because they affect both physical and mental processes and may have delayed effects. “Medical use” refers to any application of neurotechnology intended for preventive, predictive, diagnostic, therapeutic or rehabilitative purposes in relation to a health condition, including as classified in the World Health Organization’s (WHO) International Statistical Classification of Diseases and Related Health Problems (ICD), the International Classification of Functioning, Disability and Health (ICF) and International Classification of Health Interventions (ICHI), in accordance with internationally accepted medical standards.

4. Neurotechnology includes, but is not limited to:

- (a) Technical tools that measure and analyse physical (e.g. acoustic, electrical, optical, magnetic and/or mechanical), chemical and biological signals associated with the structure of and functional signals from the nervous system (including cell therapy and gene therapy). These may be used to identify, record, predict and/or monitor properties of nervous system activity, understand how the nervous system works, diagnose pathological conditions, or control external devices (brain machine interfaces (BMI), often referred to as brain computer interfaces (BCI)). They may provide real-time feedback and associated stimulation or inhibition based on an open-loop system. Examples include, but are not limited to, electroencephalography (EEG), electromyography (EMG), magnetoencephalography (MEG), magnetic resonance imaging (MRI), magnetic resonance spectroscopy (MRS), functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI), diffusion weighted imaging, focused ultrasound (FUS), positron emission tomography (PET), functional near-infrared spectroscopy (fNIRS), implanted microelectrodes, optogenetics, optical imaging, calcium imaging, voltage dye sensors and microdialysis.
- (b) Technical or interventional tools that interact with the structure or functions of the nervous system to change its activity, for example, to restore sensory input, such as hearing (e.g. cochlear implants) or deep brain stimulation (DBS). They are meant to modulate the functions of the nervous system, send signals directly to the nervous system by applying acoustic, electrical, magnetic, ultrasound or optical stimulation. Examples of this neurotechnology include, but are not limited to, implanted microelectrodes, BMI, DBS, optogenetic optical stimulation, transcranial electrical stimulation (TES), transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS) or ultrasound-targeted drug delivery.

5. **Neural data.** Neural data include qualitative and quantitative data about the structure, activity and function of the nervous system gathered through neurotechnology as defined in this Recommendation. These are the most direct measurements or observations of nervous system states, many of which are correlated with mental states. They encompass data relating to a nervous system’s activity, including both direct measurements of neuronal structure, activity and/or function (e.g. neuronal firing or averaged bioelectric signals from EEG) and indirect functional indicators (e.g. blood flow in fMRI and fNIRS).

6. Of note, several technologies collect biometric data indirectly informing about neural activity. Such biometric data are referred to as **indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences** in this Recommendation. Even if these technologies are not neurotechnology per se, their use to generate information that can interpret or predict mental states raises similar ethical and human rights issues as neurotechnology when used to infer mental states. They could include, but are not limited to, eye tracking, video-oculography, typing dynamics, voice recognition and analysis, gait analysis, skin conductance, heart rate variability, sleep movement monitoring, blood pressure measurement, facial emotion recognition systems, or microbiome measurement.

7. **Whole life cycle.** Neurotechnology should be considered from the early stages starting with its conception, design, algorithm development, decision logic, mining and obtaining raw material for materials, research, prototyping, design and development to deployment and use, including maintenance, operation, trade, financing, monitoring and evaluation, validation, end-of-use, disassembly, termination, disposal and recycling. The whole life cycle of neurotechnology includes its convergence with other technologies and the diversity of actors who are involved in every stage.

This Recommendation:

8. Acknowledges the rapid advancement in technological developments and, in this context, aims to address those features of neurotechnology that are of central ethical relevance.

9. Addresses ethical issues related to the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, as it can have many positive and adverse impacts on, including, but not limited to, human health, human well-being, individuals, communities, societies, the environment and ecosystems, as well as on the enjoyment and respect of human rights and fundamental freedoms.

10. Considers the whole life cycle of neurotechnology for all, and across various fields, including health, and non-medical direct-to-consumer applications, addressing various settings where neurotechnology may be utilized.

11. Also addresses and responds to the ethical and human rights issues raised by the use of neurotechnology within its whole life cycle, as well as any technology allowing mental states inferences.

12. Focuses on the impact on humans and society but acknowledges important ethical considerations that may apply to animals in research and the environment.

13. Approaches ethics of neurotechnology as a systematic normative reflection based on a holistic, multicultural, multidisciplinary, pluralistic and evolving framework of interdependent human rights-based values, principles and actions aiming

at guiding societies in dealing responsibly with the impacts of neurotechnology on human beings, societies and the environment and ecosystems:

- (a) It considers ethics as a dynamic basis for the normative evaluation and guidance of neurotechnology, with human rights, human dignity, well-being, the prevention of harm and mitigation of risk, and freedom of research as a compass and foundation.
 - (b) It draws upon a range of disciplines, including from neuroscience, medicine, engineering, computer science, psychology, ethics, human rights, law, sociology, anthropology and others.
14. Covers the measurement, recording, modification and modulation of the human nervous system, the handling and processing of the data collected throughout their whole life cycle, along with other societal and environmental impacts, including the emergence of new mental states and enhanced mental and physical capabilities.
15. Recognizes that interventions involving the nervous system are particularly sensitive because the highly complex human nervous system is the coordinating centre of behaviour and mental processes. It enables the exercise of individual autonomy including the freedom to make one's own choices, the capacity to act as moral agents, to be responsible for actions, cooperate with others, deliberate about collective decisions and develop personality.
16. Also recognizes that humans develop and flourish in their interaction with other human beings and a nurturing physical and cultural environment.
17. Further addresses ethical and human rights concerns that arise from the rapid developments and the convergence of neurotechnology with other technologies such as spatial computing, immersive technologies and extended reality (XR), AI and its advancements, sensors and semi-conductors. When processed to infer sensory, motor, autonomic function and mental states, other biometric data raise similar ethical concerns. Therefore, this Recommendation applies to both neurotechnology and the use of neural data, as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, ensuring that ethical principles and practices are consistently applied across these domains.
18. Addresses the integration of AI with neurotechnology, which improves the performance and cost of neurotechnology systems. Special awareness should be given to human rights impacts and ethical concerns and potential risks, including cybersecurity concerns, lack of transparency, the potential for algorithmic bias and hallucinations, and risks to autonomy, agency, privacy, including mental privacy, personal identity, and of arbitrary and/or unlawful surveillance, of addiction and other behavioural disorders, and of manipulation.
19. Promotes the peaceful use of neurotechnology and seeks to raise awareness on the profound ethical risks and concerns that may come with a potential dual use, misuse or malicious use of neurotechnology. Urges all concerned to act responsibly with regard to neurotechnology and to respect international law, including international humanitarian law and international human rights law.

II. AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

20. This Recommendation has been created with the aim of guiding the whole life cycle of neurotechnology in ways that are ethical, responsible, safe, secure, transparent, trustworthy and effective for peaceful use and the good of humanity, individuals, communities, societies, the environment and ecosystems, and to prevent harm in the present and the future in compliance with international law, in particular the Charter of the United Nations and international human rights law.
21. The objectives of this Recommendation are:
- (a) to ensure the protection, respect and promotion of human rights and fundamental freedoms, human dignity and equality, including gender equality; to safeguard the interests of present and future generations; to preserve the environment, biodiversity and ecosystems, and promote sustainable development; and to respect cultural diversity during the whole neurotechnology life cycle;
 - (b) to guide the actions of Member States, individuals, groups, communities, institutions, research organizations, private sector companies and every other relevant actor to ensure that ethical principles and international human rights law are upheld in all stages of the neurotechnology life cycle;
 - (c) to promote the responsible development and use of neurotechnology to provide innovative healthcare and the best possible diagnostic and therapy options;
 - (d) to ensure that neurotechnology in its whole life cycle is science- and evidence-based, reliable and reproducible, and should be evaluated continuously through research for its safety, effectiveness, efficiency, accessibility and quality, allowing for the anticipation of risk;
 - (e) to provide a universal framework that not only articulates values and principles but also translates into concrete policy recommendations and effective implementation to guide Member States in their engagement with neurotechnology in its whole life cycle, consistent with their obligations under international law, including human rights law, and international standards;
 - (f) to foster inclusive multi-stakeholder, multidisciplinary and pluralistic dialogue and consensus building about ethical issues relating to neurotechnology;
 - (g) to promote justice and equitable access to developments and knowledge in the field of neurotechnology and the equitable sharing of benefits, with particular attention to the needs and contributions of LMICs, including LDCs, LLDCs and SIDS;

- (h) to ensure solidarity among all actors involved in different stages of the whole life cycle of neurotechnology and accountability to prevent misuse of neurotechnology and to uphold human rights, fundamental freedoms and ethical standards.

III. VALUES AND PRINCIPLES

22. Values play a powerful role as motivating ideals in shaping policy measures and legal norms. While the set of values outlined below thus inspires desirable behaviour and represents the foundations of principles, the principles unpack the values underlying them more concretely so that the values can be more easily operationalized in policy statements and actions.

23. While all the values and principles outlined below are desirable per se, in any practical contexts, there may be tensions between these values and principles. In any given situation, a contextual assessment will be necessary to manage potential tensions, taking into account the principle of proportionality and in compliance with human rights and fundamental freedoms.

III.1 VALUES

III.1.1 Respect, protection and promotion of human rights, and fundamental freedoms and human dignity

24. The inherent dignity of every human being is the foundation of universal human rights and fundamental freedoms. Respect, protection and promotion of human dignity and rights, as established by international law, including international human rights law, are essential in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology. Dignity relates to the recognition of the intrinsic and equal worth of each person. Neurotechnology should never be used in ways that undermine the dignity or rights of any individual, including those living in vulnerable situations.

III.1.2 Promoting human health and well-being

25. The research, development and application of neurotechnology that promotes comprehensive human health and well-being should be prioritized, viewing health as a holistic state of physical, mental and social well-being.

26. The responsible allocation of resources for neurotechnology should prioritize preventative, diagnostic, therapeutic, assistive and rehabilitative purposes that benefit the largest number of people. In addition, resources for neurotechnology should be prioritized for people in underserved areas and who are least well off.

III.1.3 Ensuring and respecting diversity and fairness

27. Respect for diversity and fairness should be upheld in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology.

28. Given that widely recognized neurotechnological innovation largely occurs in urban, well-resourced contexts, specific attention to underserved and marginalized people is crucial to prevent bias, ongoing disparities in and beyond healthcare, stigma, neglect and disrespect. Cultural diversity and heritage should be promoted and protected.

29. Equitable access to evidence-based and reliable neurotechnology should be prioritized globally, ensuring that its benefits are accessible to all, regardless of socioeconomic status or geographical location or any other grounds. Special attention should be given to LMICs, resource-constrained settings, as well as to the specific needs of different groups, ages, cultural systems, languages, communities, persons in vulnerable situations, persons with disabilities, neurological disorders and mental health conditions.

30. The use of neurotechnology should be particularly scrutinized to avoid uses that segregate, discriminate, stigmatize, objectify or subordinate individuals or communities, reduce social cohesion by exacerbating pre-existing inequalities or generating novel inequalities that divide and antagonize individuals or communities against each other, and thereby threaten the coexistence between humans, other living beings and the natural environment.

III.1.4 Consideration for cross-cultural perspectives on human knowledge and its sharing

31. Respectful and accessible knowledge sharing across communities and cultures on the human nervous system and its functions fosters trust and strengthens social bonds as well as global cohesion in the pursuit of health and quality of life.

32. It is essential that any research and development involving diverse groups and communities is done with their permission and guidance and conducted with their prior, free and informed consent as well as that of their legal representatives as appropriate and in partnership in ways that serve their interests and respect their traditional knowledge and epistemic contributions.

III.1.5 Global solidarity and international cooperation

33. This Recommendation should guide all actors in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology to act in solidarity and call for accountability in instances where neurotechnology may be used in ways that threaten, violate and abuse international law, including international human rights law. Moreover, international cooperation is essential to addressing cross-border issues related to neurotechnology.

III.1.6 Sustainability

34. Neurotechnology should be developed and used with a deep respect for environmental stewardship, ensuring that ecological harm is minimized throughout the life cycle of the materials used. This includes mining extraction, data processing and storage, recycling and disposal practices and avoiding disproportionate consumption of resources and energy and waste production.

35. Neurotechnology, throughout its whole life cycle, should be guided by a profound respect for the rights of Indigenous Peoples, as set forth in the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (2007) in particular in activities related to resource extraction and waste disposal practices.

III.1.7 Integrity and responsibility

36. Integrity means that all actors in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology adhere to ethical standards, taking responsibility for their actions, being accountable for their outcomes, and taking corrective actions when necessary. It includes ensuring that all actions are ethical, respect human rights and align with both professional standards and societal values.

37. Scientific integrity throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology means committing to the rigorous pursuit of truth through science- and evidence-based, objective and transparent research practices as well as transparent evaluation of research outputs.

III.2 PRINCIPLES

38. This Recommendation embraces a human rights-based and human-centred approach through fundamental ethical principles as elaborated below.

III.2.1 Beneficence, proportionality and do no harm

39. Neurotechnology should promote health and well-being and empower individuals to make free and informed decisions concerning their nervous system and mental health while fostering a better understanding of themselves.

40. Neurotechnology should contribute to human health and well-being without causing avoidable harm, whether physically, economically, socially, politically, culturally or mentally. The “do no harm” principle must guide the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, in order to promote and protect the quality of life.

41. Any restrictions on the exercise and enjoyment of human rights must meet all applicable requirements under international law, including international human rights law.

42. The principles of proportionality, balance and legitimacy should govern the use of neurotechnology and the data it enables, to ensure their use is: (a) appropriate and proportional to the objective and expected benefits that are aimed to be achieved both in medical and non-medical fields; (b) not inconsistent with the foundational values of this Recommendation; (c) appropriate to the context and target user group; and (d) based on safety principles and rigorous scientific evidence.

III.2.2 Autonomy and freedom of thought

43. Throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, the protection and promotion of the rights of autonomy and freedom of thought must be secured and mental and physical integrity should be protected from any unwanted and harmful interference.

44. For the purpose of this Recommendation, autonomy is understood to be both individual and relational. It reflects a person's own self-determination as well as their community ties that support and give meaning to their choices. As neurotechnology evolves and increasingly interacts with the human nervous system, it must account for the individual and relational nature of autonomy throughout its whole life cycle.

45. Individuals are entitled and should be empowered to make free, informed and voluntary decisions about their engagement with neurotechnology throughout the whole life cycle, in accordance with international law, including international human rights law, and in line with ethical principles and legal standards for informed consent and other international standards. It is important to safeguard against any implicit and explicit coercion to use neurotechnology. Special attention should be given to children and adolescents and persons in vulnerable situations.

46. The procedures for expressing consent are those determined by frameworks, including national law and applicable international law. Consent should be prior, free and informed. Informed consent procedures should guarantee the free and informed nature of the consent (opt-in) and be affirmative, dynamic, iterative, comprehensive transparent and adequately documented. These should provide, in all the neurotechnology application domains, understandable, detailed and accessible information about the purposes, risks, benefits, alternatives and outcomes of the use of neurotechnology. Informed consent and assent should be adapted to and respectful of the individual's age, decision-making capacity, culture, language, education level and mental and physical condition. In cases of persons who are unable to give consent, the authorization of their legal representatives or guardians is to be sought. The will and preferences of the person being represented must be respected. Informed consent must always include the entitlement to refuse or withdraw from using neurotechnology at any time, particularly when individuals are in a power imbalance situation.

47. Neurotechnology should never be used to exert undue influence or manipulation, whether through force, coercion, perception of disadvantage, social pressure or other means that compromise autonomy and freedom of thought. This protection should cover both the internal processing of thoughts and their external expression.

III.2.3 Protection of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences

48. Neurotechnology and other technologies that collect indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences raise issues pertaining to the right to privacy due to their increasing ability to collect direct and indirect data about the nervous system that is uniquely sensitive.

49. Privacy, including mental privacy, is fundamental for personal identity and agency, as well as for the protection of human dignity. The collection, processing, modification and sharing of neural data, as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences require prior, free and informed consent of the person concerned, with the exception of life-threatening medical emergency situations, as recognized in international frameworks, in ways that safeguard and respect international law, including international human rights law, and the values and principles outlined in this Recommendation.

50. There should be clear safeguards against the collection and misuse or unauthorized access or processing of neural data, as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, including prior, free and informed consent, data minimization and purpose limitation, autonomy over data, including to access, correct, erase and suspend processing of data, as well as data security and protection, particularly in contexts where such data might be aggregated with other sources.

III.2.4 Non-discrimination and inclusivity

51. All actors involved in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, particularly in its interface with other technologies such as AI, have a shared responsibility to ensure that these technologies do not perpetuate or amplify existing or new forms of inequalities or discrimination based on neurological or mental characteristics, or any other grounds in accordance with international law, including international human rights law.

52. The development and definition of standards for neurotechnology should be inclusive in order to preserve human dignity and guarantee the protection of cultural and collective identities and to prevent homogenization and respect neurodiversity. No one may be discriminated against because they do not use or refuse to use neurotechnology.

53. In order to contribute to the definition of the common good and to the social acceptance of neurotechnology, governments and neurotechnology stakeholders should engage in a transparent and concrete public dialogue with citizens, public organizations and other stakeholders and include them in the decision-making process. Social acceptance regarding uses of neurotechnology should not replace individuals' prior, free and informed consent to such uses.

54. Care should be taken to evaluate neurotechnology solutions promoted through governments or other stakeholders for essential services.

III.2.5 Accountability

55. All actors in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology should adhere to ethical principles in order to prevent, anticipate and address potential harms – whether short-term, long-term or arising from unintended use and impact. They should commit to taking due diligence steps to identify, prevent, mitigate and account for how they address and redress any adverse impacts. They should also commit to adjusting practices in response to new evidence or ethical concerns, to remaining open to feedback, and to clear and transparent communication.

56. Member States should ensure that those who suffered harm by neurotechnology have timely access to justice and effective remedy. They should work together with all stakeholders to ensure that those responsible for these harms are held accountable.

III.2.6 Trustworthiness and transparency

57. Trustworthiness implies that people should have good reason to trust that neurotechnology applications can bring individual and shared benefits, while adequate measures are taken to mitigate risks. An essential requirement for trustworthiness is the monitoring of the whole life cycle of neurotechnology by all the stakeholders, as appropriate.

58. All actors throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology should ensure that their activities are transparent, safe and secure, grounded in scientific evidence, and aligned with international principles of responsible conduct and scientific integrity, regardless of whether neurotechnology is used in medical contexts or non-medical contexts, or when devices infer or interfere with mental states. This includes preventing the replication or amplification of biases, reinforcing the traceability and explainability of neurotechnology and ensuring its capacities and limitations are accurately portrayed, the conditions for accountability are clearly defined, adhering to ethical guidelines in research and development, including in the use of neurotechnology for medical purposes, the registration of trials, fair participant selection and review or approval by independent ethics committees.

III.2.7 Epistemic justice, inclusive engagement and public empowerment

59. Fair and equitable distribution and creation of knowledge about neurotechnology should be promoted, and participation of all individuals and communities in its creation, sharing and applications should be encouraged.

60. Open and accessible education, along with public and community engagement should be promoted to ensure that diverse populations can gain and exchange knowledge about nervous system functioning, mental health, medical and non-medical applications and tools of neurotechnology, and to foster active participation of the society.

61. Effective public and community engagement throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology requires respect for diversity, including linguistic, social, cultural, heritage and identity. This respect for diversity aims to ensure that the knowledge and perspectives of diverse communities are valued and included in decision-making processes, and that autonomy is respected.

62. All communities should have a voice in decisions that concern them when it comes to neurotechnology, at all stages of its life cycle.

III.2.8 Best interests of the child and protection of future generations

63. When neurotechnology is used on children, it is essential to uphold the rights of the child, understood to be persons under 18 years, as enshrined in relevant international law, in particular the right to privacy, freedom of thought and the right to express their views freely in all matters affecting them, while respecting, as applicable, the responsibilities, rights and duties of parents or legal guardians. This includes a firm commitment to the holistic development of every child – intellectually, emotionally, socially and physically. Neurotechnology must be deployed in ways that nurture children's autonomy, protect their mental and physical integrity, foster meaningful human relationships and promote well-being through balanced, healthy lifestyles. In the case of children with disabilities or cognitive conditions, the use of neurotechnology must be rigorously assessed to ensure that it consistently serves the best interests of the child, supports their healthy development, well-being and autonomy, while respecting human diversity and internationally accepted ethical and clinical protocols. Likewise, it must be rigorously evaluated to ensure full inclusion in society, equal opportunities, participation in cultural life and accessibility, especially in education, inclusive sports, para-sports, communication and information.

64. The nervous system is rapidly evolving from gestation, during childhood and critically changing during adolescence, which makes it crucial to preserve the rights of children and adolescents. The use of neurotechnology in children, understood as persons under 18 years, should be limited for medical and therapeutic purposes, as well as other well-justified scientifically proven applications that can be demonstrably shown to serve the best interests of the child. This includes applications that guarantee children with disabilities and cognitive conditions inclusive access to culture, communication, information and sports. Such uses

must be grounded in sound scientific research, subject to rigorous evidence-based assessment and ethical scrutiny, and must ensure full respect for the rights and best interests of the child.

65. In advancing responsible development and use of neurotechnology, particular attention should be paid to the needs of future generations and to preserve their interests.

III.2.9 Global and social justice, enjoying the benefits of scientific progress and its applications

66. Access to and benefits arising from research and development in neurotechnology should be shared equitably among all stakeholders, with a particular focus on ensuring global distribution that promotes fairness and reduces disparities, in accordance with international obligations.

67. Neurotechnology developments should be leveraged to reduce global health inequities and to improve the quality of life, particularly in resource-limited settings.

68. Efforts, including international cooperation, should be made to overcome, and never take advantage of, the lack of necessary technological or medical infrastructure, education and skills, as well as ethical and legal frameworks in neurotechnology, particularly in LMICs, LDCs, LLDCs and SIDS, affecting communities.

69. The development and impact assessment of neurotechnology applications should consider the implementation of human rights-based and human-centred paradigms to ensure that end users are not merely passive recipients of the technologies but actively participate in the whole life cycle.

IV. AREAS OF POLICY ACTIONS

70. UNESCO recognizes that Member States are at different stages of readiness to implement this Recommendation, in terms of scientific, technological, economic, educational, legal, regulatory, infrastructural, societal, cultural and other dimensions. It is noted that “readiness” here is a dynamic status.

IV.1 GOVERNMENT INVESTMENT, USE AND REGULATION

71. Member States, national and international institutions and private actors should actively support research of high-quality and science-based development, deployment and responsible use neurotechnology for the public good. Investments should be directed to applications that foster human health and well-being, the use of which respects, protects and promotes human rights. This should include funding for interdisciplinary research that not only advances neurotechnological innovation but also studies the ethical, safety and security, legal, social, psychological, environmental and cultural implications of these technologies, and supports the implementation and clinical translation of technological prototypes. Particular attention should be given, also by the private sector, to the development and implementation of adequate technical, institutional, procedural and other safeguards to mitigate risks of neurotechnology and to ensure that it equitably benefits society and that human rights and the rule of law are upheld.

72. Member States should establish or strengthen, as necessary, the oversight and enforcement capacity relevant to neurotechnology development and deployment, and sectors where neurotechnology is being applied to allow more effective measures to protect against human rights risks relating to neurotechnology.

73. Member States should ensure that ethical and human rights due diligence, including regular, comprehensive human rights impact assessments are conducted for the neurotechnology that they develop, design, deploy, use, sell, operate or procure, in order to prevent or mitigate their possible adverse human rights impacts, in the short and long run.

74. Member States should ensure that any use of neurotechnology in the justice system, including its consideration by the judiciary, should be grounded in scientific evidence and implemented ethically in accordance with human rights and the rule of law. In this context, Member States should guarantee due process and fair trial, including the presumption of innocence, and that individuals are not compelled to testify against themselves or confess guilt. Any use of neurotechnology, in judicial proceedings should have strong and robust oversight mechanisms, including strong data protection, privacy, consent and freedom of thought protection, fair trials or hearings and human rights standards.

75. Neurotechnology shall not be used for any kind of social control, attempts at coercive behavioural conformity based on personal beliefs or thoughts, political or other opinions, gender, or arbitrary and/or unlawful surveillance of mental states, as well as for torture or cruel, inhuman or degrading treatment or punishment.

76. Member States should ensure that neurotechnology is developed and deployed responsibly, with respect for international human rights law, with robust independent oversight mechanisms to foster adherence to these restrictions and protect privacy, including mental privacy, and freedom of thought for all individuals. These policies should be developed in inclusive dialogue with diverse actors, including civil society, end users, neurotechnology experts, ethicists and human rights defenders, to ensure broad consensus and respect for international law, including international human rights law.

77. Member States should ensure transparency and accountability in their support, oversight and regulation of neurotechnology, particularly in publicly funded initiatives such as research in the field of mental health, brain and brain health and overall health research and development programmes. Governments should require, as appropriate, neurotechnology projects to publicly disclose the objectives, methodologies, intended uses, results, potential risks, identified risks and societal impacts of their neurotechnology initiatives as soon as this information is suitable for public disclosure. This transparency is crucial for fostering public trust and ensuring that neurotechnology advances are aligned with ethical standards as set forth in this Recommendation, and with international law, including international human rights law.

78. Member States should apply a comprehensive approach to regulatory and policy measures to protect against human rights related harms of neurotechnology developed, marketed, operated or used by the private sector and public sector. The private sector should apply the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, and States should establish a national framework, including oversight mechanisms, with respect to neurotechnology companies. This comprehensive approach includes regulatory measures and accompanying guidance, ongoing risk monitoring and assessment, incentives and transparency

requirements, meaningful public and community engagement, and transparent communications. States should ensure access to timely and effective remedy for those affected by human rights violations in the context of neurotechnology.

79. Member States should consider establishing comprehensive incentive structures, such as tax incentives, grants and awards, to promote and enable innovation ecosystems participatory and transparent for neurotechnology development for medical applications, and to strengthen capabilities within public research institutions to contribute to societal benefits.

80. Member States should establish a coordinated, comprehensive, transparent, multi-stakeholder, cross-sectoral and multidisciplinary approach to assessing the impacts of neurotechnology as a general technology class across its whole life cycle. This technology assessment should be conducted, managed and/or overseen by relevant competent entities, including international bodies, as appropriate. This approach involves meaningful public, stakeholder and community engagement, and could include, but is not limited to:

- (a) Human rights impact assessments: to identify, prevent and mitigate potential adverse impacts of neurotechnology on human rights, with particular attention to vulnerable people and those living in vulnerable situations;
- (b) Economic and social impact assessments: to assess how neurotechnology impacts economic growth, decent work, social justice and environmental sustainability;
- (c) Benefit-risk assessments: to evaluate the risks and benefits associated with the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, including research, clinical applications and consumer products, including risks that manifest after withdrawal of technology and guarantee access to medical care, when appropriate;
- (d) Privacy impact assessments: to evaluate and mitigate risks to individuals' right to privacy posed by neurotechnology, including ensuring appropriate safeguards to protect neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences in compliance with applicable national and international privacy standards and the data policy actions set forth in this Recommendation;
- (e) Ethical assessments: to identify and respond to ethical concerns.

81. Member States should promote equitable access to science- and evidence-based, safe and reliable neurotechnology worldwide that fosters health and the common good. To achieve such goals, efforts should be made to support the reduction of final costs for end users, pursue the development, adoption and continuous support of non-proprietary software solutions, and explore reimbursement strategies or subsidization commensurate with conventions in local jurisdictions.

82. Member States should consider intellectual property (IP) development strategies that incentivize innovation and promote open science and access to and dissemination of neurotechnology, as well as the sharing of its benefits. The impact of IP policies on the neurotechnology sector should be holistically and continuously monitored, paying particular attention to the risks associated with the commodification and commercialization of living organisms and the human body.

83. Member States should consider adopting agile and risk-based tiered regulatory frameworks. These may include the use of regulatory sandboxes – controlled environments for designing, developing, testing, evaluating, verifying and validating neurotechnology – in response to rapid advancements in neurotechnology and its convergence with other technologies such as AI, spatial computing and immersive technologies. These frameworks should facilitate innovation, ensure ethical data processing, prevent harm and safeguard rights by incorporating mechanisms for regular monitoring, evaluation and dynamic policy adjustments in line with technological and ethical developments.

84. When Indigenous Peoples are involved or impacted at any stage during the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, Member States and other actors should take measures in line with the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples to ensure that their rights are respected and protected to safeguard their meaningful participation with prior, free and informed consent through processes that are accessible in their languages and contexts, and to prevent interference with their traditional or ancestral knowledge systems or cultural sovereignty. When Indigenous knowledge is involved, open science processes and IP management strategies should be developed in collaboration with Indigenous Peoples from the beginning.

IV.2 DATA POLICY

85. Member States should develop robust, fair and agile regulatory and legal frameworks to govern the collection, processing, sharing and all other uses of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, as appropriate. New and existing frameworks should consider both neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences as sensitive personal data.

86. Member States should ensure that their existing privacy policies comprehensively cover stringent safeguards for individuals' neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences. If current policies do not adequately address these areas, Member States should adopt targeted safeguards in existing or new legislation or regulatory frameworks to secure these protections. Such legislation or frameworks should prohibit the practice of tying access to goods or services to the disclosure of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, require explicit opt-in or a legal basis for any data sharing, and forbid the use of such data for targeted advertising without the individual's prior, free and informed consent.

87. Member States should develop and implement specific policies that ensure that the ecological footprint of neurotechnology is sustainable, particularly in relation to large-scale data centres and computing resources used for processing and storage of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences. These policies should emphasize data minimization, to ensure that only the necessary amount of data is collected and processed, and promote the proportional use of neurotechnology, aligning its deployment with genuine needs and minimizing unnecessary environmental impact. These policies should include optimizing energy efficiency, using renewable energy sources, promoting the recycling and sustainable disposal of neurotechnology-related equipment, and ensuring the rehabilitation of affected environments.

88. Member States should support and incentivize the development and implementation of technological innovations and design standards for neurotechnology that improve the protection of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, such as state-of-the-art encryption, secure databases with multi-factor authentication, cutting-edge anonymization techniques, and edge-processing and storage (processing and storing data closer to where they are generated).

89. Member States should incentivize neurotechnology manufacturers to prioritize privacy and a code of ethics by design, facilitating the incorporation of privacy-preserving technologies as default features in their devices.

90. Member States should encourage data sharing in compliance with relevant data protection law, and in line with principles set forth in this Recommendation, by establishing safe and secure data repositories for neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences used in research. These repositories should meet stringent cybersecurity, data privacy and ethical use standards (including data minimization and purpose limitations), tiered access and other privacy-enhancing approaches. Appropriate funding mechanisms should be established for the curation and maintenance of data, and data governance processes should be streamlined.

91. Member States should prioritize efforts to facilitate cross-border data sharing in neurotechnology research, in compliance with relevant data protection law, working towards greater alignment of data protection standards, particularly concerning neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, by establishing clear protocols for data transfer for secure, risk-based and compliant data exchanges across borders, and standards for interoperability of data, including governance frameworks for data sharing, while taking into account existing mechanisms and guidelines for privacy protection and data governance, including adequate information and prior, free and informed consent.

92. Member States should consider specific guidelines for the ethical use of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences in AI development and research, including ethics and privacy by design approaches and consent procedures for their uses in the training and application of AI models, if current policies do not adequately address these areas, ensuring transparency and respecting individual and community rights and IP, as applicable.

IV.3 SECURITY

93. Member States should collaborate internationally to establish comprehensive standards for cybersecurity across all neurotechnology domains. These standards should encompass hardware, software and data security measures to protect against potential cyber threats and information and communication technology threats. By establishing uniform cybersecurity standards, Member States should enable an environment that fosters and promotes the integrity, confidentiality, security and availability of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, and enhance user trust and confidence in neurotechnology devices, including applying a secure by design approach. Additionally, these standards should evolve in tandem with technological advancements and emerging cyber threats to maintain robust protection against evolving risks.

94. Member States should adopt and maintain a cybersecurity standards framework for neurotechnology, as applicable, that implements existing international frameworks and leading methodologies from industries, the public and private sectors, academia and civil society to model, predict, avoid and mitigate cybersecurity threats. Such a framework should employ, but not be limited to, policy protocols, risk assessment prioritization, security controls, data encryption, key performance indicator (KPI) optimization and privacy compliance for cybersecurity effectiveness.

95. Member States should encourage and facilitate, as appropriate, red-teaming exercises – adversarial challenges to test the efficacy of security systems – as a proactive measure to assess and enhance the safety, security and resilience of neurotechnology systems. By conducting regular red-teaming exercises, Member States should seek to proactively identify and address security gaps, test incident response procedures, and strengthen the overall safety and cybersecurity posture of neurotechnology devices.

IV.4 COMMUNICATION, ENGAGEMENT AND INFORMATION

96. Member States should promote communication and develop engagement policies for neurotechnology throughout its whole life cycle that foster informed, inclusive and respectful dialogue between researchers, developers, diverse users, media and the broader public to respect individual and community rights, promote public trust and harness the collective intelligence and diversity of communities.

97. Member States should collaborate with national and international organizations, educational institutions, media, private and non-governmental entities, and public and civil society organizations to develop and disseminate science-based, accessible and engaging educational materials that are age, contextually, culturally and linguistically appropriate, and establish transparent platforms to inform the public about possible societal or individual adverse effects. These should be tailored to diverse audiences to bridge knowledge gaps, particularly in underserved regions, about the nervous system functioning and mental and brain health, as well as the functionality, safety, benefits and risks of neurotechnology. These programmes should aim to empower individuals to make informed decisions and to enable their ethical reflection about their use of neurotechnology, including their supportive use at home, both for the users and for caregivers and family members.

98. Member States should implement public and community engagement processes that facilitate genuine mutual learning and collaboration throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology. These processes should include regular and inclusive consultations with a wide array of actors. The aim of these engagements should be to inform policy development, shape ethical guidelines, increase public awareness and understanding, shape investment priorities, and ensure that neurotechnology deployment aligns with public interests and values. Special attention should be given to involving groups traditionally underrepresented in technological policymaking, thereby fostering responsible innovation in the field of neurotechnology.

99. Member States should collaborate in the co-creation and dissemination of accurate, precise and understandable language and terminology for discussing neurotechnology that involves actors from diverse backgrounds so that the language used is inclusive, non-stigmatizing and accurately reflects the technologies' capabilities and limitations. Regulatory frameworks should

address fraudulent or misleading reporting of capabilities, risks and limitations across all applications to avoid exaggeration of claims including, but not limited to applications in sleep, attention, memory and emotional regulation. Member States should encourage evidence-based communications, including with the media, about early-stage research and capabilities, risks and limitations across all neurotechnology applications.

100. Member States should foster effective collaboration between end users, researchers and innovators throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology product development, for example through establishing platforms for ongoing dialogue and feedback between researchers, developers and representatives from various user groups, especially persons with disabilities, while respecting all diversities, including neurodiversity, and involving them in the process of developing and testing new neurotechnology products to optimize device efficacy, safety and quality, usability, longevity and sustainability.

IV.5 GENDER EQUALITY

101. Member States should adopt and enforce comprehensive policies that promote and respect gender equality in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology. The policies should prioritize inclusive research for addressing gender-specific needs and differences, require targeted sex-disaggregated data collection and analysis, include education and training programmes on inclusive research practices, ensure public and community engagement with gender health experts and advocacy groups and incentivize gender-responsive technology design. Targeted policies are necessary to close gender gaps in these fields and increase representation, engagement and leadership.

102. Member States should establish clear guidelines and legal frameworks to ensure that workplaces and research environments, throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology, are gender inclusive, representative and free from harassment and discrimination. These should include robust mechanisms for reporting and addressing incidents of gender-based harassment, discrimination and violence to ensure accountability and support.

103. Member States should adopt a range of measures that prioritize ethical and equitable research and innovation and support programmes that promote gender equality in neurotechnology, encouraging participation throughout its whole life cycle. This should include policies and initiatives to close the gender gap in neurotechnology through targeted education and mentorship programmes, networking and employment opportunities, entrepreneurship support, leadership development and public awareness-raising campaigns within the sector and developing indicators to evaluate the impact of these measures. Member States should also actively work to eliminate the barriers that hinder or prevent women from participating or succeeding in the neurotechnology field.

HEALTH AND RESEARCH ETHICS

IV.6 HEALTH

104. Member States should support the development of health applications for unmet medical needs in the provision of neurological and mental health. This should include establishing and supporting research programmes specifically targeted at addressing identified gaps in nervous system care.

105. Member States should build and maintain international solidarity and foster dialogue and cooperation to address global health risks and uncertainties and ensure that their implementation of healthcare for the nervous system is consistent with international law, including international human rights law, as well as medical and scientific standards.

106. Member States should establish oversight mechanisms, if they do not already exist, to evaluate the physical and mental health impacts as well as the socialization effects of long-term use of neurotechnological devices, with special attention to invasiveness and reversibility of neurotechnology interventions and to the potential harm caused by the removal of invasive neurotechnology. This should include implementing regulatory measures requiring long-term follow-up studies for approved neurotechnology devices and establishing clear criteria for continued approval based on these studies results.

107. Member States should consider the significant cost and impact associated with pathologies related to the nervous system, as well as the potential benefits of early diagnosis and access to preventive, assistive and rehabilitative neurotechnology. Public policies should promote access to these technologies and aim to ensure health cost coverage for individuals in need.

108. Member States should promote the development of reliable, safe and durable neurotechnology for healthcare applications. This should include the design of devices and systems that require minimal maintenance, to ensure they remain safe, functional and effective under varying conditions. Regulatory bodies or designated authorities should oversee the enforcement of standards for quality, safety and longevity, and address obsolescence, thereby reducing the burden on users and enhancing the dependability and sustainability of neurotechnological solutions, as well as continuity of access to these solutions when developers and suppliers cease to provide access or can no longer do so.

109. Member States should develop or strengthen existing comprehensive neurotechnology medical device reporting systems that track and address adverse effects. These systems should pool pertinent observations from health personnel and patients alike. In contexts where such systems do not exist, Member States should establish them. Where systems are already in place, they should be updated to specifically include neurotechnology. These systems should be interoperable and, where appropriate, contribute to a centralized, public and transparent international database in case it is permitted by their national laws, managed in collaboration with international organizations and accessible for public knowledge, oversight and research, while ensuring that patient privacy, data security and IP rights are protected. Member States should consider the establishment of national registries of neurotechnology interventions supported by policy and infrastructure mechanisms.

IV.7 RESEARCH ETHICS

110. Member States should reinforce the ethical frameworks governing neurotechnology research to ensure robust protection and the non-exploitative participation of all individuals involved. Special attention should be given to ensure that those contributing to research and development have their fair share of the benefits and do not bear disproportionately the risks. Individuals participating in research should, along with other informed consent requirements, be informed of potential side effects, including in the long term, and given the opportunity to disclose if they have contraindications for the procedures used. Furthermore, due

consideration should be given to the potential dual use, misuse or malicious use of neurotechnology research to avoid its use for malign purposes.

111. Member States should adopt clear guidelines or policies that define the qualifications required to ensure that research is conducted by professionals with appropriate knowledge about the nervous system structure, including information about brain disorders as well as knowledge of the communities where they are working, and is performed in adequate research settings. Furthermore, research protocols, public or private, in the medical as well as the non-medical domain, should be carefully evaluated by independent, multidisciplinary and pluralist research ethics committees with specific consideration for individuals with diminished or without capacity to give informed consent or to make decisions, including the objection to participate, and for those in vulnerable situations. Member States should seek to ensure that all research institutions require their staff to be appropriately trained and experienced to perform their tasks ethically and responsibly.

112. Member States should encourage multi-centre international research that involves various cultures and ethnic groups. Member States should promote international cooperation to develop common reporting standards and protocols for interoperability, particularly for implantable neurotechnology devices. This cooperation should aim to enhance the comparability and utility of research globally, improving both the efficacy and ethical integrity of research.

113. Member States should ensure that the whole life cycle of neurotechnology is considered in the design of a trial, including policies to protect participants in case of cessation of activities of the trial sponsor or promoter, as well as post-trial support for continued access for participants, where needed. Member States should establish requirements for clinical trials to be included in relevant nationally or internationally approved registries and encourage registration with community and participant registries. Also, trials should report on appropriate medical device reporting systems developed within Member States.

114. Technology developers should ensure that the validation of AI algorithms in neurotechnology research include rigorous testing and monitoring for biases, as well as measures to ensure human oversight and enhance fairness, explainability and transparency, including the provenance of training datasets. Suitable techniques should be employed to mitigate any biases present in AI models used in neurotechnology applications.

115. Member States should promote research efforts that do not only focus on biomedical risks associated with neurotechnology. Understanding how neurotechnology may impact aspects of self-perception, consciousness, agency identity and interpersonal relationships is essential for addressing safety and ethical concerns and ensuring the well-being of individuals using these technologies. Social and societal effects of a widespread use should also be considered. Member States should encourage and support longitudinal studies into the long-term impacts of the uses of neurotechnology.

116. Member States should, as appropriate, ensure that those engaged in neurotechnology research implement regular and independent auditing and monitoring of research practices to ensure adherence to ethical standards. This should include evaluating the adequacy of prior, free and informed consent, particularly concerning reuse of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences.

117. Member States should require researchers in neurotechnology to establish clear and transparent protocols for communicating clinically significant and actionable incidental findings to participants. These protocols should ensure that such findings are conveyed promptly, respecting participants' rights and autonomy. The informed consent process should clearly outline what these findings might entail, the participants' option to choose whether they wish to be informed about such findings, and guarantee that their decisions, or the decision of the relevant legal representatives, as appropriate, in this regard will be respected throughout the study or treatment. Additionally, Member States should mandate that researchers provide the necessary support and coordination with healthcare providers to address any health concerns that arise from these findings.

SPECIFIC DOMAINS OF APPLICATION OUTSIDE OF HEALTH

IV.8 EDUCATION

118. Neurotechnology for the purpose of non-therapeutic performance optimization should not be used for children with full health and cognitive function, as defined by WHO, understood as persons under 18 years. The use of neurotechnology in education could be permitted for certain legitimate pedagogical purposes such as assisting students with learning difficulties, including persons with disabilities or cognitive conditions, or promoting technological literacy, provided that it is compatible with the human rights, health, well-being and non-discrimination of students, as well as their prior, free and informed consent or assent, as appropriate. Such uses must also be evidence-based, evaluated in advance, correspond to legitimate educational objectives and be limited to what is necessary to achieve such objectives. Member States should be encouraged to develop national guidelines to that end.

119. Member States should approach with caution the integration of neurotechnology in education, ensuring that its use is science- and evidence-based, assessed ex-ante, aligned with the education goals and complements traditional learning methods. If neurotechnology is integrated into education, emphasis should be placed on promoting the holistic and inclusive development of students, focusing not just on academic performance but also on mental health, well-being and overall interests. It is also important to train educators properly so that they are able to deploy neurotechnology appropriately in educational environments.

120. To ensure inclusivity, Member States should develop age-appropriate guidelines for neurotechnology use across different educational stages, taking into account individual differences in cognitive development and learning needs. Regular assessments of neurotechnology's impact on student development, including mental and brain health, should be conducted, with ethical review processes established to oversee deployment. The primary focus should be on fostering critical thinking, creativity and social-emotional skills rather than solely improving academic performance or guiding young people strictly according to the specific needs of the labour market.

121. Member States should adopt policies ensuring that the voluntary deployment of neurotechnology in education are grounded in prior, free and informed consent. Policies governing the use of neurotechnology in education should include clear, age-appropriate information about the technology's purpose, benefits and risks, with adequate consideration periods. Consent and assent procedures for minors should involve children, adolescents, parents, guardians and all actors necessary. Ethical

oversight mechanisms should be established, including regular informed consent renewal and immediate cessation of neurotechnology use upon withdrawal, and ensure anonymous feedback channels. Policies should prohibit undue incentives or academic penalties for non-participation and take measures to avoid creating or reinforcing inequalities among students. Policies should also prohibit the use of neurotechnology in performance evaluation of students and educators. Additionally, Member States should support student and educator involvement in decision-making about neurotechnology integration, and fund training programmes on its ethical use, empowering educators and students to critically assess its application.

122. Member States should establish a unified, robust and independent oversight mechanism for neurotechnology use at all levels of educational settings, incorporating regular audits, public and community feedback, culturally appropriate and strict adherence to safety, human rights and ethical standards, including an assessment of reversibility on the nervous system. Continuous research should be conducted to assess the short-term and long-term psychological and cognitive impacts of these technologies. Oversight should involve periodic reviews based on empirical evidence to adjust neurotechnology usage as needed, to ensure it serves student development and addresses risks such as dependency or de-skilling. This comprehensive approach can help maintain the safety, effectiveness and alignment of neurotechnology with best practices for student well-being and learning outcomes.

123. Member States should support the inclusion of ethics related to the whole life cycle of neurotechnology into all relevant educational curricula and professional development programmes. This should ensure that all concerned actors, including innovators and business leaders, involved in the whole life cycle of neurotechnology are equipped to critically evaluate the implications of their work.

IV.9 LABOUR AND EMPLOYMENT

124. Member States should establish new or adapt existing policies to govern the use of neurotechnology in the workplace, to promote and protect internationally recognized workers' rights in line with the ILO principles and instruments, especially through tripartite approaches, to safeguard workers' privacy and safety, and to ensure that all deployment of neurotechnology is evidenced-based and has been scientifically validated to promote worker health and well-being. Deployment must be strictly voluntary, and workers must opt in actively and in an informed manner and must have the option to opt out at any time and report abusive use without facing any negative consequences or discrimination. Particular attention must be paid to the relationship of subordination between worker and employer, which leads to high requirements for ensuring prior, free and informed consent. The processing should only be carried out if there is a legal basis, for a legitimate purpose and only to the extent necessary. In principle, consent per se should not constitute a sufficient sole legal basis for intrusive processing using neurotechnology. It is also essential that workers be consulted and able to participate in decisions about the introduction of neurotechnology applications affecting their working conditions. Member States should require employers who use neurotechnology in the workplace to adopt transparent policies that disclose the purpose of the use and limit the scope and location of its use to legitimate purposes in the interest of the worker and third parties (e.g. safety, monitoring fatigue in commercial drivers or tracking attention in air traffic controllers). Under no circumstances should neurotechnology be used for performance evaluation, for punitive measures, in ways that could compromise worker health, to allow profiling or when the risks outweigh potential benefits.

125. Member States should ensure that employers protect the privacy rights of workers if their personal data are processed by their employer using neurotechnology. Employers should be prohibited from collecting and using neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences for any non-agreed or illegitimate purposes, particularly those that could negatively impact a worker's working conditions or privacy. Unauthorized access to or processing of such data that may be collected incidentally during routine workplace monitoring should be prohibited. Employers should not share workers' neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences outside the employer's business and employer's agents without workers' explicit prior approval and only within the scope of a legal basis. Employers should also work to mitigate the risks and comply with relevant laws related to the collection and retention of information regarding workers' disabilities or genetic information, including any worker's family medical history.

126. Member States should, if neurotechnology is used, require employers to clearly provide workers and job seekers with comprehensive training and information, for example, about how neurotechnology used in their workplace works, the benefits it offers, transparency about what data are collected, how they are used and who has access to them, and to clearly disclose any potential risks of its use. Workers should be able to refuse the use of the data collected that concern them personally.

127. Member States should require employers to adopt best practices for data minimization and secure storage of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences, ensure that data are stored securely, with access limited to authorized personnel only, and are deleted once their intended purpose has been fulfilled or the worker has the option to opt out. Additionally, upon a worker's departure, all related records should be fully and automatically deleted or individual data released to the worker, ensuring that no data are retained after the termination of employment.

128. Member States should ensure that when workers are issued multifunctional devices (e.g. earbuds or headphones that also include neural sensors) that can be used at work or at home, employers should be prohibited from collecting neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences outside of workplace settings and working hours and ensure that any data collected during work are used exclusively for legitimate and agreed-upon purposes with the prior, free and informed consent of the worker. Employers should implement technological safeguards to automatically disable data collection outside working hours.

129. Member States should ensure that employers provide workers, upon their request, with a copy of any neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences collected about them, along with any interpretations drawn from it in an accessible and comprehensible manner.

130. Member States should require, through stringent regulations, that any use of neurotechnology in the workplace require worker's explicit, prior, free and informed consent, and only within the scope of a legal basis and for legitimate purposes that demonstrably enhance workplace safety, worker well-being as required by dignity, and not for enhancing productivity or at the expense of worker integrity and health, in particular mental and brain health.

131. Member States should guard against the exploitation of and discrimination against workers and job seekers, by limiting to legitimate purposes the use of neurotechnology for hiring and maintaining employment and by adapting existing or developing new regulations regarding the use of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences for profiling in the workplace, ensuring that hiring practices and workplace policies are fair, inclusive and healthy, particularly regarding mental and brain health.

IV.10 CONSUMER AND COMMERCIAL DOMAINS

132. Member States should proactively establish a regulatory framework that balances innovation in the recreational consumer and commercial domains with protecting individual rights and well-being, taking into account the United Nations guidelines for consumer protection (2015). This framework should be dynamic, allowing for timely updates as technology evolves and as new insights are gained about its impacts on society. This includes providing adequate oversight to ensure that neurotechnology does not cause harm, is used consensually, and includes robust mechanisms to protect users from different types of risks, including psychological risk or manipulation.

133. Member States should strengthen comprehensive consumer protection laws to include clear labelling on commercial neurotechnology products, detailing their effects, limitations and risks to prevent misleading claims and ensure transparency, and provide detailed instructions for use. This should also include prohibiting practices of “tying” or requiring the disclosure of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences as a condition to access goods or services, and prohibiting third party data sharing or the uses of these data without an affirmative opt-in option based on clear and understandable information.

134. Member States should foster an environment that ensures all claims about consumer, non-medical technologies are supported by robust scientific evidence. They should, by regulation, require that any such product claiming to treat, prevent or diagnose diseases or medical conditions be validated through rigorous safety, toxicity and efficacy testing, under appropriate medical supervision. The consumer should be informed of the non-medical nature of the products concerned.

135. Member States should enforce consent processes that are thorough and transparent across all neurotechnological interventions and apply these uniformly in various domains such as sports and arts, where robust standards should safeguard against coercive use and respect athletes’ and artists’ individual autonomy, community interests and IP rights.

136. Member States and international organizations should raise public awareness about the potential advantages, including unfair ones, that neurotechnological applications could provide in competitive domains such as sports and certain artistic disciplines, and consider the potential for such technologies to introduce new inequalities. Member States and international organizations should also consider the positive role neurotechnological applications may play in fostering inclusion for persons with disabilities in these domains and guard against the possibility of these technologies to introduce new inequalities. Member States and international organizations should encourage the creation of systems that require full disclosure of neurotechnology use in any kind of competitive activity.

137. If neurotechnology is used in the arts, Member States should encourage all actors concerned to promote critical and creative reflection, and enhanced cultural learning without compromising individual autonomy or leading to cultural homogenization.

138. Member States and other relevant actors should adopt policies and regulations to prevent the misuse or abuse of neurotechnology for consumers, especially neurogaming and gambling and other devices that exploit the dopamine reward system or seek to induce problematic and unhealthy use and overconsumption. Such regulations should mandate clear labelling of risks as well as disclosures on their effects on the nervous system, and enforce game design standards and safety, privacy and age-appropriate design standards that prevent taking advantage of a person’s physical, mental and emotional vulnerability to lead to compulsive use or addiction of gaming or digital recreational platforms combined with neurotechnology, to promote healthy, balanced use, especially among children.

139. Member States should ensure that devices capable of multiple functions, such as XR glasses or smart earbuds with neural sensors, include hardware-based controls that allow users to selectively disable neurotechnology features while maintaining basic functionality. Regulations should ensure that opt-out features are accessible and straightforward, promoting healthy, balanced use especially among children and persons in vulnerable situations.

140. Member States should address the profound ethical and human rights related questions regarding autonomy, consent, privacy and the potential for manipulation raised by neurotechnology that arise in contexts that include, but are not limited to, recommender systems, priming and nudging, marketing during sleep and dream, neuromarketing and closed-loop environments, by adopting comprehensive policies and regulations that:

- (a) Recommender systems: explicitly prohibit the use of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences in recommender systems for manipulative or deceptive purposes, including in political, medical and commercial contexts. These regulations should require that any use of such data that may in principle be authorized within these systems be based on explicit, informed opt-in consent from users.
- (b) Priming and nudging: govern the use of neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences for priming and nudging – influencing individuals’ decisions or behaviours, often without their explicit awareness and understanding. This is particularly critical in sensitive areas such as political messaging and commercial advertisement where its use is not acceptable. If used in healthcare, the frameworks should require prior, free and informed consent for any use of such data to influence decisions or behaviour, the option to opt out of these systems, and transparency and clear disclosures at the point of data collection, with strict limitations on using data for purposes beyond those explicitly disclosed.
- (c) Marketing during sleep and dream: prohibit the use of neurotechnology that influences or manipulates individuals during sleep, such as marketing during sleep and dream. Regulations should strictly prohibit commercial, marketing or political applications that target individuals during sleep, using neurotechnology or neural data as well as indirect

neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences. Additionally, robust oversight mechanisms should be required to ensure that any research or application of such technologies prioritizes the well-being, privacy and autonomy of individuals, with particular attention to the potential long-term psychological and cognitive impacts of manipulating sleep states.

- (d) Decision neuroscience of consumer behaviour (commonly labelled as “neuromarketing”): safeguard against unethical aims and practices in neuromarketing, including by requiring comprehensive disclosures to ensure that all neuromarketing activities are conducted transparently, with participants’ prior, free and informed consent. This includes ensuring that participants in neuromarketing research or campaigns are fully aware of methods, risks and intentions and affirmatively opt into participation. The use, storage and potential reuse of the collected data should be strictly regulated.
- (e) Closed-loop environments: provide clear regulatory guidelines on the design and use of closed-loop environments, such as immersive computing devices that adjust experiences based on detected neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences. These policies should require clear and accessible disclosure about how neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences are used in these environments, prohibit real-time behavioural modification or manipulation without prior, free and informed consent. Additionally, these policies should implement safeguards specifically designed to prevent abuses such as unauthorized surveillance, manipulative interventions and practices that could influence ways of thinking, decision-making processes or behaviour, ranging from political to commercial choices, or exploit psychological and emotional vulnerabilities in real-time.

IV.11 CONSIDERATION FOR SPECIFIC USERS

141. The development of neurotechnology should bring benefits to all. Traditional population segmentation is presented below with the caveat that the ethical recommendations benefit all.

IV.11.1 Children and adolescents

142. Member States and other stakeholders should safeguard children and adolescents from implicit and explicit coercion to use neurotechnology. Member States and other stakeholders should respect the opinions, rights and best interests of the child, and pay attention to the autonomy of children and adolescents through prior, free and informed consent and assent that is adapted to and respectful of age and decision-making capacity, while also taking into account the rights and duties of parents and legal guardians to protect children and adolescents in their care.

143. Member States should facilitate research and development grants focused on creating user-friendly risk-mitigated assistive neurotechnology tailored for children and adolescents with disabilities. These projects should respect the rights and best interests of the child and involve children, adolescents, parents and caregivers throughout the whole process, including the design, to ensure that the technologies meet their specific needs.

144. Member States should ensure that research involves strict oversight and close follow-up of all neurotechnology research involving children and adolescents. This oversight is crucial during the developmental phases of childhood to address and mitigate any unforeseen long-term effects. Such research must include comprehensive monitoring protocols and periodic evaluations to ensure the ongoing safety and well-being of young participants, respecting their rights, their best interest and their unique developmental needs and vulnerabilities. In the framework of research involving children and adolescents in medically vulnerable situations (e.g. children in epilepsy monitoring units), special attention will be given to consent and assent processes, particularly considering specific aspects of research (time, iterations) to mitigate against any form of instrumentalization. Research conducted on persons under the age of 18 years may only be conducted in accordance with relevant human rights law provisions under international and domestic law.

145. Member States should enact specific regulations to prevent the use of marketing techniques – such as neuromarketing, biometric emotional analytics, immersive advertising and virtual or augmented reality advertising – that rely on neural data as well as indirect neural data and non-neural data allowing mental states inferences collected from children and adolescents. Recognizing the rights and heightened vulnerability of children and adolescents in digital environments, and with regards to children’s and adolescents’ developing brains, especially in areas related to decision-making, these regulations should explicitly forbid any practices that use such data to influence or exploit children and adolescents.

IV.11.2 Older persons

146. Member States should promote healthy aging and support older persons by funding and implementing science- and evidence-based programmes that integrate neurotechnology into routine care. These programmes should involve the entire support ecosystem, including family, caregivers and medical teams, throughout the whole process, including in the design, to ensure that the technologies meet their specific needs. Priority should be given to developing and implementing tools that prevent, delay, treat or assist individuals to overcome age-related health conditions, impairments and neurodegenerative diseases. Member States should ensure that access to these neurotechnology programmes is equitable and does not exacerbate socioeconomic and other existing inequalities.

147. Member States should establish guidelines for neurotechnology design sensitive to the needs of older persons, carefully considering human-computer interface factors for usability (such as fonts, buttons and colours) and experience for enhanced visual and auditory cues.

148. Member States should preserve, support and promote autonomous decision-making for older persons using neurotechnology for sensorimotor and cognitive support. The consent process should accommodate potential cognitive challenges faced by older persons to ensure that consent is prior, free and informed, ongoing and adaptable to changing health conditions. Policies should be in place to ensure that assistive neurotechnology recognizes changing cognitive capacities over time and respects users’ preferences.

IV.11.3 Persons with disabilities

149. Member States should adopt policies that harness the potential of neurotechnology by removing barriers experienced by persons with disabilities and providing support, thereby contributing to achieving full enjoyment of human rights. They should implement regulatory frameworks that ensure the participation and consultation of persons with disabilities to prioritize their needs and preferences. These frameworks should require accessibility assessments for all neurotechnology products to ensure that these products do not perpetuate existing disparities related to disabilities or health. Member States should encourage schools and education systems to promote digital literacy, ensure special needs and inclusive education and promote lifelong learning opportunities.

150. Member States should create incentive programmes to promote the development or deployment of neurotechnology for persons with disabilities to improve their quality of life and independence. These programmes could include tax incentives, research grants and expedited regulatory reviews aiming at advancing effective, affordable and accessible neurotechnology solutions.

151. Member States should work towards making advanced neurotechnology affordable and integrating neurotechnology coverage into, as applicable, national health insurance and other reimbursement schemes for persons with disabilities, for example through public-private partnerships. A national database of available neurotechnology resources and support services should be interoperable, privacy preserving and culturally accessible, and developed to facilitate access and information sharing.

IV.11.4 Persons with mental health conditions

152. Member States should foster research and promote awareness-raising initiatives to address the increasing prevalence and special needs of persons with mental health conditions, including victims and survivors of trauma and violence, and the relevance of neurotechnology for them.

153. Member States should consider allocating funding for long-term advocacy and efficacy studies, post-market oversight and tiered scrutiny with special attention to invasiveness and reversibility of neurotechnology interventions. Research and development should be guided by feedback and engagement with persons with mental health conditions and their advocates and consider risks of treatment with neurotechnology.

154. Member States should support the development and deployment of neurotechnology that is affordable and designed to improve quality of life and daily functioning of individuals with mental health conditions. This should include technologies that assist in managing symptoms, improving cognitive functions and providing emotional support at home, in the workplace, in their communities and in society. It is important to ensure that persons with mental health conditions are rigorously informed and have reasonable expectations about the process.

155. When neurotechnology is applied to the study and treatment of mental disorders, research design, intent and outcomes must be approached with caution to avoid deepening societal discrimination against people with mental disorders.

IV.12 ENHANCEMENT

156. The use of neurotechnology to improve mental (e.g. memory, attention) or physical (e.g. through controlled BCI-based prostheses or devices) human capacities beyond medical need introduces additional complex ethical, social and legal challenges, which can create new kinds of disparities in the world. When neurotechnology is used in these contexts, it raises crucial questions about equity, consent, individual and community autonomy, societal impact and the nature of enhancement of the nervous system itself. Member States should ensure that any policies, law and regulatory frameworks that govern the whole life cycle of neurotechnology in these contexts do not exacerbate social inequalities or lead to discrimination, address the potential risks (including to reversibility, invasiveness and risks to autonomy), uphold human dignity and comply with international law, including international human rights law. Member States should encourage research regarding the potential risks and significant ethical implications of such use of neurotechnology both for individuals as well as society as a whole.

V. IMPLEMENTATION

157. Member States and all other actors as identified in this Recommendation should respect, promote and protect the ethical values, principles and standards set forth in this Recommendation, and should take all appropriate steps to give effect to its implementation.

158. Member States should – according to their specific contexts, governing structures and constitutional provisions – credibly and transparently advance the ethics of neurotechnology, in line with this Recommendation. Member States should, as appropriate, monitor and evaluate policies, programmes and mechanisms related to neurotechnology and its ethics. Progress monitoring could rely on a combination of quantitative and qualitative approaches.

159. Member States should develop capacities in governmental institutions and support government officials to ensure that the technological is developed responsibly and ethically as well as in ways that fully protect, respect and promote human rights.

160. Member States should establish or designate national bodies responsible for overseeing and coordinating the regulation, vigilance and oversight of neurotechnology across relevant government agencies. These coordinating bodies should be tasked with ensuring that legal and regulatory frameworks are consistently applied, that public health and safety are protected, and that ethical standards and human rights are upheld throughout the whole life cycle of neurotechnology. This includes facilitating inter-agency collaboration, monitoring compliance with national and international standards, and ensuring that data and insights from different regulatory domains are shared effectively to inform decision-making and policy development. These bodies should also help coordinate public and community engagement.

161. Member States should strive to extend and complement their own actions in respect of this Recommendation, by cooperating with all relevant national and international governmental and non-governmental organizations, as well as transnational corporations and scientific organizations, whose activities fall within the scope and objectives of this Recommendation. Civil

society will be an important actor to advocate for the public sector's interests and therefore UNESCO needs to ensure and promote its legitimacy.

162. UNESCO should publicize and disseminate this Recommendation widely through all available means, and share it with Member States, National Commissions for UNESCO, relevant international and regional partners, human rights institutions where they exist, as well as with UNESCO ethics advisory bodies for dissemination to all levels and actors in this field.

163. To support Member States implementing this Recommendation by developing concrete programmes and policies and developing institutional capacities in the ethics of neurotechnology, UNESCO can contribute by:

- (a) developing a UNESCO readiness assessment methodology (RAM) to assist Member States in identifying their status at specific moments of their readiness trajectory along a continuum of dimensions;
- (b) developing a UNESCO methodology for Ethical Impact Assessment (EIA) of neurotechnology based on rigorous scientific research and grounded in international human rights law, along with specific guidance for its implementation in the whole neurotechnology life cycle, and capacity-building tools and materials to support Member States' efforts to train government officials, policymakers and other relevant actors on the methodology;
- (c) developing a UNESCO methodology to evaluate ex ante and ex post the effectiveness and the efficiency of the policies for neurotechnology ethics and incentives against defined objectives;
- (d) strengthening the research- and evidence-based analysis of and reporting on policies regarding neurotechnology in the framework of existing UNESCO forums;
- (e) collecting and disseminating progress, innovations, research reports, scientific publications, data and statistics regarding policies for neurotechnology, including through existing initiatives, to support sharing best practices and mutual learning, and to advance the implementation of this Recommendation.

164. Processes for monitoring and evaluation should ensure broad participation of all actors, including, but not limited to, under-represented, vulnerable people or those in vulnerable situations and ensuring social and cultural diversity and gender equality. The monitoring and assessment of the impact of neurotechnology and related ethics policies and practices should be carried out continuously in a systematic way proportionate to the relevant risks. This should be based on internationally consented frameworks and involve evaluations of private and public institutions. Data collection and processing should be conducted in accordance with international law and national legislation on data protection and data privacy, and in line with the values and principles outlined in this Recommendation.

VI. FINAL PROVISIONS

165. This Recommendation needs to be understood as a whole, and the foundational values and principles are to be understood as complementary and interrelated.

166. Nothing in this Recommendation may be interpreted as replacing, altering or otherwise prejudicing Member States' obligations or rights under international law, including international human rights law, or as approval for any State, other political, economic or social actor, group or person to engage in any activity or perform any act contrary to human rights, fundamental freedoms, human dignity and concern for the environment and ecosystems.